Point 1: Core Program Model

A. Objective of this point

Define the core POOOL Affiliate Program model for Phase 1 so that internal teams, affiliates, and users all understand the same structure, boundaries, and intent.

This point establishes:

- what the program is,
- what it is designed to do,
- what type of activity is allowed,
- what type of activity is not allowed,
- and how POOOL should describe the model internally and externally.

B. Key assumptions

- The approved baseline in this chat is the binding source of truth.
- Phase 1 is a **controlled referral-only program in Indonesia**.
- The program is **single-level only** and not MLM, not network marketing, and not a sales-team model.
- Affiliates may share general information, approved materials, their personal referral link, and official POOOL pages only.
- Affiliates may not provide investment advice, asset recommendations, return guarantees, active closing, side deals, private cold outreach, or payment handling.
- The model is being drafted to legal-review standard and not presented as legally final. **[LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]**

C. Full internal/professional draft

POOOL Affiliate Program

Program Scope & Positioning Statement

Phase 1 – Controlled Referral Model

1. Program position

The POOOL Affiliate Program is a controlled, compliance-led referral program designed to support awareness, education, and qualified traffic generation for POOOL in a limited and structured manner.

The program is not structured as an open sales force, broker network, or advisory channel. Its purpose is to allow approved affiliates to:

- introduce POOOL in a general way,
- direct potential users to official POOOL information,
- share their personal referral link or code where permitted,
- and generate qualified referral traffic within a controlled framework.

2. Program nature

The program is a **referral-only model**, not a personal selling model.

Affiliates act only as limited referrers operating within approved communication boundaries. Their role is restricted to awareness and introduction. They are not permitted to assess suitability, recommend specific investments, persuade users to invest, negotiate terms, or otherwise perform advisory or sales functions.

3. Structural boundaries

The Phase 1 model is built on the following structural principles:

- **Indonesia-focused launch**
- **single-level only**
- **no downlines**
- **no team overrides**
- **no multi-level commission logic**
- **no external sales teams**
- **approved materials only**
- **official POOOL sources only**
- **direct qualified referral logic only**

Compensation and tier advancement must be based only on the affiliate's own qualified referral activity as separately defined by POOOL's qualification and payout rules.

4. Positioning principle

The correct operational positioning of the program is:

> **Affiliates create awareness and direct users to official POOOL information.**
> **They do not advise, recommend, negotiate, close, or handle transactions.**

This principle must be reflected consistently across:

- affiliate terms,
- onboarding,
- website copy,
- disclosure text,
- dashboards,
- training materials,
- moderation,
- and enforcement.

5. Distinction between communication categories

A. General information

General information means neutral, non-personalized, non-advisory communication about POOOL, such as:

- what POOOL is,
- what services or opportunities are available on the platform in general terms,
- where official documents, risk information, fee information, and asset pages can be found,
- and how a user can learn more through official POOOL channels.

General information must remain factual, high-level, non-misleading, and consistent with approved materials.

B. Referral activity

Referral activity means permitted communication by an approved affiliate that:

- shares a personal referral link or code,
- directs a user to an official POOOL page,
- uses approved marketing materials,
- or invites a user to review official POOOL information through a permitted channel.

Referral activity is allowed only when it stays within the general-information boundary and does not turn into advisory, promotional pressure, or sales conduct.

C. Prohibited advisory/sales activity

Prohibited advisory or sales activity includes any conduct where the affiliate moves beyond neutral introduction and begins influencing, steering, or handling the user's decision or transaction.

This includes, without limitation:

- recommending a specific asset,
- suggesting what the user should buy,
- making claims about expected safety, returns, suitability, or profitability,
- persuading or pressuring a user to invest,
- answering in a way that amounts to personal investment guidance,
- negotiating or promising special terms,
- handling customer funds or payment steps,
- conducting private cold outreach,
- or using unapproved materials.

6. Safe-harbor principle for private conversations

Normal private, non-systematic conversations about personal experience with POOOL are not automatically treated as affiliate marketing.

However, once any of the following is introduced, the communication must be treated as affiliate communication and must fully comply with POOOL rules:

- referral link,
- referral code,
- call to action,
- systematic promotional behavior,
- or commission-related redirection.

This safe-harbor principle should be used internally as a practical compliance boundary and reflected in training materials.
[LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

7. Internal interpretation rule

When deciding whether a communication is allowed, POOOL should apply the following test:

A communication is permitted only if it remains within all of the following limits:

1. general information or compliant referral activity only,
2. approved materials or approved wording only,
3. no personal recommendation,
4. no promise or guarantee,
5. no negotiation or closing behavior,
6. no handling of funds,
7. no private cold outreach.

If any one of these limits is crossed, the communication should be classified as prohibited conduct.

8. Internal compliance instruction

All product, compliance, marketing, affiliate, and operations teams must treat the program as a **restricted referral layer**, not as a distributed sales channel.

Any proposed feature, campaign, workflow, copy, or incentive that would reasonably push affiliates into advisory, sales, or recruitment behavior must be rejected or escalated for legal/compliance review before implementation.
[LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

D. Short customer-facing / website-facing version

How the POOOL referral program works

POOOL's Phase 1 affiliate program is a controlled referral program for approved participants in Indonesia.

Affiliates may share general information about POOOL, use approved materials, share their personal referral link, and direct people to official POOOL pages, documents, fees, and risk information.

Affiliates do **not** act as personal investment advisers, brokers, or sales agents. They are not allowed to recommend specific assets, promise returns, negotiate deals, handle payments, or pressure anyone to invest.

In simple terms: affiliates can introduce POOOL and refer people to the official platform, but investment decisions must always be made independently based on official POOOL information.

Participation is subject to approval, onboarding, and ongoing compliance with POOOL's affiliate rules.

E. Required UI text / checkbox text / disclosure text (if relevant)

1. Website / onboarding distinction block

General Information
Neutral information about POOOL and links to official POOOL pages and documents.

Referral Activity
An approved affiliate shares their personal referral link or approved materials and directs users to official POOOL information.

Prohibited Advisory / Sales Activity
Personal investment advice, specific asset recommendations, return claims, sales pressure, negotiation, payment handling, or private cold outreach.

2. Affiliate onboarding acknowledgment

Checkbox text:
I understand that my role is limited to general information and compliant referral activity only. I may not provide investment advice, recommend specific assets, promise returns, negotiate, handle payments, or engage in prohibited sales activity.

3. Referral landing page disclosure

Disclosure text:
Referrers may receive compensation for qualified referrals. Referrers are not your personal investment adviser, broker, or sales representative. Please rely only on official POOOL information when making any investment decision.

4. Internal admin label suggestion

Use the following status labels in affiliate/admin tools:

- General information permitted
- Referral activity permitted
- Advisory/sales activity prohibited
- Escalate for review

F. Operational / backend / implementation notes

- Marketing and product teams should maintain a content matrix with three buckets:
    - permitted general information,
    - permitted referral communication,
    - prohibited advisory/sales communication.
- Affiliate training should include examples of each category with pass/fail scenarios.
- Dashboard and CMS tools should only provide approved content blocks and official page links.
- Engineering should not create tools that encourage:
    - “best asset” recommendations,
    - “close this lead” behavior,
    - private outreach automation,
    - payment collection by affiliates,
    - or custom pitch generation by affiliates.
- Moderation team should flag language such as:
    - “guaranteed,”

    - “safe investment,”
    - “buy this one,”
    - “I recommend this asset,”
    - “I can help you invest directly,”
    - “send me the money and I’ll arrange it.”
- Support escalation playbook should distinguish:
    - education question,
    - referral question,
    - product question,
    - advisory-risk incident.
- The same distinction logic should be reused later in:
    - Affiliate Terms,
    - Code of Conduct,
    - Marketing Materials Policy,
    - training quiz,
    - complaint handling,
    - and clawback/suspension workflows.

G. Open legal-review items

- Whether any of the proposed category labels should be revised to better fit Indonesian regulatory language and risk allocation.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]
- Whether additional disclaimers are needed to avoid any implication that affiliates are acting as brokers, introducers, or financial advisers.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]
- Whether the private-conversation safe-harbor rule should be further narrowed in the written terms.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]
- Whether the Indonesia-only positioning should be stated expressly in public-facing program copy or kept primarily in affiliate-facing documentation.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

H. Final recommended version

Use the following as the core program model statement:

> **POOOL’s Phase 1 Affiliate Program is a controlled, single-level referral program. Approved affiliates may share general information, approved materials, their personal referral link, and official POOOL pages only. Their role is limited to awareness and referral activity. They may not provide**

personal investment advice, recommend specific assets, promise returns, negotiate deals, handle customer funds, conduct private cold outreach, or otherwise perform advisory or sales functions. POOOL affiliates introduce the platform; they do not advise or sell.

5 short “what this is / what this is not” clarifiers

1. **This is:** a controlled referral program.
   This is not: an open sales force.
2. **This is:** sharing approved information and official POOOL links.
   This is not: giving personal investment advice.
3. **This is:** introducing POOOL in general terms.
   This is not: recommending a specific asset to buy.
4. **This is:** earning from qualified direct referrals under POOOL rules.
   This is not: MLM, downlines, or team commissions.
5. **This is:** directing users to official POOOL materials to decide for themselves.
   This is not: closing, negotiating, or handling payments for users.

Point 2: Phase 1 Structure with No Sales Teams

A. Objective of this point

Define and formalize that POOOL Phase 1 launches as a **controlled referral-only program** and **not** as a sales organization.

This point is intended to prevent operational drift from referral activity into:

- structured sales activity,
- closing functions,
- advisory selling,
- outsourced promoters,
- or informal "sales helper" roles that would effectively turn affiliates into sales agents.

B. Key assumptions

- The approved baseline in this chat is the binding source of truth.
- Phase 1 is intentionally limited to a **controlled referral-only model**.
- POOOL does **not** launch Phase 1 with:
    - external sales teams,
    - closers,
    - appointment setters,
    - advisory sellers,
    - or similar revenue-conversion roles.
- Affiliates may create awareness, share approved materials, share their personal referral link, and direct users to official POOOL information only.
- Any role that persuades, recommends, negotiates, or pushes a user toward investment moves beyond the intended Phase 1 boundary.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

C. Full internal/professional draft

POOOL Phase 1 Operating Rule

No Sales Teams / No Closers / No Advisory Sellers

1. Core rule

POOOL Phase 1 shall launch and operate as a **controlled referral-only model**.

In Phase 1, POOOL may permit approved affiliates to:

- introduce POOOL in general terms,
- share approved marketing materials,
- use their personal referral link or code,
- and direct users to official POOOL pages, documents, risk information, and fee information.

POOOL shall **not** operate Phase 1 through any external or quasi-external sales structure.

2. No sales-team model

Phase 1 expressly excludes the use of:

- external sales teams,
- freelance sales representatives,
- “closers,”
- appointment setters,
- deal-conversion agents,
- advisory sellers,
- chat-based or call-based persuaders,
- regional promoter teams,
- and similar roles designed to move prospects from awareness into commitment through personalized influence.

No manager, affiliate lead, marketing partner, community partner, or third party may create such a structure informally, experimentally, or under another label.

3. No advisory selling

In Phase 1, no affiliate or third-party promoter may be used to:

- assess a prospect’s needs, risk profile, suitability, or investment goals,
- guide the prospect toward a particular asset, allocation, or decision,
- persuade the prospect to invest,
- overcome objections in a sales capacity,

- explain why a particular opportunity is “better,” “safer,” or “more suitable,”
- or otherwise function as a human conversion layer between official POOOL information and the customer’s final decision.

That type of conduct is outside the permitted referral model and is prohibited in Phase 1.

4. No hidden sales substitution

The prohibition applies regardless of wording or title.
A person will be treated as performing a prohibited sales function if, in substance, they:

- influence the prospect’s investment decision,
- handle objection management,
- create urgency,
- recommend action,
- guide closing behavior,
- or act as a conversion intermediary.

This applies even if that person is called, for example:

- ambassador,
- community lead,
- onboarding helper,
- success partner,
- education partner,
- introducer,
- relationship manager,
- consultant,
- affiliate mentor,
- or any similar title.

5. Operational design principle

The permitted Phase 1 structure is:

> **Affiliate → official POOOL page / official POOOL materials / official platform flow**

The prohibited structure is:

> **Affiliate or third party → personal persuasion / recommendation / objection handling / negotiation / closing**

All product, marketing, affiliate, operations, and partner workflows must be designed to preserve the first structure and block the second.

6. Conversion boundary

Phase 1 affiliates may generate awareness and qualified traffic.
They may not own or control the human conversion process.

Where users require:

- product clarification,
- procedural support,
- platform navigation help,
- or document access guidance,

that support must be provided through **official POOOL-controlled channels** using approved scripts, approved support roles, and internal escalation controls, without turning the interaction into personal investment guidance or sales persuasion.
[LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

7. No informal exceptions

No exception may be created based on:

- “high-quality leads,”
- “trusted affiliates,”
- “top-tier partners,”
- “private investor groups,”
- “friends and family referrals,”
- “VIP handling,”
- or “just helping the user decide.”

If the activity crosses into recommendation, persuasion, objection handling, or deal-closing conduct, it is prohibited unless POOOL later adopts a separately approved framework with revised legal, compliance, operational, and documentation controls.
[LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

8. Escalation rule

If any team proposes a role, workflow, campaign, script, or incentive that would place an affiliate or third party into a prospect-persuasion function, the proposal must be:

1. stopped,
2. escalated,
3. reviewed by compliance/legal,
4. and not deployed in Phase 1 unless formally restructured and approved.
   [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

D. Short customer-facing / website-facing version

Short website / internal FAQ explanation

Does POOOL use affiliate sales teams or closers in Phase 1?
No. POOOL Phase 1 is a controlled referral-only program.

Approved affiliates may introduce POOOL, share approved materials, use their personal referral link, and direct users to official POOOL information. They do not act as sales agents, personal advisers, or closers.

That means affiliates may not recommend specific assets, pressure users to invest, negotiate terms, handle payments, or privately "walk someone into" an investment decision.

Investment decisions must always be made by the user independently based on official POOOL information.

E. Required UI text / checkbox text / disclosure text (if relevant)

1. Affiliate onboarding acknowledgment

Checkbox text:
I understand that POOOL Phase 1 is a referral-only program and not a sales-team model. I may not act as a closer, sales agent, advisory seller, or conversion intermediary.

2. Internal manager notice

Internal warning text:
Do not create or approve any workflow in which affiliates or third parties persuade, recommend, negotiate, or close prospects. Phase 1 allows referral activity only.

3. Partner application notice

Notice:
POOOL is not onboarding external sales teams, closing partners, or advisory sellers in Phase 1. The program is limited to controlled referral activity only.

F. Operational / backend / implementation notes

Manager-facing implementation rule

Managers must enforce the Phase 1 boundary by ensuring that affiliates and external partners are used only for **traffic generation and introduction**, never for **human conversion activity**.

Implementation standard

A manager may approve an affiliate activity only if all of the following are true:

1. the activity is limited to general information or compliant referral activity,
2. the affiliate uses only approved materials or approved wording,
3. the user is directed to official POOOL pages or official POOOL-controlled flows,
4. the affiliate does not recommend, persuade, negotiate, or close,
5. the affiliate does not handle payment steps, funds, or side arrangements,
6. the activity does not rely on private cold outreach,
7. the workflow does not create a de facto sales role under another name.

Enforcement rule

Managers must reject, stop, or escalate any proposal that includes any of the following:

- call scripts designed to improve close rates,
- objection-handling scripts for affiliates,
- affiliate-led consultation calls,
- “sales conversion help” for referred users,
- affiliate-managed investor groups aimed at pushing commitments,
- custom pitch decks for affiliate use,
- performance incentives tied to persuasion behavior,
- affiliate-led deal explanation sessions that go beyond official materials,
- or any request to let “trusted affiliates” personally guide decisions.

Monitoring rule

Operations and affiliate management should monitor for:

- repeated one-to-one persuasion behavior,
- language that suggests advice or recommendation,
- private chats used as sales channels,
- affiliate requests for custom sales material,
- affiliate claims of “helping people decide,”
- and any evidence that a referral role has become a conversion role.

Escalation trigger

If there is doubt whether an activity is education/referral or sales/advisory conduct, the activity should be treated as **not approved** until reviewed.

List of prohibited roles or activities that would accidentally turn affiliates into sales agents

Prohibited roles

- closer
- sales closer
- external sales representative
- freelance sales agent
- appointment setter for investment conversion
- investment coach tied to referral conversion
- advisory seller
- investor consultant linked to affiliate commission
- relationship manager for referred prospects
- community salesperson
- conversion agent
- lead nurturer whose task is to push commitment
- objection handler
- private promoter handling warm leads
- unofficial "account manager" for investors
- affiliate sub-team leader managing conversion behavior

Prohibited activities

- holding one-to-one calls to convince a prospect to invest
- telling a prospect which asset to choose
- explaining why one asset is better for that person
- answering suitability questions with personal guidance
- following up to overcome objections and secure a commitment
- using urgency or pressure to get a user to invest
- negotiating special terms, bonuses, or exceptions
- promising outcomes, returns, safety, or likely profit
- collecting or forwarding customer funds
- telling users to send money first and complete process later
- using private cold DMs, WhatsApp, Telegram, or calls to push the product
- running private investor groups as unofficial closing channels
- creating unapproved personal pitch decks or custom sales scripts
- presenting oneself as an adviser, broker, analyst, or internal POOOL representative

- “pre-qualifying” a user and steering them to a specific opportunity

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G. Open legal-review items

- Whether any official POOOL support roles need additional wording to ensure they are not interpreted as advisory or sales roles.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]
- Whether any affiliate-assisted educational events require additional scripting, disclaimer, or moderation controls.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]
- Whether any terms such as “introducer,” “ambassador,” or “community partner” should be restricted or prohibited in Phase 1 documents.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]
- Whether manager escalation requirements should be mirrored directly in the Affiliate Terms and Code of Conduct.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

H. Final recommended version

Adopt the following as the Phase 1 structural rule:

> **POOOL Phase 1 shall operate as a controlled referral-only program and not as a sales-team model. No external sales teams, closers, advisory sellers, appointment setters, or similar conversion roles are permitted. Approved affiliates may create awareness, share approved materials, use their personal referral link, and direct users to official POOOL information only. They may not persuade, recommend, negotiate, close, handle funds, or otherwise act as sales agents or advisers. Any workflow that turns affiliates into human conversion intermediaries is prohibited in Phase 1.**

Point 3: Permitted Affiliate Activities

A. Objective of this point

Define exactly what POOOL affiliates are allowed to do in Phase 1 so that affiliates, managers, compliance, product, and support teams all apply the same standard.

This point is intended to:

- translate the approved baseline into a usable operating rule,
- reduce ambiguity around "allowed promotion,"
- keep affiliates within the general-information and referral zone,
- and prevent accidental drift into advisory, sales, or unapproved communications.

B. Key assumptions

- The approved baseline in this chat is the binding source of truth.
- Phase 1 is a **controlled, referral-only, single-level** affiliate model.
- Affiliates may:
  - present POOOL in general terms,
  - share their personal referral link,
  - use approved materials only,
  - and direct users to official POOOL pages and documents.
- Affiliates may not:
  - provide investment advice,
  - recommend specific assets,
  - promise returns,
  - actively close,
  - privately cold-outreach,
  - handle payments,
  - or use unapproved materials.
- This draft is prepared to legal-review standard and is not a claim of final legal approval. **[LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]**

C. Full internal/professional draft

POOOL Affiliate Program

Permitted Activities Standard

Phase 1

1. Core principle

POOOL affiliates may operate only within the **general information + compliant referral activity** zone.

Their permitted role is limited to:

- creating awareness,
- sharing approved information,
- directing users to official POOOL resources,
- and generating attributable referral traffic through approved referral tools.

Affiliates do not advise, assess suitability, recommend assets, negotiate, close, or handle any part of the investment transaction.

2. General permitted activity rule

An affiliate activity is permitted only if all of the following are true:

1. it presents POOOL in general or factual terms,
2. it uses approved materials, approved wording, or approved official source content,
3. it links only to the affiliate's personal referral link and/or official POOOL pages,
4. it does not include personal investment advice or specific asset recommendations,
5. it does not include return promises, guaranteed outcomes, or misleading claims,
6. it does not involve negotiation, objection-handling, or closing conduct,
7. it does not involve collection, forwarding, or handling of customer funds,
8. it does not rely on prohibited private cold outreach,
9. it does not create the impression that the affiliate is acting as an adviser, broker, analyst, sales agent, or POOOL representative beyond the approved referral role.

If any of these conditions is not met, the activity is outside the permitted standard.

3. Permitted activity categories

A. General brand and platform awareness

Affiliates may:

- describe POOOL in general terms,
- explain that POOOL is a platform or marketplace in approved general language,
- state that users can review official POOOL information on the platform,
- and encourage users to learn more through official channels.

This communication must remain non-personalized and non-advisory.

B. Sharing approved public content

Affiliates may publish or repost approved:

- posts,
- short-form content,
- videos,
- story formats,
- visual creatives,
- banners,
- blog-style content,
- and official campaign content,

provided that such use remains consistent with the Approved Marketing Materials Policy and any applicable channel guidance.

C. Use of personal referral link or referral code

Affiliates may:

- share their personal referral link,
- include the link in posts, captions, bios, story links, landing pages approved by POOOL, or other approved placements,
- and invite users to review official POOOL pages through that link.

Affiliates may not mask the nature of the referral or use deceptive routing practices.
[LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

D. Directing users to official POOOL information

Affiliates may direct users to official:

- POOOL website pages,
- asset pages,
- fee pages,
- risk information,
- FAQs,
- terms,
- disclosure pages,
- or other approved official resources.

Where a user asks for more detailed information, the affiliate must point to official POOOL materials rather than answer in a way that becomes advisory or persuasive.

E. Describing their own experience in a compliant way

Affiliates may describe their own experience with POOOL in a factual, non-misleading, non-promissory way, provided they do not:

- turn that communication into a specific investment recommendation,
- imply guaranteed outcomes,
- or use personal experience as a substitute for official product, risk, or suitability information.

Any statement about personal experience must remain clearly personal, limited, and not framed as advice.
[LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

F. Answering basic non-advisory questions

Affiliates may answer basic high-level questions such as:

- where official information can be found,
- how users can sign up,
- where risk or fee information is located,
- or how to access official pages.

Affiliates must not answer questions in a way that becomes:

- suitability guidance,
- asset comparison for the user,
- expected-return guidance,
- or investment decision support.

If a question approaches those areas, the affiliate must redirect the user to official POOOL materials or official POOOL-controlled support channels.

4. Permitted channel use

Affiliates may use approved channels and formats for compliant referral activity, including:

- public social media posts,
- videos,
- reels,
- stories,
- blog posts,
- profile bio links,
- approved landing-page placements,
- and other public-facing approved formats.

Channel use is permitted only when the content remains within the permitted activity standard and any channel-specific compliance rules adopted by POOOL.

5. Required conduct standard

All permitted affiliate activity must be:

- truthful,
- accurate,
- consistent with approved materials,
- not misleading,
- not exaggerated,
- not incomplete in a way that creates a false impression,
- and clearly subordinate to official POOOL information.

Affiliates must not improvise product claims, risk descriptions, performance language, or commercial promises.

6. Mandatory redirect rule

If a user asks a question that could require:

- personal investment guidance,
- specific asset assessment,
- legal or tax interpretation,
- prediction of returns,
- or suitability analysis,

the affiliate must not answer substantively. Instead, the affiliate must redirect the user to official POOOL information and/or official POOOL-controlled support.

7. Interpretation rule

If there is uncertainty whether a proposed activity is allowed, the default rule is:

- it is **not approved until confirmed**.

Managers and compliance reviewers should interpret borderline behavior conservatively to preserve the Phase 1 referral-only model.

D. Short customer-facing / website-facing version

Short affiliate-facing summary in plain language

You may introduce POOOL, share approved content, use your personal referral link, and send people to official POOOL pages, documents, fees, and risk information.

You may talk about POOOL in general terms and share your own experience carefully and truthfully.

You may **not** give personal investment advice, recommend a specific asset, promise returns, negotiate deals, pressure someone to invest, handle money, or use unapproved materials.

Simple rule:
Bring attention, share your referral link, and direct people to official POOOL information — but do not advise or sell.

E. Required UI text / checkbox text / disclosure text (if relevant)

Website / help-center copy explaining what affiliates are allowed to do

What are POOOL affiliates allowed to do?

Approved POOOL affiliates may:

- share general information about POOOL,
- use approved marketing materials,
- share their personal referral link,
- and direct users to official POOOL pages, documents, fees, and risk information.

Affiliates may create public content such as posts, videos, stories, and blogs, as long as the content stays factual, uses approved materials, and does not cross into personal advice or sales activity.

Affiliates are not allowed to recommend specific assets, promise returns, negotiate special terms, handle payments, or act as personal investment advisers.

Investment decisions must always be made independently based on official POOOL information.

Optional onboarding checkbox

Checkbox text:
I understand that I may only share general information, approved materials, my personal referral link, and official POOOL pages. I may not provide advice, recommend specific assets, promise returns, negotiate, or handle payments.

Optional help-center note

Help-center note:
When in doubt, share official POOOL information and your referral link only. Do not answer in a way that sounds like advice or a sales pitch.

F. Operational / backend / implementation notes

Channel-specific examples of allowed conduct

1. Public posts

Allowed examples

- “POOOL is building a platform where users can explore official opportunities and documents directly on the platform. You can learn more here: [referral link]”
- “If you want to see how POOOL works, you can review the official pages, fees, and risk information here: [referral link]”
- “I’m sharing my referral link for anyone who wants to explore POOOL through the official website: [referral link]”

Allowed format characteristics

- general description,
- approved visuals,
- official links,
- no specific asset recommendation,
- no return or safety claims.

2. Videos / reels

Allowed examples

- short educational video explaining what POOOL is in general terms
- walkthrough of where users can find official information on the platform
- creator-style intro: “Here is a platform I’m following — if you want to review the official information yourself, here is my referral link.”

Allowed format characteristics

- informational,
- high-level,
- no “this is the best one to buy,”

- no “you should invest now,”
- no personalized recommendations.

3. Stories

Allowed examples

- “Want to check out POOOL? Here’s my referral link.”
- “Official info, fees, and risk details are on the platform here.”
- “New update from POOOL — review it on the official site through my link.”

Allowed format characteristics

- short CTA to review official information,
- referral sticker or swipe-up link if approved,
- no pressure language,
- no advice language.

4. Blogs / long-form content

Allowed examples

- overview article explaining what POOOL does in general
- article summarizing official platform features using approved wording
- educational post about how users can review official POOOL materials and make their own decisions

Allowed format characteristics

- factual,
- cites or links official POOOL pages,
- no personalized recommendation,
- no custom investment conclusion,
- no unapproved forecasts or claims.

5. Referral links

Allowed examples

- link in profile bio
- link in approved landing page
- link in post caption
- link in story
- link shared in response to inbound interest, provided the response remains compliant and non-advisory

Allowed use conditions

- the link must be the affiliate's own approved referral link,
- the link must direct to approved official POOOL pages or approved flow paths,
- the link must not be used together with prohibited advisory or closing behavior.

Manager / operations implementation notes

- Build a channel-specific content library with pre-approved examples for:
  - posts,
  - reels,
  - story frames,
  - blog formats,
  - link placements.
- Provide affiliates with a "say / do not say" reference sheet.
- Require all templates, captions, and visuals used at scale to be versioned and approved.
- Flag affiliates whose content repeatedly includes:
  - asset-level persuasion,
  - performance language,
  - comparative recommendations,
  - "DM me and I'll help you decide" language,
  - or quasi-sales behavior.
- Support should provide a standard redirect script for affiliates to use when users ask advisory-style questions.

G. Open legal-review items

- Whether personal-experience statements should carry a standard disclaimer in all public-facing affiliate content.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]
- Whether any specific channels require additional rules on disclosure placement, link presentation, or recordkeeping.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]
- Whether certain long-form content types should require pre-approval in all cases rather than rule-based approval only.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]
- Whether the phrase "share your own experience" should be narrowed further in the affiliate policy documents.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

H. Final recommended version

Use the following as the core permitted-activities rule:

> **POOOL affiliates may share general information about POOOL, use approved marketing materials, share their personal referral link, and direct users to official POOOL pages, documents, fee information, and risk information. They may create public-facing content such as posts, videos, stories, blogs, and other approved formats, provided the content remains factual, non-misleading, non-advisory, and consistent with approved materials. Affiliates may not provide personal investment advice, recommend specific assets, promise returns, negotiate terms, pressure users to invest, handle customer funds, or use unapproved materials. When a user asks for anything that could require advice, suitability guidance, or a recommendation, the affiliate must redirect the user to official POOOL information or official POOOL-controlled support.**

Point 4: Prohibited Affiliate Activities

A. Objective of this point

Define the full set of activities that POOOL affiliates are prohibited from performing in Phase 1, so that the referral model stays clearly separated from advisory, sales, solicitation, and transaction-handling activity.

This point is intended to:

- protect the Phase 1 referral-only structure,
- give affiliates a clear “do not cross” boundary,
- support moderation, enforcement, payout control, and clawback,
- and create a usable breach framework for operations and compliance.

B. Key assumptions

- The approved baseline in this chat is the binding source of truth.
- Phase 1 is a **controlled, single-level, referral-only** model.
- Affiliates may share general information, approved materials, their personal referral link, and official POOOL pages only.
- Affiliates may not provide investment advice, asset recommendations, return guarantees, active closing, private cold outreach, side deals, payment handling, or unapproved materials.
- Normal private, non-systematic conversations are not automatically prohibited, but once a referral link, code, CTA, or commission-related redirection is introduced, the communication must comply fully with POOOL’s affiliate rules.
- This draft is prepared to legal-review standard and is not legally final. **[LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]**

C. Full internal/professional draft

POOOL Affiliate Program

Prohibited Activities Standard

Phase 1

1. Core prohibition rule

POOOL affiliates must not engage in any activity that moves their role beyond **general information and compliant referral activity** into:

- personal investment guidance,
- asset recommendation,
- persuasive selling,
- transaction handling,
- misleading promotion,
- unapproved communication,
- or controlled-channel evasion.

Any such activity is prohibited whether performed publicly, privately, directly, indirectly, manually, through scripts, through third parties, or through any digital communication channel.

2. General prohibited activity test

An activity is prohibited if it does any of the following:

1. recommends, suggests, or steers a user toward a particular asset or investment decision;
2. gives personal investment advice, suitability guidance, or decision support;
3. promises, implies, exaggerates, or selectively frames returns, safety, likely profit, or certainty of outcome;
4. uses sales pressure, objection handling, urgency tactics, or closing behavior;
5. involves side deals, special promises, hidden arrangements, or off-platform commitments;
6. involves handling, collecting, forwarding, receiving, or controlling customer money or payment steps;
7. uses unapproved materials, unapproved claims, or unapproved explanations;
8. uses prohibited private cold outreach or systematic one-to-one product pushing;
9. misrepresents the affiliate’s role, authority, relationship with POOOL, or status;
10. interferes with required disclosures, official information flows, monitoring controls, or attribution controls.

If an activity falls into any of these categories, it is prohibited.

3. Specific prohibited categories

A. Guarantees, promises, and misleading return language

Affiliates must not make or imply statements such as:

- “This is guaranteed.”
- “You will definitely make money.”
- “This is safe.”
- “This cannot lose.”
- “You will get your money back.”
- “This will give you X%.”
- “This is low-risk for you.”
- “This is basically certain.”
- “This is the best investment.”
- “You should enter now before it is too late.”

This prohibition includes explicit claims, implied claims, selective framing, exaggerated confidence, or any language that creates a misleading impression of certainty, safety, or expected results.

B. Personal investment advice

Affiliates must not provide personal investment advice or any equivalent guidance, including:

- telling a person whether they should invest,
- telling a person how much they should invest,
- telling a person whether an investment fits their goals,
- discussing what is “best” for their personal situation,
- comparing opportunities for the purpose of steering a decision,
- responding to “What should I buy?” with directional guidance,
- or otherwise helping a user decide in an advisory capacity.

C. Specific asset recommendations

Affiliates must not recommend a specific asset, project, listing, or offering.

Examples include:

- “Buy this villa.”
- “This is the right one for you.”
- “Choose this asset, not the other one.”
- “This project is the safest.”
- “I recommend this specific opportunity.”
- “Start with this one because it will perform better.”

D. Active selling, persuasion, and closing conduct

Affiliates must not engage in sales behavior, including:

- persuading a user to commit,
- overcoming objections,
- pushing for urgency,
- following up repeatedly to secure an investment,
- asking for commitment decisions,
- leading conversion calls,
- handling “last-mile” decision pressure,
- or acting as a closer, sales helper, or conversion intermediary.

E. Private cold outreach

Affiliates must not use private cold channels for product solicitation, including:

- cold DMs,
- cold WhatsApp messages,
- cold Telegram messages,
- cold private chats,
- cold calls,
- or similar unsolicited one-to-one outreach for referral or investment-promotion purposes.

This includes first contact and repeated unsolicited follow-up contact intended to create referral conversions.

F. Side deals, special arrangements, and unofficial promises

Affiliates must not create, suggest, or imply:

- special terms,
- side commissions,
- cashback promises not officially approved,
- extra benefits,
- private discounts,
- special access,
- faster processing,
- private guarantees,
- or off-platform arrangements.

Affiliates may not negotiate on behalf of POOOL or create expectations that official POOOL documents do not support.

G. Payment handling and transaction involvement

Affiliates must not:

- receive money from prospects or users,
- ask users to transfer funds to them,
- forward funds,
- pool funds,
- hold funds temporarily,
- assist with payment routing outside official flows,
- complete payment steps on behalf of users,
- collect wallet addresses or payment credentials for transaction handling,
- or otherwise become involved in the movement or control of customer money.

H. Use of unapproved materials or unapproved wording

Affiliates must not use:

- self-created pitch decks not approved by POOOL,
- self-written return claims,
- altered visuals,
- edited official materials that change meaning,
- unauthorized screenshots used in a misleading way,
- unofficial FAQs,
- unapproved scripts,
- custom sales documents,
- or any content that has not been approved where approval is required.

Affiliates also must not improvise explanations in ways that create claims beyond approved wording.

I. Misrepresentation of authority or role

Affiliates must not present themselves as:

- investment advisers,
- brokers,
- analysts,
- sales representatives,
- official POOOL staff unless they are,
- negotiation contacts,
- decision makers,
- or authorized persons for legal, tax, product, or investment interpretation.

Affiliates must not imply they can approve, prioritize, secure, or customize investment outcomes for users.

J. Evasion and indirect misconduct

Affiliates must not try to avoid the rules by:

- using friends, assistants, or team members to perform prohibited outreach,
- moving prohibited claims into voice notes or disappearing messages,
- sharing prohibited sales language in private groups,
- using another person's approved account or materials,
- hiding referral intent while still seeking commission,
- or splitting a prohibited activity across multiple messages or channels.

4. Safe-harbor boundary for private conversations

POOOL does not prohibit normal private, non-systematic conversation about personal experience as such.

However, once the affiliate:

- shares a referral link,
- shares a referral code,
- uses a call to action,
- redirects someone in a commission-related way,
- or turns the conversation into structured product promotion,

the communication falls under affiliate rules and all prohibitions in this standard apply in full.

This should be interpreted conservatively in moderation and enforcement.
[LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

5. Mandatory redirect rule

If a user asks for:

- personal advice,
- a recommendation,
- a comparison framed around what they should choose,
- expected outcomes,
- suitability guidance,
- or help completing the transaction outside official flows,

the affiliate must not answer substantively. The affiliate must redirect the user to official POOOL information and/or official POOOL-controlled support.

6. Zero-tolerance conduct areas

The following areas should be treated as especially sensitive and escalation-worthy:

- guarantees or certainty claims,

- personal investment advice,
- specific asset recommendations,
- payment handling,
- private cold outreach,
- side deals,
- falsified or altered materials,
- and impersonation or role misrepresentation.

7. Enforcement linkage

A breach of this Prohibited Activities Standard may result in one or more of the following:

- warning,
- content takedown,
- mandatory retraining,
- temporary suspension,
- link deactivation,
- payout freeze,
- commission denial,
- clawback,
- permanent removal,
- internal incident review,
- or legal escalation where necessary.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

D. Short customer-facing / website-facing version

Short affiliate-facing warning section

Important warning:
You may not advise, sell, guarantee, negotiate, or handle payments.

That means you must not:

- promise profits or safety,
- recommend a specific asset,
- tell someone what they should invest in,
- contact people through private cold messages to push POOOL,
- make side deals or unofficial promises,
- collect or handle customer money,
- or use materials that were not approved by POOOL.

Simple rule:
If it sounds like advice, a sales pitch, a guarantee, or a private deal, do not do it.

E. Required UI text / checkbox text / disclosure text (if relevant)

Website / help-center version with plain-language examples

What are affiliates not allowed to do?

POOOL affiliates are not allowed to act like personal advisers or sales agents.

For example, affiliates must not say things like:

- “This investment is guaranteed.”
- “You should buy this villa.”
- “This one is best for you.”
- “You will definitely make money.”
- “Send me the funds and I’ll help you arrange it.”

Affiliates also must not:

- privately cold-message people to push POOOL,
- offer side deals or unofficial benefits,
- use their own unapproved pitch decks or claim sheets,
- negotiate special terms,
- or handle any part of a user’s payment.

Affiliates may introduce POOOL and direct users to official POOOL information only. All investment decisions must be made independently by the user based on official POOOL materials.

Optional onboarding checkbox

Checkbox text:
I understand that I must not provide investment advice, recommend specific assets, promise returns, engage in private cold outreach, offer side deals, handle customer payments, or use unapproved materials.

Optional help-center warning

Warning note:
If you are unsure whether something crosses the line, do not say it or do it. Use approved materials and direct the user to official POOOL information only.

F. Operational / backend / implementation notes

Risk-based classification of violations

1. Minor breaches

Minor breaches are lower-severity violations that do not necessarily involve direct advice, payment handling, or intentional misconduct, but still break the rules and require correction.

Examples

- using outdated but previously approved material after a newer version has been issued,
- omitting a required disclosure in a post or caption,
- using informal wording that is too promotional but does not yet amount to advice or guarantee,
- publishing content before required review where pre-approval was required,
- linking to the wrong official page or incomplete official page,
- posting an unapproved visual that does not materially change the message,
- failing to use the standard redirect language when asked borderline questions.

Typical response

- warning,
- content correction,
- content takedown,
- mandatory retraining,
- temporary content restriction,
- documented incident note.

2. Serious breaches

Serious breaches are violations that materially increase regulatory, customer, or mis-selling risk, but may not yet involve direct payment handling or the most severe forms of misconduct.

Examples

- making performance claims or soft guarantees,
- describing an opportunity as “safe,” “best,” or “guaranteed” in substance,
- giving personal investment advice,

- recommending a specific asset,
- engaging in repeated private solicitation after inbound contact becomes advisory or sales-driven,
- using unapproved pitch decks or custom claim sheets,
- presenting oneself as a quasi-adviser or unofficial POOOL representative,
- negotiating unofficial benefits,
- running private groups that function as informal closing channels,
- repeated failure to follow redirect rules.

Typical response

- immediate review,
- link deactivation,
- payout hold,
- suspension,
- mandatory investigation,
- retraining or probation,
- commission denial for affected referrals,
- possible clawback depending on impact.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

3. Critical breaches

Critical breaches are high-risk violations that directly threaten customer protection, program integrity, or legal/compliance safety and should be treated as immediate escalation events.

Examples

- explicit guarantees or certainty promises tied to investment outcomes,
- direct personal advice used to push investment decisions,
- payment handling, fund collection, routing, or custody behavior,
- side deals or off-platform transaction arrangements,
- falsified, manipulated, or intentionally misleading materials,
- systematic private cold outreach campaigns,
- impersonating POOOL staff or claiming authority not granted,
- fraud indicators, self-referral manipulation, referral rings tied to misconduct,
- concealment of prohibited activity through alternate accounts, assistants, or hidden channels,
- refusal to stop prohibited activity after prior notice,
- repeated serious breaches showing intentional disregard.

Typical response

- immediate suspension,
- link termination,

- payout freeze,
- clawback review,
- permanent removal,
- formal internal investigation,
- legal escalation where appropriate.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

Manager / compliance handling notes

- Build moderation flags around keywords such as:
  - guaranteed,
  - safe,
  - best for you,
  - I recommend,
  - send me the money,
  - I can arrange it,
  - limited spot, act now,
  - message me privately and I'll help you choose.
- Maintain an incident log with:
  - affiliate ID,
  - date,
  - channel,
  - content copy,
  - breach category,
  - severity,
  - action taken,
  - payout impact,
  - retraining status.
- Repeat offenses should increase classification severity.
- Any suspected payment handling, side deal, or impersonation should bypass ordinary moderation and go directly to escalation review.
- Link deactivation and payout freeze should be technically available immediately.
- Versioned material controls should help distinguish accidental outdated use from intentional unapproved content creation.

G. Open legal-review items

- Whether any violation category should automatically trigger permanent disqualification rather than discretionary review.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

- Whether side-deal language should be expanded to expressly cover rebates, cashback, gifts, or private incentives.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]
- Whether the breach classification should be mirrored directly in the Affiliate Terms, Code of Conduct, and Complaint & Investigation SOP.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]
- Whether private-outreach rules require additional wording for inbound versus outbound one-to-one interactions.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]
- Whether payment-handling breaches should require a mandatory finance/compliance escalation workflow.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

H. Final recommended version

Use the following as the core prohibited-activities rule:

> **POOOL affiliates must not provide personal investment advice, recommend specific assets, promise or imply returns or safety, engage in sales pressure or closing behavior, conduct private cold outreach, offer side deals, handle customer money or payment steps, use unapproved materials, or misrepresent their role or authority. Any activity that moves the affiliate beyond general information and compliant referral activity into advisory, sales, negotiation, or transaction-handling conduct is prohibited. Violations must be classified and enforced based on risk severity, with immediate escalation for guarantees, advice, payment handling, side deals, impersonation, and systematic private solicitation.**

Point 5: Safe-Harbor Rule for Normal Private Conversations vs. Affiliate Communication

A. Objective of this point

Define a practical and enforceable boundary between:

- normal private, non-systematic conversations about POOOL or personal experience, and
- affiliate-regulated communication that must comply fully with POOOL's affiliate rules.

This point is intended to prevent overreach on ordinary human conversation while still protecting POOOL against hidden referral marketing, advisory conduct, and uncontrolled private promotion.

B. Key assumptions

- The approved baseline in this chat is the binding source of truth.
- POOOL does **not** want a rule so broad that affiliates feel they can never speak privately about POOOL again.
- At the same time, POOOL needs a clear compliance trigger once a conversation becomes referral-driven, CTA-driven, or commission-related.
- The safest operational boundary is:
    - normal private, non-systematic conversation is generally outside affiliate regulation;
    - once a referral link, referral code, call to action, or commission-related redirection is used, the communication becomes affiliate-regulated communication.
- The exact legal treatment of every private-conversation fact pattern is not fully settled by a single express rule in the baseline and therefore requires cautious drafting. **[LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]**

C. Full internal/professional draft

POOOL Affiliate Program

Private Conversation vs. Affiliate Communication Rule

Phase 1

1. Core rule

POOOL distinguishes between:

1. **Normal private conversation**, and
2. **Affiliate communication**.

Normal private conversation is generally permitted outside the affiliate rule set, provided it remains genuinely personal, non-systematic, and not used as a disguised referral or sales channel.

Affiliate communication begins when a conversation is used to promote, direct, convert, or monetize user interest in POOOL through referral-related conduct or other regulated affiliate behavior.

2. Safe-harbor for normal private conversation

A conversation should generally be treated as a normal private conversation, and not as affiliate-regulated communication, when all of the following are true:

- it is informal and personal in nature,
- it is not part of a systematic promotional pattern,
- it does not include a referral link or referral code,
- it does not include a call to action to sign up, invest, or use the affiliate's referral path,
- it does not include commission-motivated redirection,
- it does not include advisory or sales conduct,
- and it does not otherwise function as a conversion step.

Examples may include:

- casual discussion with family or friends about one's own experience,
- answering a spontaneous question in general terms,
- mentioning that one knows or uses POOOL,
- or discussing POOOL without directing the person into a tracked referral flow.

3. When communication becomes affiliate communication

A conversation becomes affiliate-regulated communication when one or more of the following occurs:

A. Referral tool use

The affiliate shares:

- a referral link,
- a referral code,
- a tracked invitation path,
- or another attribution mechanism tied to the affiliate.

B. Call-to-action behavior

The affiliate encourages the other person to take an action such as:

- sign up,
- join through the affiliate,
- click the affiliate's link,
- use the affiliate's code,
- review a specific offering through the affiliate path,
- or otherwise enter a referral flow.

C. Commission-related redirection

The affiliate directs the person toward POOOL in a way connected to the affiliate's compensation interest, including where the redirection is structured to preserve or create attribution.

D. Systematic promotional behavior

The communication is not merely personal conversation, but part of a repeated or organized pattern of promotion, such as:

- repeated private discussions with multiple people,
- repeated follow-up messages intended to generate conversions,
- or use of private conversations as a regular lead-generation channel.

E. Advisory or sales conduct

The affiliate goes beyond personal/general conversation and begins:

- recommending an asset,
- advising the person what to do,
- persuading the person to invest,
- handling objections,
- or otherwise engaging in prohibited advisory or sales conduct.

Once any of the above occurs, the communication must be treated as affiliate communication and must comply fully with all applicable POOOL affiliate rules, disclosures, and prohibitions.

4. Profile-link and later-discovery rule

The mere fact that an affiliate has a referral link somewhere on a profile does **not automatically** convert every earlier or unrelated private conversation into affiliate communication.

However, a conversation should be treated as affiliate communication where:

- the affiliate intentionally uses the conversation to drive the person toward that profile or referral path,
- the affiliate relies on the later discovery of the link as part of a referral strategy,
- or the conversation and the profile placement are functionally connected as part of a promotional flow.

Practical meaning:

- **incidental later discovery alone** does not automatically reclassify the earlier conversation;
- **intentional or structured redirection** does.

5. Story / profile / indirect CTA rule

Affiliate communication can exist even if the link is not placed in the same message, post, or conversation, if the overall behavior includes a referral-oriented call to action.

Examples:

- "Check my profile for the link."
- "I posted the signup link in my story."
- "You can find my referral code in my bio."
- "Look at my latest story if you want to join."

In these cases, the absence of the direct link in the immediate message does not avoid affiliate classification. The communication is still functioning as referral communication.

6. No loophole rule

An affiliate may not avoid classification as affiliate communication by:

- separating the conversation and the link in time,
- using indirect wording instead of a direct link,
- sending people to a bio, profile, or story instead of sharing the link directly,
- using disappearing messages or voice notes,
- asking another person to send the link,
- or pretending the conversation is "just personal" while using it in substance as a referral or conversion path.

The test is based on the **substance and function** of the interaction, not only on whether a link was pasted in the same message.

7. Practical enforcement standard

For operational purposes, POOOL should apply the following enforcement standard:

A conversation should remain outside affiliate regulation only where it is genuinely:

- personal,
- non-systematic,
- non-promotional,
- non-advisory,
- and not used to generate attributable referral activity.

If there is evidence that the conversation is being used as part of a referral or conversion flow, it should be treated as affiliate communication.

8. Result of reclassification

Once a conversation is classified as affiliate communication:

- the affiliate conduct rules apply in full,
- permitted and prohibited activity standards apply,
- disclosure requirements apply where relevant,
- monitoring and enforcement rules apply,
- and the conversation may be reviewed as part of moderation, payout, complaint, or breach handling.

9. Interpretation rule

Where there is uncertainty, POOOL should interpret borderline private conversations conservatively but proportionately:

- not every human mention of POOOL should be treated as regulated referral activity;
- but any meaningful referral, CTA, monetization, advisory, or conversion element should trigger affiliate classification.

This rule is intended as a practical compliance safeguard and should be reflected in onboarding, FAQs, moderation guidance, and investigation SOPs.
[LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

D. Short customer-facing / website-facing version

Short explanation for affiliates in plain language

You are still allowed to talk normally with family or friends about your own experience with POOOL.

A private conversation usually stays outside the affiliate rules if it is just a normal, personal, non-systematic conversation and you do **not**:

- share your referral link or code,
- tell the person to sign up through you,
- direct them to your bio, story, or profile for your referral link,
- or start advising, recommending, or pushing them.

The moment you use the conversation to drive someone into your referral path, or it starts to sound like promotion, advice, or selling, it becomes affiliate communication and all POOOL affiliate rules apply.

Simple rule:
Talking personally is allowed. Turning the conversation into a referral or sales path is not.

E. Required UI text / checkbox text / disclosure text (if relevant)

1. Affiliate onboarding acknowledgment

Checkbox text:
I understand that normal private conversations are not automatically affiliate communication, but once I use a referral link, referral code, call to action, profile/story redirect, or commission-related redirection, the communication becomes subject to all POOOL affiliate rules.

2. Help-center note

Help-center note:
A link does not have to appear in the same message for the rules to apply. If you tell someone to use your bio, profile, story, or code to join POOOL, that is affiliate communication.

3. Internal moderation note

Internal note:
Classify by substance, not form. Do not look only for pasted links. Look for CTA behavior, profile redirects, referral intent, repeated follow-up, and functional conversion activity.

F. Operational / backend / implementation notes

Practical decision tree: When does a conversation become affiliate-regulated communication?

Step 1: Is this just a normal private conversation?

Ask:

- Is the conversation informal and personal?
- Is it spontaneous rather than systematic?
- Is the affiliate simply talking about personal experience or POOOL in general terms?
- Is there no referral link, code, CTA, or monetized redirection?

If **yes**, treat it as **normal private conversation** for now.

If **no**, go to Step 2.

Step 2: Is any referral mechanism being used?

Ask:

- Did the affiliate share a referral link?
- Did the affiliate share a referral code?
- Did the affiliate say “use my link,” “join through me,” or similar?
- Did the affiliate direct the person to the affiliate’s bio, story, profile, or other place containing the link?

If **yes**, classify as **affiliate communication**.

If **no**, go to Step 3.

Step 3: Is there a call to action or commission-related redirection?

Ask:

- Did the affiliate encourage the person to sign up, join, review, invest, or proceed through the affiliate path?
- Is the conversation being used to generate a referral conversion?
- Is the affiliate preserving attribution or trying to do so?

If **yes**, classify as **affiliate communication**.

If **no**, go to Step 4.

Step 4: Is the behavior systematic or promotional?

Ask:

- Is the affiliate doing this repeatedly with multiple people?
- Is the affiliate following up to create conversions?
- Is the affiliate using private chats as a regular lead channel?

If **yes**, classify as **affiliate communication**.

If **no**, go to Step 5.

Step 5: Has the conversation crossed into advice or sales?

Ask:

- Did the affiliate recommend a specific asset?
- Did the affiliate give personal investment advice?
- Did the affiliate start persuading, handling objections, or pushing action?

If **yes**, classify as **affiliate communication** and likely also as a **potential breach**.

If **no**, the conversation may remain **normal private conversation**, subject to further facts.

Examples for clarity and enforcement

1. Family conversation — allowed private conversation

Example:
At dinner, an affiliate says: “I’ve been looking at POOOL recently. It’s interesting.”
No link, no code, no CTA, no recommendation.

Classification:
Normal private conversation.

---

2. Family conversation + later direct link — affiliate communication

Example:
At dinner, the affiliate explains POOOL casually. Later that night, the affiliate sends: “Here’s my referral link if you want to check it out.”

Classification:
Affiliate communication from the moment the referral link is sent.

---

3. Friend asks casually, no CTA — usually still private

Example:
A friend asks: “What is POOOL?”
The affiliate answers: “It’s a platform where you can review official opportunities and documents.”
No link, no code, no CTA, no recommendation.

Classification:
Usually normal private conversation.

---

4. Friend asks casually, then gets directed to the affiliate path — affiliate communication

Example:
The affiliate says: “Check my bio, my link is there.”
Or: “I put the signup link in my story.”

Classification:
Affiliate communication.

---

5. Story without sales language, but with referral link — affiliate communication

Example:
Story text: “Want to explore POOOL? Link in story.”
Even if factual and compliant, it is still referral communication because it uses a referral path and CTA.

Classification:
Affiliate communication, subject to affiliate rules.

---

6. Public profile contains referral link, but no intentional redirection — not automatically enough

Example:
An affiliate has a referral link in bio. Earlier, the affiliate had a normal private conversation with a

friend about POOOL but never mentioned the bio, link, story, or joining through them. Two days later, the friend independently checks the profile and finds the link.

Classification:
The earlier conversation does not automatically become affiliate communication solely because the link existed on the profile.
However, attribution, intent, and surrounding facts should still be reviewed operationally.

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7. Public profile contains referral link and the affiliate intentionally relies on it — affiliate communication

Example:
The affiliate says: “You can find everything on my profile.”
The affiliate knows the referral link is there and intends the person to use it.

Classification:
Affiliate communication.

---

8. Private chat with repeated follow-up — affiliate communication

Example:
An affiliate messages a friend several times: “Did you sign up yet?” “Use my code.” “This is a good time to join.”

Classification:
Affiliate communication. Depending on wording, possibly sales-oriented conduct.

---

9. Private chat with recommendation — affiliate communication and likely breach

Example:
“Use my link and buy this villa first. It’s the best one and you’ll make money.”

Classification:
Affiliate communication plus prohibited advisory/sales conduct.

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10. Inbound interest answered carefully — may become affiliate communication if referral path is used

Example:
A friend asks for more info. The affiliate replies: “You can review the official information here,” and sends their referral link.

Classification:
Affiliate communication. Allowed only if the wording remains compliant and non-advisory.

Manager / compliance enforcement notes

- Moderation should not rely only on direct-link detection.
- Review should consider:
    - timing,
    - sequence,
    - CTA behavior,
    - bio/story/profile redirects,
    - repeated private follow-up,
    - affiliate intent,
    - and whether the conversation was used as a monetized referral path.
- Internal incident review should record whether the issue involves:
    - innocent personal conversation,
    - compliant affiliate communication,
    - or affiliate communication that also crossed into prohibited conduct.
- Training should include before/after examples showing when a harmless conversation becomes regulated communication.

G. Open legal-review items

- Whether the safe-harbor definition should be narrowed further in the written Affiliate Terms to reduce ambiguity around repeated one-to-one discussions.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]
- Whether “systematic” should be defined by volume, frequency, or intent in internal enforcement guidelines.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]
- Whether profile-link attribution rules require a more explicit contractual presumption for enforcement purposes.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

- Whether inbound private conversations should carry any additional disclosure requirement once a referral link is introduced.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]
- Whether the “later discovery of a link” fact pattern should be addressed explicitly in the payout attribution policy as well as in conduct rules.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

H. Final recommended version

Use the following as the core safe-harbor rule:

> **Normal private, non-systematic conversations about personal experience with POOOL are not automatically treated as affiliate communication. However, once an affiliate uses a referral link, referral code, call to action, profile/story redirect, commission-related redirection, systematic promotional behavior, or any advisory/sales conduct, the communication becomes affiliate-regulated communication and must comply fully with all POOOL affiliate rules. Classification depends on the substance and function of the interaction, not only on whether a link appears in the same message.**

Point 6: Structure of the Tier System

A. Objective of this point

Define the formal structure of the POOOL affiliate tier system so that it can reward compliant affiliate performance **without** drifting into MLM, network-marketing, or recruitment-based compensation logic.

This point establishes:

- the legal/compliance shape of the tier model,
- the single-level-only rule,
- the prohibition on downlines and recruitment earnings,
- and the operational/product structure required to keep the system clean.

B. Key assumptions

- The approved baseline in this chat is the binding source of truth.
- POOOL intends to use an **8-tier** affiliate status system in Phase 1.
- Tier progression is based only on the affiliate's **own qualified referral volume** within a defined measurement period.
- The tier system is a **single-level** structure only.
- No MLM, no downlines, no recruitment commissions, and no override commissions are permitted.
- This draft is prepared to legal-review standard and is not legally final.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

C. Full internal/professional draft

POOOL Affiliate Program

Tier Structure Rule

Phase 1

1. Core rule

POOOL may operate an internal affiliate tier system in Phase 1, provided that the tier system is structured and enforced as a **single-level, direct-referral-only** model.

The purpose of the tier system is to:

- recognize compliant affiliate performance,
- differentiate commission status based on the affiliate's own qualified referral volume,
- and support program administration, incentives, and performance tracking,

without creating any recruitment-based, team-based, or multi-level compensation structure.

2. Single-level-only principle

The POOOL tier system must operate on a **single-level-only** basis.

This means:

- an affiliate may progress in tier only through the affiliate's **own qualified direct referrals**;
- an affiliate may earn only from the affiliate's **own qualified direct referrals**;
- no affiliate may earn based on the activity, volume, or conversions of another affiliate;
- no affiliate may sponsor, manage, or build a subordinate affiliate structure for compensation purposes;
- no tier benefit may depend on recruiting, onboarding, or activating additional affiliates.

3. No MLM / no downline / no recruitment model

The POOOL tier system is **not** an MLM, network-marketing, or pyramid-style structure.

Accordingly, the following are prohibited:

- downlines,
- uplines,
- team structures for commission purposes,
- recruitment earnings,
- override commissions,
- leadership commissions tied to other affiliates,
- rank advancement through affiliate recruitment,
- bonuses for bringing in new affiliates,
- indirect earning chains,
- or any other mechanism by which one affiliate earns from another affiliate's activity.

Any attempt to recreate such structures under another label is prohibited.

4. Tier logic basis

Tier position may be determined only by criteria tied to the affiliate's **own qualified referral performance**, as defined in the relevant qualification and payout rules.

Permitted tier criteria may include, for example:

- the affiliate's own qualified referral volume,
- the affiliate's own number of qualified referrals,
- the affiliate's own compliant activity history,
- and other non-recruitment criteria approved by POOOL.

Tier advancement must not be based on:

- number of recruited affiliates,
- activity of friends, team members, or sub-affiliates,
- number of affiliate signups generated,
- "network volume,"
- "group volume,"
- "team production,"
- or any equivalent indirect-performance concept.

5. Separation between status and structure

The existence of multiple tiers does not change the structural classification of the program, provided that all tiers remain anchored solely to direct qualified referral performance.

Multiple tiers are permitted internally only as a **performance ladder**, not as a network hierarchy.

Affiliates in higher tiers must not receive:

- supervisory rights over lower-tier affiliates,
- economic participation in lower-tier affiliates' referrals,
- recruiting authority tied to compensation,
- or management-style rights that effectively create an upline/downline structure.

6. No affiliate-to-affiliate compensation chain

No affiliate may receive compensation, credit, points, tier benefit, or ranking advantage because:

- another affiliate joined through them,
- another affiliate performed well,
- another affiliate generated qualified referrals,
- or another affiliate remained active.

Affiliate-to-affiliate referral relationships, if ever tracked operationally for non-compensation reasons, must not affect payouts, tier progression, or economic rights.
[LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

7. Naming and presentation rule

The tier system must be described and presented as:

- a **direct referral performance tier system**,
- a **status ladder** based on the affiliate's own results,
- or similar language that does not imply network growth, team-building, or recruitment-based income.

Product, marketing, onboarding, and support materials must not use terminology such as:

- build your team,
- recruit others,
- grow your network,
- earn from your referrals' referrals,
- unlock leadership income,
- override income,
- passive team income,
- or similar MLM-style concepts.

8. Enforcement rule

If any proposed tier feature, promotion, dashboard element, incentive, or affiliate communication suggests or enables:

- team-building,
- sub-affiliate monetization,
- recruitment rewards,
- override commissions,
- or indirect earnings,

that feature must not be launched in Phase 1 and must be escalated for compliance and legal review.
[LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

D. Short customer-facing / website-facing version

Short internal explanation of why the structure is single-level only

The tier system is single-level only because POOOL wants a **performance-based referral model**, not a network-marketing structure.

Affiliates may move up based only on their **own qualified referrals**. They do not earn from recruiting other affiliates, from team volume, or from any downline activity.

This keeps the system aligned with the Phase 1 referral-only model and prevents the tier structure from turning into MLM-style compensation.

E. Required UI text / checkbox text / disclosure text (if relevant)

1. Affiliate onboarding acknowledgment

Checkbox text:
I understand that the POOOL tier system is single-level only. I may progress and earn only based on my own qualified direct referrals. I may not earn from recruiting affiliates, downlines, team volume, or override commissions.

2. Internal FAQ / manager notice

Notice:
The tier system is a direct-referral performance ladder only. It is not a team structure and must not be used to create network income, upline/downline logic, or recruitment incentives.

3. Dashboard compliance notice

Notice:
Your tier reflects only your own qualified referral performance. No team-based, downline-based, or recruitment-based earnings are available in Phase 1.

F. Operational / backend / implementation notes

Implementation notes for product / engineering

1. Compensation architecture

The system should support **one-layer attribution only**:

- Affiliate → qualified referred user
- No second-layer payout logic
- No third-layer payout logic
- No tree-based compensation engine
- No network commission tables

2. Data model constraints

Product and engineering should not create data structures that imply or support:

- upline fields for compensation,
- downline trees,
- group volume,
- team volume,
- override percentages,
- sponsor bonuses,
- leadership pools tied to subordinate activity,
- recursive referral payout logic.

If affiliate-to-affiliate relationships are stored for operational reasons, they must be clearly marked as **non-compensation, non-tier, non-payout relevant**.

3. Tier calculation logic

Tier status should be calculated only from approved direct-performance inputs, such as:

- own qualified referral count,
- own qualified referral volume,
- own compliant status,
- own review-period-cleared conversions.

Tier calculation must exclude:

- recruited-affiliate count,
- indirect conversions,
- network volume,
- group metrics,
- team activity,
- cross-account hierarchy metrics.

4. UI / dashboard restrictions

The affiliate UI must not display:

- team tabs,

- downline tabs,
- network trees,
- sponsor relationships,
- group sales,
- team commission widgets,
- “people you recruited” earnings,
- or any MLM-style visual hierarchy.

Permitted UI concepts include:

- Your referrals
- Your qualified referrals
- Your tier
- Your payout status
- Your qualified referral volume

5. Language controls

System copy, marketing copy, and in-product labels should prohibit MLM-style language. Avoid terms such as:

- team,
- upline,
- downline,
- recruit,
- sponsor,
- network income,
- override,
- leadership bonus,
- passive affiliate income from others.

Use neutral terms instead:

- direct referral,
- qualified referral,
- own referral volume,
- status tier,
- direct commission rate.

6. Rules engine / abuse controls

Engineering should support monitoring for attempts to simulate multi-level behavior, including:

- affiliate recruitment campaigns framed as income opportunities,
- unusual cross-affiliate linking patterns,

- attempts to transfer or split attribution,
- affiliate rings designed to mimic team structures,
- manual payout requests tied to another affiliate's activity.

7. Future-proofing

If POOOL ever considers affiliate recruitment, partner hierarchies, or indirect commissions in a later phase, that must be treated as a **new model**, not as a minor feature expansion. It would require separate legal, compliance, product, contractual, and tax review.
[LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

G. Open legal-review items

- Whether affiliate-to-affiliate introductions should be prohibited entirely in Phase 1, even where no compensation is attached.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]
- Whether the internal tier names and commission ladder should be reviewed together with this rule to ensure presentation does not imply network marketing.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]
- Whether any additional contractual language is needed to expressly disclaim direct-selling, MLM, or recruitment-based compensation treatment.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]
- Whether certain UI terms such as "leaderboard" or "rank" should be restricted if they create the wrong structural impression.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

H. Final recommended version

Use the following as the formal tier-structure statement:

> **The POOOL affiliate tier system is a single-level, direct-referral-only performance ladder. Affiliates may progress in tier and earn commissions only from their own qualified direct referrals. No MLM, no downlines, no recruitment earnings, no override commissions, no team volume, and no indirect affiliate income are permitted. The tier system exists solely to recognize and price direct referral performance and must not be structured, presented, or implemented as a network-marketing model.**

Point 7: 8-Tier Ladder and Unlock Logic

A. Objective of this point

Define the formal 8-tier affiliate ladder for POOOL Phase 1, including:

- the tier names,
- the commission percentages,
- the unlock logic,
- the lookback-based qualification rule,
- and the structural safeguards that prevent the tier model from turning into self-funded, fee-based, or recruitment-based access.

B. Key assumptions

- The approved baseline in this chat is the binding source of truth.
- The approved tier names and percentages are:
    - Access — 0.50%
    - Plus — 0.75%
    - Pro — 1.00%
    - Elite — 1.50%
    - Premium — 2.00%
    - Platinum — 2.75%
    - Signature — 3.50%
    - Sovereign — 4.50%
- The baseline requires that tier unlock must be based only on the affiliate's **own qualified referral volume**.
- The baseline states that the measurement period should be a defined lookback period, with **12 months** as the working model example.
  Assumption for this draft: unless POOOL later approves another period in writing, the default lookback period is a **rolling 12-month lookback**.
- The baseline does **not** yet define the exact monetary or volume thresholds for each tier. Therefore, this draft includes the structure and placeholders for threshold insertion rather than invented numbers.
- This draft is prepared to legal-review standard and is not legally final.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

C. Full internal/professional draft

POOOL Affiliate Program

Tier Schedule & Unlock Logic

Phase 1

1. Core rule

POOOL shall operate an 8-tier affiliate ladder in Phase 1 as a **single-level, direct-referral-only** performance structure.

Tier status determines the affiliate's applicable commission level under the approved payout model, subject always to:

- qualified referral status,
- applicable holdback/review rules,
- compliance status,
- payout eligibility,
- and any other approved conditions in the Qualified Referral & Payout Policy.

2. Approved tier schedule

The Phase 1 tier ladder shall be:

Tier	Commission Rate
Access	0.50%
Plus	0.75%
Pro	1.00%
Elite	1.50%

Premium	2.00%
Platinum	2.75%
Signature	3.50%
Sovereign	4.50%

These percentages apply only within the approved affiliate program framework and do not create any right to payment outside the applicable qualification, holdback, tax, and compliance rules.

3. Unlock basis

A tier may be unlocked only by the affiliate's **own qualified referral volume** achieved within the defined lookback period.

For this purpose:

- "own" means attributable only to that affiliate's direct referrals;
- "qualified referral volume" means only volume that satisfies POOOL's separate qualified-referral requirements;
- no indirect, recruited, team-based, or network-based volume may count.

4. Default lookback period

Unless and until POOOL formally adopts another period in writing, tier unlock shall be measured over a **rolling 12-month lookback period**.

This means:

- on each calculation date, the system reviews the affiliate's own qualified referral volume generated during the immediately preceding 12 months;
- the affiliate's current tier is the highest tier for which the required threshold has been met within that rolling period;
- expired volume falling outside the rolling period no longer counts toward tier qualification.

5. Threshold schedule structure

Because the approved baseline does not yet set exact unlock thresholds, the tier ladder should be implemented using the following approved structure template:

Tier	Commission Rate	Unlock Requirement
Access	0.50%	Base entry tier / approved affiliate status
Plus	0.75%	Own qualified referral volume ≥ [Threshold 1] during rolling 12-month lookback
Pro	1.00%	Own qualified referral volume ≥ [Threshold 2] during rolling 12-month lookback
Elite	1.50%	Own qualified referral volume ≥ [Threshold 3] during rolling 12-month lookback
Premium	2.00%	Own qualified referral volume ≥ [Threshold 4] during rolling 12-month lookback
Platinum	2.75%	Own qualified referral volume ≥ [Threshold 5] during rolling 12-month lookback
Signature	3.50%	Own qualified referral volume ≥ [Threshold 6] during rolling 12-month lookback
Sovereign	4.50%	Own qualified referral volume ≥ [Threshold 7] during rolling 12-month lookback

The final threshold amounts must be approved separately and inserted into the schedule before live deployment.
[LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

6. Entry-tier logic

Upon successful onboarding and activation, an approved affiliate enters the program at the **Access** tier unless POOOL formally approves another entry rule in writing.

Access is the base participation tier and does not require:

- self-purchase,
- entry payment,
- recruited affiliates,
- team creation,
- or any paid upgrade mechanism.

7. No alternate unlock routes

No tier may be unlocked, accelerated, preserved, or upgraded through:

- self-purchase,
- self-referral,
- entry fee,
- membership fee,
- subscription payment intended to unlock tier status,
- purchase of internal status packages,
- recruiting sub-affiliates,
- affiliate sign-up counts,
- team volume,
- downline activity,
- override logic,
- manual side arrangements,
- or discretionary commercial deals outside the approved rules.

Tier unlock must come only from the affiliate's own qualified referral volume within the applicable lookback period.

8. No recruitment-based progression

An affiliate must not receive:

- a higher tier,
- faster tier progression,
- protected tier status,

- or additional commission percentage

because the affiliate:

- recruited another affiliate,
- introduced another affiliate applicant,
- manages a community of affiliates,
- or caused other affiliates to generate referrals.

Affiliate recruitment, if ever permitted in a later model for non-compensation purposes, must remain entirely separate from tier unlock and payout logic.
[LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

9. Qualification integrity rule

Only volume that qualifies under POOOL's approved qualification rules may count toward tier unlock.

Volume must be excluded from tier calculations where:

- attribution is invalid,
- KYC is incomplete,
- the first investment was not completed,
- the review/holdback period has not cleared,
- fraud or abuse flags apply,
- a policy breach affects the referral,
- self-referral is detected,
- or a prohibited referral ring or manipulation pattern exists.

10. Recalculation logic

Tier status should be recalculated on a defined recurring basis, for example:

- daily,
- weekly,
- or at another approved system interval,

using the same rolling lookback methodology for all affiliates.

Any recalculation standard adopted by product/operations must be:

- consistent,
- auditable,
- and applied equally across the program.

11. Interpretation rule

The 8-tier ladder is a **performance schedule**, not a recruitment hierarchy.

All documents, dashboards, onboarding materials, and internal communications must present it as:

- a direct-referral ladder,
- based only on the affiliate's own qualified performance,
- with no MLM, no downlines, no recruitment earnings, and no override commissions.

D. Short customer-facing / website-facing version

Short affiliate-facing explanation of the 8 tiers and percentages

POOOL uses an 8-tier affiliate ladder:

- Access — 0.50%
- Plus — 0.75%
- Pro — 1.00%
- Elite — 1.50%
- Premium — 2.00%
- Platinum — 2.75%
- Signature — 3.50%
- Sovereign — 4.50%

Your tier is based only on your **own qualified referral volume** during the defined lookback period.

You do **not** unlock tiers by paying a fee, buying through yourself, or recruiting other affiliates.

Simple rule:
Your own qualified referrals unlock your tier. Nothing else does.

E. Required UI text / checkbox text / disclosure text (if relevant)

1. Affiliate onboarding acknowledgment

Checkbox text:
I understand that tier unlock is based only on my own qualified referral volume during the

applicable lookback period. I may not unlock or improve my tier through self-purchase, self-referral, entry fees, recruiting sub-affiliates, team volume, or override structures.

2. Dashboard explanatory note

Note:
Your current tier is calculated from your own qualified referral volume within the rolling lookback period. Only cleared and eligible qualified volume counts.

3. Website / help-center note

Note:
POOOL's tier system is performance-based and single-level only. Tiers are not purchased and are not unlocked by recruiting other affiliates.

F. Operational / backend / implementation notes

Clean presentation format for website / dashboard

1. Website presentation format

Use a clean two-part layout:

Section 1: "How Tiers Work"

Short explainer:

- 8 tiers
- each tier has a commission percentage
- unlocks are based only on own qualified referral volume
- no MLM, no downlines, no purchased upgrades

Section 2: Tier table

Recommended display:

Tier	Commission	Unlock Basis

Access	0.50%	Entry tier for approved affiliates
Plus	0.75%	Own qualified referral volume threshold
Pro	1.00%	Own qualified referral volume threshold
Elite	1.50%	Own qualified referral volume threshold
Premium	2.00%	Own qualified referral volume threshold
Platinum	2.75%	Own qualified referral volume threshold
Signature	3.50%	Own qualified referral volume threshold
Sovereign	4.50%	Own qualified referral volume threshold

Once threshold values are finalized, replace the generic phrase with the actual threshold numbers.

2. Dashboard presentation format

Recommended dashboard modules:

A. Current Tier Card

Display:

- Current tier
- Current commission rate
- Qualified referral volume counted
- Lookback period label
- Compliance / payout status if relevant

B. Progress to Next Tier

Display:

- next tier name,
- next commission rate,
- volume needed to unlock,
- progress bar,
- excluded/pending volume shown separately if needed.

C. Tier Ladder View

Vertical or horizontal ladder with:

- unlocked tiers,
- current tier highlighted,
- next tier emphasized,
- locked tiers grayed out.

3. Product calculation notes

- Store tier thresholds as configurable rule values, not hard-coded copy.
- Separate:
  - pending volume,
  - qualified cleared volume,
  - excluded volume,
  - fraud-blocked volume.
- Use only **qualified cleared volume within the rolling lookback period** for unlock logic.
- Ensure self-referrals and disallowed volume sources are technically excluded from tier calculations.
- Do not show any team, network, sponsor, or indirect affiliate metrics.
- Maintain an audit trail for:
  - tier change date,
  - triggering qualified volume,
  - excluded volume reasons,
  - and manual adjustments if ever allowed under internal controls.

4. Compliance language controls

Avoid phrases such as:

- unlock by inviting others,
- build your team,
- recruit to rank up,
- leadership tier,

- network growth,
- passive downline earnings.

Use only neutral terms such as:

- own qualified referral volume,
- rolling lookback period,
- current tier,
- next unlock threshold,
- direct commission rate.

G. Open legal-review items

- Final approval of the exact unlock thresholds for each tier.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]
- Confirmation that a rolling 12-month lookback is the approved commercial and legal model for launch.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]
- Confirmation of recalculation frequency and any downgrade/maintenance mechanics.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]
- Review of how tier percentages should interact with holdbacks, clawbacks, post-clearance adjustments, and tax withholding.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]
- Confirmation that Access as the default onboarding tier is the intended launch structure.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

H. Final recommended version

Use the following as the formal rule:

> **POOOL operates an 8-tier affiliate ladder consisting of Access (0.50%), Plus (0.75%), Pro (1.00%), Elite (1.50%), Premium (2.00%), Platinum (2.75%), Signature (3.50%), and Sovereign (4.50%). A tier may be unlocked only through the affiliate's own qualified referral volume achieved within the applicable lookback period, which for launch is assumed to be a rolling 12-month period unless otherwise approved in writing. No tier may be unlocked, accelerated, preserved, or improved through self-purchase, self-referral, entry fees, recruiting sub-affiliates, team volume, downlines, or override commissions. The ladder is a direct-referral performance schedule only and must be presented and implemented accordingly.**

Point 8: Definition of a Qualified Referral

A. Objective of this point

Define exactly when a referred user becomes a **Qualified Referral** for POOOL Phase 1, so that:

- affiliates know when commission eligibility actually arises,
- finance and operations know when commission may become payable,
- product and engineering know what must be tracked,
- and compliance has a clear basis for fraud prevention, reversals, clawbacks, and payout control.

This point is intended to prevent the affiliate program from paying on:

- mere clicks,
- incomplete registrations,
- unverified users,
- unpaid investments,
- manipulated referrals,
- self-referrals,
- referral rings,
- or transactions that later reverse or fail review.

B. Key assumptions

- The approved baseline in this chat is the binding source of truth.
- A referral is not qualified merely because a user clicked a link or registered.
- The baseline requires, at minimum, that a Qualified Referral must have:
    - valid attribution through the affiliate's link/code,
    - completed KYC,

    - completed first paid investment,
    - cleared internal review period,
    - and no fraud flag or policy breach.
- The approved baseline also supports additional anti-abuse logic, including:
    - holdback before payout,
    - no self-referral,
    - no referral rings,
    - no payout where misconduct or reversal exists.
- The baseline mentioned a **30-day holdback** as a sensible control.
  Assumption for this draft: unless POOOL later approves another period in writing, the default operational model is a **30-day holdback after the qualifying paid investment event**.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]
- The baseline mentioned that a **minimum investment threshold** may be used, but no amount has yet been approved. This draft therefore includes a placeholder rule rather than inventing a number.

C. Full internal/professional draft

POOOL Affiliate Program

Qualified Referral Definition & Qualification Rule

Phase 1

1. Core rule

A referral becomes a **Qualified Referral** only when all required qualification conditions have been satisfied, all applicable review checks have cleared, and the referral remains eligible under POOOL's anti-fraud, reversal, policy, and payout rules.

No affiliate commission is earned, vested, payable, or considered final merely because:

- a referral link was clicked,
- a user account was created,
- KYC was started,
- KYC was completed,
- a deposit was attempted,
- or an investment order was initiated.

Commission eligibility arises only when the referral meets the full Qualified Referral standard.

2. Formal definition

A **Qualified Referral** means a referred user who:

1. was validly attributed to the affiliate under POOOL's approved attribution rules;
2. completed all required onboarding and KYC requirements;
3. completed a first eligible paid investment through approved POOOL payment/investment flows;
4. satisfied any approved minimum-investment requirement, if such requirement is adopted by POOOL;
5. completed the applicable review and holdback period without disqualifying event;
6. is not subject to reversal, chargeback, refund, cancellation, fraud flag, self-referral restriction, referral-ring restriction, or policy-breach disqualification;
7. remains eligible for payout treatment under POOOL's affiliate, compliance, finance, tax, and operational controls.

Only after all of the above are satisfied may the related commission move into payable status.

3. Qualification stages

For internal control purposes, POOOL should treat referral status as a staged sequence:

A. Referred

The user has been attributed to the affiliate through a valid referral mechanism.

B. Registered

The user has created an account or entered the official onboarding flow.

C. KYC-completed

The user has successfully completed required identity verification.

D. First paid investment completed

The user has completed the first eligible paid investment through official POOOL flows.

E. Under review / holdback

The referral is provisionally tracked but not yet commission-payable.

F. Qualified Referral

All qualification conditions have cleared and no disqualifying event applies.

G. Payable

The commission has passed finance/compliance gating and is approved for payout in the next payout cycle.

A referral must not be treated as "qualified" or "payable" before the required stage is reached.

4. Attribution rule

A referral counts only if it is validly attributable to the affiliate under POOOL's approved attribution system.

Attribution must be:

- technically recorded,
- internally verifiable,
- tied to an approved referral link/code/path,
- and not overridden by fraud, manipulation, or policy-breach findings.

Invalid, missing, disputed, or manipulated attribution disqualifies the referral unless resolved through approved exception handling.
[LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

5. KYC rule

The referred user must complete all required KYC and identity-verification steps successfully.

Incomplete, failed, rejected, or unresolved KYC means the referral is not qualified.

6. First paid investment rule

The referred user must complete a first eligible paid investment.

For this purpose:

- the investment must actually be paid,
- the payment/investment must settle through official POOOL channels,
- and the transaction must not be merely initiated, pending indefinitely, or technically incomplete.

If POOOL adopts an eligible minimum-investment threshold, only investments meeting or exceeding that threshold may count for qualification.
[LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

7. Holdback and review rule

After the first eligible paid investment is completed, the referral enters a holdback/review period.

Recommended launch default:
A referral should remain in holdback for **30 days** from the qualifying paid investment event unless POOOL later approves a different period in writing.
[LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

During holdback:

- commission is provisional only,
- no payout is due,
- the referral remains subject to fraud review, reversal review, policy review, and attribution review,
- and the referral may still be disqualified.

8. Anti-fraud and abuse rule

A referral is not qualified, or ceases to remain qualified, where fraud, abuse, manipulation, or bad-faith conduct is detected.

This includes, without limitation:

- fake accounts,
- synthetic or stolen identity use,
- fabricated onboarding activity,
- manipulated attribution,
- coordinated referral abuse,
- policy evasion,
- abusive payment patterns,
- or other conduct reasonably determined by POOOL to undermine the integrity of the program.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

9. Reversal / cancellation / refund rule

A referral is not qualified, or must be reclassified out of qualified/payable status, where the underlying qualifying event is reversed or invalidated, including by:

- chargeback,
- cancellation,
- refund,
- payment failure,
- investment reversal,
- compliance rejection,
- or other unwind event affecting the qualifying paid investment.

If payout has already been made on a referral later affected by such event, the commission may be denied, offset, frozen, or clawed back under the applicable payout and enforcement rules.
[LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

10. No self-referral rule

An affiliate may not qualify, receive commission, or receive tier credit for referring themselves.

Self-referral includes, without limitation:

- registering through one's own referral link or code,
- using an account controlled by the affiliate,
- using a related or proxy account for the affiliate's own economic benefit,
- routing one's own investment activity through one's referral path,
- or otherwise causing one's own activity to appear as third-party referral activity.

Any self-referral is disqualified and may trigger additional enforcement action.

11. No referral-ring rule

An affiliate may not participate in any referral ring, reciprocal referral arrangement, circular referral pattern, or other coordinated conduct intended to manufacture commission eligibility, tier credit, or payout rights.

Examples include:

- two or more affiliates referring each other or each other's controlled persons,
- coordinated household/account routing,
- circular sign-up structures,
- reciprocal attribution swaps,
- or any pattern designed to simulate genuine third-party referrals.

POOOL may disqualify affected referrals, freeze related payouts, and escalate the matter for investigation.
[LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

12. Policy-breach exclusion rule

A referral is not qualified if the referral arose from affiliate conduct that violated the program rules, including where the affiliate used:

- prohibited advisory conduct,
- asset recommendations,
- guarantees,
- private cold outreach,

- side deals,
- payment handling,
- unapproved materials,
- or any other prohibited activity.

Even if the referred user completed KYC and invested, a referral sourced through material policy breach may be excluded from qualification and payout.

13. Commission-payable rule

Commission becomes **payable** only when all of the following are true:

- the referral is recorded as validly attributed,
- KYC is complete and approved,
- the first eligible paid investment is completed,
- any minimum-investment rule is satisfied, if applicable,
- the holdback/review period has expired,
- no reversal, refund, cancellation, or chargeback applies,
- no fraud, self-referral, referral-ring, or policy-breach flag remains unresolved,
- the referral has been approved under finance/compliance payout controls,
- and the affiliate has satisfied applicable payout, tax, and account-status requirements.

Until then, the commission is provisional only and may be withheld, denied, or removed.

14. Burden of proof / system-of-record rule

POOOL's internal systems of record govern whether a referral is treated as:

- referred,
- pending,
- under review,
- qualified,
- payable,
- disqualified,
- reversed,
- or clawback-affected.

Where referral status is disputed, payout may be paused pending investigation and resolution under the applicable SOP.
[LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

D. Short customer-facing / website-facing version

Short customer / affiliate-facing explanation

A referral counts for commission only when it becomes a **Qualified Referral**.

That means the referred user must:

- be correctly linked to your referral,
- complete KYC,
- complete a first eligible paid investment,
- pass the review/holdback period,
- and have no fraud, reversal, self-referral, referral-ring, or policy-breach issue.

A click, signup, or incomplete onboarding is **not enough**.

Simple rule:
Commission becomes payable only after the referral is verified, invested, cleared, and still eligible after review.

E. Required UI text / checkbox text / disclosure text (if relevant)

Qualification checklist

Qualified Referral checklist

A referral is treated as qualified only if all boxes below are true:

1. **Valid attribution**
   - The user was correctly tracked through the affiliate's approved referral link/code/path.
2. **Eligible onboarding completed**
   - The user completed registration and all required onboarding steps.
3. **KYC approved**
   - The user successfully completed required identity verification.
4. **First eligible paid investment completed**
   - The user completed a first paid investment through official POOOL flows.
5. **Minimum investment rule satisfied**
   - The investment met the approved minimum threshold, if POOOL adopts one.
   - Placeholder until finalized.
     [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]
6. **Holdback/review period cleared**
   - The applicable review period expired without disqualifying event.
7. **No reversal or payment unwind**

    - No refund, chargeback, cancellation, failed settlement, or reversal applies.
8. **No fraud or abuse flag**
    - No unresolved fraud, manipulation, fake-account, or policy-evasion issue applies.
9. **No self-referral**
    - The referral is not the affiliate's own account, controlled account, or self-benefit structure.
10. **No referral ring / coordinated abuse**
    - The referral is not part of a reciprocal, circular, or coordinated abuse pattern.
11. **No sourcing through prohibited conduct**
    - The referral was not generated through guarantees, advice, asset recommendations, private cold outreach, payment handling, side deals, or unapproved materials.
12. **Affiliate payout eligibility active**
    - The affiliate's own account, tax, payout, and compliance status allows payment.

Only after all of the above are satisfied should the referral move to **Qualified** and then to **Payable** status.

Optional affiliate dashboard note

Note:
Your referral becomes payable only after KYC, first eligible paid investment, holdback/review clearance, and all fraud/compliance checks are passed.

Optional affiliate onboarding acknowledgment

Checkbox text:
I understand that commission is payable only for Qualified Referrals and that a referral does not qualify unless valid attribution, KYC, first eligible paid investment, review-period clearance, and all anti-fraud and policy checks are satisfied.

F. Operational / backend / implementation notes

Holdback, anti-fraud, reversal, no-self-referral, and no-referral-ring logic

1. Holdback logic

- Commission status should move from **Pending** to **Under Review/Holdback** once the first eligible paid investment is recorded.

- Default recommended holdback: **30 days** from qualifying paid investment timestamp, unless later changed by approved rule.
- No payout file should include referrals still in holdback.
- If a disqualifying event occurs during holdback, status should move to **Disqualified** or **Reversed**, not to **Qualified/Payable**.

2. Anti-fraud logic

Before commission becomes payable, the system should support:

- identity-verification status check,
- duplicate-account checks,
- device / IP / behavioral anomaly review where available,
- unusual attribution-pattern checks,
- affiliate/referral abuse flags,
- suspicious payment or funding-pattern review,
- manual investigation override where required.

Any unresolved fraud flag should block qualification and payout.

3. Reversal logic

The system should reclassify or block commission if any of the following occurs before payout:

- payment failure,
- chargeback,
- refund,
- cancellation,
- compliance rejection,
- transaction unwind,
- investment reversal,
- or administrative invalidation of the qualifying event.

If reversal occurs after payout, the system should mark the referral and commission as:

- **Post-Payout Reversal**
- and route it to offset / clawback handling.

4. No-self-referral logic

The system should detect and/or flag:

- same affiliate account and referred user identity match,
- same legal name,
- same government ID / KYC identifier,

- same payout details,
- same wallet / bank details where relevant,
- same device or persistent identifiers where appropriate,
- shared controlled-account indicators.

Confirmed self-referral should:

- exclude the referral from qualification,
- remove any tier credit,
- block payout,
- and trigger enforcement review if intentional.

5. No-referral-ring logic

The system should support detection of patterns such as:

- reciprocal referrals between affiliates,
- repeated cross-referrals among a closed group,
- circular conversion paths,
- household or related-party loops,
- shared funding or device patterns across "different" referrals,
- unusual cluster behavior inconsistent with genuine external referrals.

Suspected referral-ring activity should:

- freeze associated commission status,
- block payable conversion,
- flag related accounts for manual investigation,
- and allow tier recalculation if disqualified volume had been counted.

Backend conditions that must be logged before commission becomes payable

Before any commission moves to **Payable**, the following should be logged in the system of record:

A. Attribution data

- affiliate ID
- referral link/code ID
- attribution timestamp
- source path / campaign / channel if tracked

- attribution validity status
- dispute / override status if applicable

B. Referred user identity and onboarding status

- referred user account ID
- registration timestamp
- KYC status
- KYC approval timestamp
- onboarding completion status

C. Investment qualification data

- first eligible investment ID
- investment timestamp
- paid/settled status
- investment amount
- minimum-threshold pass/fail flag
- asset / product reference if needed for internal reporting
- payment status / settlement status

D. Review and holdback data

- holdback start timestamp
- holdback end timestamp
- review status
- fraud-review status
- compliance-review status
- manual-review flag if any

E. Disqualification controls

- reversal flag
- refund flag
- chargeback flag
- cancellation flag
- self-referral flag
- referral-ring flag
- policy-breach flag
- excluded-volume reason code
- investigation case ID if applicable

F. Commission readiness data

- provisional commission amount
- qualified status timestamp
- payable approval timestamp
- payout batch eligibility status
- payout hold / freeze flag
- affiliate payout account status
- affiliate tax status / withholding readiness
- final approved commission amount

G. Audit trail

- system event log for each status change
- user/admin action history
- manual override history
- reason codes for qualification, disqualification, or reversal
- tier-credit inclusion / exclusion record

Recommended status flow

Use a clean status sequence such as:

- Attributed
- Registered
- KYC Approved
- First Paid Investment Completed
- Under Holdback
- Qualified
- Payable
- Paid

And where necessary:

- Disqualified
- Reversed
- Frozen
- Under Investigation
- Clawback Pending

G. Open legal-review items

- Final confirmation of the launch holdback period, including whether **30 days** is the approved standard.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

- Final decision on whether an explicit minimum-investment threshold will apply and, if so, at what amount.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]
- Whether "qualified" and "payable" should be separated contractually as two distinct defined terms.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]
- Whether certain fraud flags should create automatic permanent disqualification versus manual review.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]
- Whether reversal, clawback, and payout-offset language should be mirrored word-for-word in the Affiliate Terms and Qualified Referral & Payout Policy.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]
- Whether related-party and household-account treatment should be defined more expressly in the anti-abuse rules.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

H. Final recommended version

Use the following as the formal rule:

> **A Qualified Referral is a validly attributed referred user who has completed required KYC, completed a first eligible paid investment through official POOOL flows, satisfied any approved minimum-investment rule, cleared the applicable review and holdback period, and remains free of reversal, refund, chargeback, fraud, self-referral, referral-ring, policy-breach, or other disqualifying condition. Commission becomes payable only after all required qualification, compliance, anti-fraud, and payout-control checks have been completed and logged in POOOL's system of record. Clicks, signups, incomplete onboarding, incomplete KYC, and provisional investments do not by themselves qualify a referral for commission.**

Point 9: Affiliate Onboarding

A. Objective of this point

Create a complete onboarding framework for POOOL affiliates so that no affiliate receives an active referral link until POOOL has:

- identified the person,
- collected required payout and tax data,
- obtained all required contractual and policy acknowledgements,
- completed basic compliance screening,
- and confirmed that the affiliate understands the permitted and prohibited boundaries of the program.

This point is intended to make onboarding a real control layer, not just a signup form.

B. Key assumptions

- The approved baseline in this chat is the binding source of truth.
- No affiliate should receive an active referral link before completing onboarding.
- The baseline requires, at minimum:
  - application,
  - KYC,
  - identity and payout data,
  - tax data where required,
  - acceptance of affiliate terms,
  - acceptance of code of conduct,
  - acceptance of marketing materials policy,
  - acceptance of payout/tax policy,
  - and mini-training with quiz.
- POOOL may choose manual approval in Phase 1 even if some onboarding steps are automated.
- This draft is prepared to legal-review standard and is not legally final.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

C. Full internal/professional draft

POOOL Affiliate Program

Affiliate Onboarding SOP

Phase 1

1. Purpose

This SOP governs the onboarding of all POOOL affiliates in Phase 1.

Its purpose is to ensure that no person is activated as a POOOL affiliate unless POOOL has completed the required identity, compliance, payout, tax, policy, and training checks and has recorded the required consents and approvals in the system of record.

2. Scope

This SOP applies to:

- all new affiliate applicants,
- all re-applications after rejection or removal where re-entry is permitted,
- all re-activations after suspension where retraining or refreshed acknowledgements are required,
- and any migration of legacy referrers into the controlled Phase 1 program.

3. Core onboarding rule

No affiliate link, referral code, tracking path, or commission eligibility may be activated until all required onboarding steps have been completed and approved.

Until then, the applicant may be treated only as:

- applicant,
- pending review,
- pending documents,
- pending KYC,
- pending training,
- pending approval,
- or rejected,

but not as an active affiliate.

4. Onboarding stages

Stage 1 — Application intake

The applicant submits an affiliate application through the approved POOOL onboarding flow.

The application should collect at minimum:

- full legal name,
- contact details,
- country / jurisdiction information,
- applicant type classification, if relevant for payout/tax handling,
- intended promotion channels,
- basic description of how the applicant plans to promote POOOL,
- acknowledgment that participation is subject to approval only.

The application must also include a preliminary declaration that the applicant understands the program is referral-only and not an advisory or sales role.

Stage 2 — Identity and KYC review

Before activation, the applicant must complete required identity verification and KYC checks.

KYC review should confirm, as applicable:

- identity verification completion,
- document sufficiency,
- consistency of submitted information,
- and any required internal compliance screening.

Applicants with incomplete, failed, or unresolved KYC must not proceed to activation.

Stage 3 — Payout and tax setup

Before link activation, the applicant must submit required payout and tax information.

This should include, as applicable:

- payout name,
- payout method details,
- tax classification details,
- required taxpayer information,
- residency / entity status information where relevant,
- and any documents or declarations needed for withholding and reporting workflows.

No link should be activated if payout/tax setup is incomplete where such setup is required for lawful payout processing.

Stage 4 — Contract and policy acceptance

Before activation, the applicant must affirmatively accept all required program documents.

At minimum, the applicant must accept:

1. Affiliate Terms & Conditions
2. Affiliate Code of Conduct
3. Approved Marketing Materials Policy
4. Qualified Referral & Payout Policy
5. Tax / payout acknowledgment or related payout policy text
6. Affiliate Privacy Notice

Acceptance must be:

- explicit,
- timestamped,
- version-linked,
- and stored in a retrievable record.

Stage 5 — Mandatory onboarding disclosures and acknowledgements

Before activation, the applicant must acknowledge the core operating boundaries of the program.

At minimum, the applicant must confirm that they understand:

- the program is referral-only,
- they may use only approved materials and official POOOL pages,
- they may not provide personal investment advice,
- they may not recommend specific assets,
- they may not promise returns,
- they may not do private cold outreach,
- they may not negotiate or close,
- they may not handle payments or funds,
- qualified referral rules apply before commission becomes payable,
- POOOL may monitor, suspend, freeze payouts, or claw back where rules are breached.

Stage 6 — Mini-training

Before activation, the applicant must complete mandatory onboarding training.

The training should cover at minimum:

- how the program works,
- what affiliates are allowed to do,
- what affiliates are not allowed to do,
- private conversation vs. affiliate communication,
- how qualified referrals work,
- disclosure basics,
- reporting/escalation basics,
- sanctions for violations,

- and where official materials are found.

Training should be concise, operational, and scenario-based.

Stage 7 — Training quiz / knowledge confirmation

The applicant must complete a short quiz or knowledge confirmation step to verify minimum understanding before activation.

The quiz should test at minimum:

- allowed vs. prohibited conduct,
- no advice / no asset recommendation rule,
- no private cold outreach rule,
- qualified referral basics,
- referral link usage rules,
- and redirect-to-official-materials behavior.

Applicants who fail the quiz should not be activated until they retake and pass.

Stage 8 — Manual compliance / operations review

In Phase 1, POOOL should use a manual or semi-manual final review before activation.

The reviewer should confirm:

- application completeness,
- KYC completion,
- payout/tax readiness,
- acceptance records present,
- training complete,
- quiz passed,
- no obvious prohibited promotion plan,
- and no unresolved risk flags.

Stage 9 — Approval and link activation

Only after successful completion of all required stages may the applicant be approved and activated.

Upon activation, the system may issue:

- affiliate status = active,
- affiliate ID,
- referral link / referral code,
- access to approved materials,
- access to dashboard and reporting tools as permitted.

Stage 10 — Rejection / pending / remediation handling

Where onboarding is incomplete or deficient, the applicant should not be activated.

Possible statuses:

- Pending documents
- Pending KYC
- Pending tax/payout setup
- Pending policy acceptance
- Pending training
- Pending review
- Rejected
- Escalated for manual review

POOOL may request remediation before approval or may reject the application outright based on internal policy and legal/compliance considerations.
[LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

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5. Mandatory pre-activation approvals and acknowledgements

Before any referral link becomes active, the following must exist in recorded form:

Required approvals

- application submitted
- applicant reviewed
- KYC approved
- payout setup accepted as complete
- tax setup accepted as complete where required
- final compliance/operations approval
- affiliate account status approved for activation

Required acknowledgements

- acceptance of Affiliate Terms
- acceptance of Code of Conduct
- acceptance of Approved Marketing Materials Policy
- acceptance of Qualified Referral & Payout Policy
- acceptance of Affiliate Privacy Notice
- acknowledgment of monitoring, payout freeze, clawback, and suspension logic
- acknowledgment of no-advice / no-guarantee / no-closing / no-payment-handling rules
- acknowledgment of referral-only model and single-level structure

Required training steps

- training module opened
- training module completed
- training quiz passed
- completion timestamp recorded
- training version recorded

6. Activation control rule

Product and operations must ensure that the affiliate link cannot be used in active referral mode unless onboarding status is fully approved.

Permitted system logic:

- applicant can create account,
- applicant can view limited onboarding materials,
- applicant cannot access active link,
- applicant cannot earn commission,
- applicant cannot appear as active affiliate,
- applicant cannot access payout-eligible status,

until final approval is complete.

7. Refresh and re-certification rule

POOOL may require refreshed acknowledgements, retraining, or re-verification where:

- policies materially change,
- the affiliate was inactive for a defined period,
- the affiliate was previously suspended,
- payout/tax data has expired or become incomplete,
- or legal/compliance changes require updated consent. **[LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]**

8. Audit and recordkeeping rule

POOOL must retain onboarding records sufficient to show:

- who applied,
- what was submitted,
- what was approved,
- what was acknowledged,
- what training was completed,
- when the link was activated,

- and who approved activation.

This record should support:

- complaint handling,
- payout disputes,
- enforcement,
- legal review,
- and internal audits.

D. Short customer-facing / website-facing version

Short onboarding flow summary

To become a POOOL affiliate, you must complete the onboarding process before your referral link is activated.

The onboarding flow includes:

1. application,
2. identity/KYC review,
3. payout and tax setup,
4. acceptance of the affiliate rules and policies,
5. short compliance training,
6. short quiz,
7. final approval by POOOL.

Your link is activated only after all required steps are completed and approved.

Simple rule:
No approval, no active link.

E. Required UI text / checkbox text / disclosure text (if relevant)

User-facing onboarding screen text in concise form

Screen 1 — Welcome

Title:
Apply to become a POOOL Affiliate

Body:
POOOL’s affiliate program is a controlled referral program. Approved affiliates may share general information, approved materials, and their personal referral link. Personal advice, asset recommendations, guarantees, private cold outreach, negotiation, and payment handling are not allowed.

CTA:
Start application

Screen 2 — Application

Title:
Your affiliate application

Body:
Please provide your details, contact information, and intended promotion channels. All applications are reviewed before approval.

Screen 3 — Identity Verification

Title:
Complete identity verification

Body:
Before activation, we need to verify your identity and complete required review steps.

Screen 4 — Payout & Tax

Title:
Set up payout and tax details

Body:
To receive any future commission, you must provide complete payout and tax information where required.

Screen 5 — Agreements & Policies

Title:
Review and accept the program rules

Body:
Please review and accept the affiliate terms, code of conduct, marketing materials policy, payout rules, and privacy notice before continuing.

Example checkbox set:

- I accept the Affiliate Terms & Conditions.
- I accept the Affiliate Code of Conduct.
- I accept the Approved Marketing Materials Policy.
- I accept the Qualified Referral & Payout Policy.
- I acknowledge the Affiliate Privacy Notice.
- I understand that POOOL may monitor compliance, freeze payouts, claw back commissions, and suspend or remove affiliates for violations.

Screen 6 — Core Conduct Acknowledgement

Title:
Important conduct rules

Body:
Your role is limited to general information and compliant referral activity.

Example checkbox set:

- I understand that I may not provide personal investment advice.
- I understand that I may not recommend specific assets.
- I understand that I may not promise returns or guarantees.
- I understand that I may not use private cold outreach.
- I understand that I may not negotiate, close, or handle payments.
- I understand that only qualified referrals may become commission-payable.

Screen 7 — Training

Title:
Complete the affiliate training

Body:
Before activation, you must complete a short training module on permitted activities, prohibited activities, qualified referrals, and compliance rules.

CTA:
Start training

Screen 8 — Quiz

Title:
Knowledge check

Body:
Please complete the short quiz to confirm you understand the program rules.

Screen 9 — Final Review

Title:
Application under review

Body:
Your application is now under review. Your referral link will be activated only after all checks are completed and approved.

Optional concise help text

Help text:
Your affiliate link stays inactive until your application, verification, training, and approvals are complete.

F. Operational / backend / implementation notes

Clean operational checklist for compliance and operations teams

1. Application review checklist

- applicant account created
- legal name collected

- contact details collected
- location/jurisdiction captured
- intended channels captured
- high-level promotion plan reviewed
- no obvious prohibited use case disclosed

2. KYC / identity checklist

- identity documents received
- identity verification completed
- KYC status approved
- internal screening completed if applicable
- unresolved red flags escalated

3. Payout / tax checklist

- payout method selected
- payout data submitted
- payout name matched or reviewed
- tax classification captured
- required tax details/documents received
- payout/tax completeness approved

4. Document acceptance checklist

- Affiliate Terms accepted
- Code of Conduct accepted
- Marketing Materials Policy accepted
- Qualified Referral & Payout Policy accepted
- Affiliate Privacy Notice acknowledged
- acceptance timestamps logged
- document version IDs logged

5. Conduct acknowledgement checklist

- referral-only model acknowledged
- no-advice rule acknowledged
- no asset recommendation rule acknowledged
- no guarantee rule acknowledged
- no private cold outreach rule acknowledged
- no closing / no negotiation rule acknowledged
- no payment-handling rule acknowledged
- monitoring / freeze / clawback / suspension acknowledged

6. Training checklist

- training assigned
- training completed
- quiz passed
- score logged
- training version logged
- retake completed if needed

7. Final approval checklist

- all prior sections complete
- no unresolved risk flag
- reviewer name logged
- approval timestamp logged
- affiliate status moved to active
- referral link/code issued
- approved materials access enabled
- dashboard access enabled

8. Rejection / pending handling checklist

- missing item reason code logged
- applicant notified of pending or rejection status
- remediation path offered if allowed
- no active link issued
- no commission status enabled

Backend / product implementation notes

- Use onboarding statuses such as:
  - Draft
  - Submitted
  - Pending KYC
  - Pending Payout/Tax
  - Pending Agreements
  - Pending Training
  - Pending Review
  - Approved
  - Rejected
  - Suspended
- Referral-link generation should exist only after **Approved** status.

- Commission logic should check affiliate status before any attribution becomes commission-eligible.
- Record all acknowledgement timestamps and policy version IDs.
- Store training completion and quiz score in structured fields.
- Support re-certification flags for future policy updates.
- Access to approved materials should ideally be gated until approval.
- Admin panel should show missing-step breakdown clearly to operations/compliance reviewers.

G. Open legal-review items

- Whether any applicant categories require enhanced onboarding or enhanced due diligence before approval.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]
- Whether payout/tax setup must be fully complete before activation in all cases, or whether limited activation without payout enablement is acceptable.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]
- Whether the training quiz should have a minimum passing score and formal retake policy written into the SOP.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]
- Whether POOOL should reserve an express discretionary right to reject applicants without onboarding completion even where all documents were submitted.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]
- Whether refreshed acknowledgements and retraining should be mandatory after material policy changes.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

H. Final recommended version

Use the following as the formal onboarding rule:

> **No person may become an active POOOL affiliate, receive an active referral link, or become eligible for commission until POOOL has completed the required onboarding process. The onboarding process must include application intake, identity/KYC review, payout and tax setup, acceptance of the Affiliate Terms and required policies, mandatory conduct acknowledgements, completion of onboarding training, successful completion of a knowledge check, and final compliance/operations approval. All approvals, acknowledgements, training records, and activation events must be logged in POOOL's system of record before link activation.**

Point 10: Required Document Architecture for the POOOL Affiliate Program

A. Objective of this point

Create the document architecture for the POOOL Affiliate Program so POOOL has a clear map of:

- which documents are required,
- why each document exists,
- who should own each document,
- whether each document is internal, external, or mixed-use,
- and where each document connects into product, onboarding, payout, compliance, and support workflows.

This point is about **document structure and ownership**, not full drafting.

B. Key assumptions

- The approved baseline in this chat is the binding source of truth.
- The minimum required document set already approved is:
  - Affiliate Terms & Conditions
  - Affiliate Code of Conduct
  - Approved Marketing Materials Policy
  - Disclosure Library
  - Qualified Referral & Payout Policy
  - Complaint & Investigation SOP
  - Tax SOP
  - Affiliate Privacy Notice
- Phase 1 is a controlled, referral-only, single-level affiliate model.
- The document system must support both:
  - external-facing trust and clarity, and
  - internal governance, enforcement, and operational control.
- Ownership recommendations below are operational recommendations and may need to be adapted to POOOL's final org structure.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

C. Full internal/professional draft

POOOL Affiliate Program

Document Architecture & Ownership Map

Phase 1

1. Architecture principle

The POOOL Affiliate Program should not be governed by a single document.

Instead, it should be governed by a **stacked document architecture**, where each document has a distinct role:

- **contract layer**
- **behavior layer**
- **content-control layer**
- **disclosure layer**
- **qualification/payout layer**
- **complaint/investigation layer**
- **tax operations layer**
- **privacy layer**

This structure prevents overload in any single document and makes the program easier to:

- implement,
- explain,
- enforce,
- update,
- and audit.

2. Document map overview

No.	Document	Primary Role	Use Type
1	Affiliate Terms & Conditions	Contractual foundation	External + Internal

2	Affiliate Code of Conduct	Behavioral rulebook	External + Internal
3	Approved Marketing Materials Policy	Content-control and usage rules	External + Internal
4	Disclosure Library	Controlled wording source	Mixed-use
5	Qualified Referral & Payout Policy	Qualification and payout logic	External + Internal
6	Complaint & Investigation SOP	Complaint/investigation playbook	Internal Only
7	Affiliate Tax SOP	Finance/tax payout workflow	Internal Only
8	Affiliate Privacy Notice	External privacy notice	External + Internal reference

3. Purpose of each required document

3.1 Affiliate Terms & Conditions

Purpose:
This is the main contract document between POOOL and the Affiliate.

It should define:

- eligibility,
- onboarding,
- activation,
- permitted use,
- prohibited conduct at a high level,
- commission and payout conditions,

- monitoring and enforcement rights,
- suspension,
- clawback,
- termination,
- liability,
- and governing operational language.

Why it exists:
To create the contractual basis for participation and enforcement.

What it should not do alone:
It should not try to carry every operational detail by itself.

3.2 Affiliate Code of Conduct

Purpose:
This is the practical behavior document for affiliates.

It should define:

- how Affiliates are expected to behave,
- communication boundaries,
- prohibited styles of communication,
- examples of compliant and non-compliant behavior,
- and the practical conduct standard for the Phase 1 model.

Why it exists:
To translate the contract into daily behavioral rules that can be trained, monitored, and enforced.

What it should not do alone:
It should not replace the contract or payout policy.

3.3 Approved Marketing Materials Policy

Purpose:
This document governs what Affiliates may and may not use as content and promotional material.

It should define:

- what counts as approved material,

- what edits are prohibited,
- version-control rules,
- submission/approval rules,
- withdrawal and replacement rules,
- and content-usage enforcement.

Why it exists:
To stop affiliates from improvising or modifying materials into advice, guarantees, or sales content.

What it should not do alone:
It should not replace the Code of Conduct or disclosure system.

3.4 Disclosure Library

Purpose:
This is the controlled source of approved disclosure wording.

It should contain:

- short, medium, and full disclosure texts,
- checkbox wording,
- support macros,
- placement variants,
- and a mapping of which disclosure appears where.

Why it exists:
To stop disclosure wording from becoming fragmented across product, support, marketing, and onboarding.

What it should not do alone:
It should not define the full placement logic by itself without product integration and governance rules.

3.5 Qualified Referral & Payout Policy

Purpose:
This document defines when a referral becomes qualified, when commission becomes payable, and when it may be blocked, reversed, denied, or clawed back.

It should define:

- qualified-referral conditions,
- payout timing,
- holdback,
- anti-fraud logic,
- self-referral and ring prohibition,
- evidence standards,
- dispute handling,
- and payable-status rules.

Why it exists:
To separate referral tracking from actual payout entitlement and give finance/operations a precise payout rulebook.

What it should not do alone:
It should not replace the tax workflow or complaint SOP.

3.6 Complaint & Investigation SOP

Purpose:
This is the internal case-handling procedure for affiliate complaints, violations, disputes, and investigations.

It should define:

- intake,
- evidence collection,
- triage,
- escalation,
- freeze logic,
- decision documentation,
- templates,
- closure,
- and retention steps.

Why it exists:
To ensure cases are handled consistently, quickly, and with preserved evidence.

What it should not do alone:
It should not replace the contract or conduct rules being enforced.

3.7 Affiliate Tax SOP

Purpose:
This is the internal finance/operations document for payout tax handling.

It should define:

- payout data requirements,
- recipient classification,
- withholding/review checkpoints,
- exception handling,
- year-end readiness,
- and payout-block logic.

Why it exists:
To ensure no payout is released without a completed tax/payout workflow.

What it should not do alone:
It should not determine final tax law positions without legal/tax review.

3.8 Affiliate Privacy Notice

Purpose:
This is the external notice explaining how POOOL processes affiliate-program data.

It should define:

- data categories,
- purposes,
- retention logic,
- access/control rights wording,
- security language,
- and privacy contact/notice framework.

Why it exists:
To provide external transparency and align the actual affiliate data model with a user-facing notice.

What it should not do alone:
It should not replace internal data-governance controls or retention SOPs.

4. Recommended owner/team for each document

Document	Primary Owner	Supporting Teams
Affiliate Terms & Conditions	Legal / Compliance Lead	Founder, Affiliate Ops, Finance
Affiliate Code of Conduct	Compliance / Affiliate Ops	Legal, Training Owner, Support
Approved Marketing Materials Policy	Marketing Governance / Compliance	Affiliate Ops, Legal, Product
Disclosure Library	Compliance / Product UX Governance	Legal, Marketing, Support
Qualified Referral & Payout Policy	Affiliate Ops + Finance	Compliance, Product, Legal
Complaint & Investigation SOP	Compliance / Affiliate Ops	Support, Finance, Legal, Product
Affiliate Tax SOP	Finance	Compliance, Legal/Tax Review, Ops
Affiliate Privacy Notice	Privacy / Legal	Product, Compliance, Engineering

5. Use classification: internal only, external only, or mixed-use

Internal only

These documents should primarily or exclusively be used internally:

- Complaint & Investigation SOP
- Affiliate Tax SOP

External only

No document in the current minimum set is purely external-only in the strict sense, because even external documents need internal reference ownership.

Mixed-use

These documents are externally visible or externally accepted, but also operationally used internally:

- Affiliate Terms & Conditions
- Affiliate Code of Conduct
- Approved Marketing Materials Policy
- Disclosure Library
- Qualified Referral & Payout Policy
- Affiliate Privacy Notice

6. Recommended visibility model by document

Document	Public Website	Affiliate Onboarding	Affiliate Dashboard	Internal Ops/Compliance	Finance	Support
Affiliate Terms & Conditions	Linkable	Required acceptance	Reference	Yes	Yes	Reference
Affiliate Code of Conduct	Optional summary only	Required acceptance	Reference/reminder	Yes	Reference	Reference

Approved Marketing Materials Policy	Usually not public in full	Required acceptance	Yes	Yes	No	Reference
Disclosure Library	No full public release	Embedded by flow	Embedded by flow	Yes	Reference	Yes
Qualified Referral & Payout Policy	Summary/linkable	Required acceptance	Yes	Yes	Yes	Reference
Complaint & Investigation SOP	No	No	No	Yes	Yes	Yes
Affiliate Tax SOP	No	No	No	Reference	Yes	Limited reference
Affiliate Privacy Notice	Public / linkable	Required acknowledgment	Link/reference	Yes	Reference	Reference

7. Workflow connection map

7.1 Website pages

The following documents should connect to website/public-facing pages:

- **Affiliate Terms & Conditions**
  Public summary page or linked full terms for applicants

- **Disclosure Library**
  Referral landing pages, FAQ, help-center, website disclosures
- **Affiliate Privacy Notice**
  Public privacy link and onboarding privacy link
- **Qualified Referral & Payout Policy**
  Public summary or help-center explanation for affiliates
- **Affiliate Code of Conduct**
  Usually not fully public-facing, but short summary may appear on affiliate information pages

7.2 Affiliate onboarding flows

The following documents must connect directly into affiliate onboarding:

- **Affiliate Terms & Conditions**
  mandatory acceptance
- **Affiliate Code of Conduct**
  mandatory acceptance
- **Approved Marketing Materials Policy**
  mandatory acceptance
- **Qualified Referral & Payout Policy**
  mandatory acceptance
- **Affiliate Privacy Notice**
  mandatory acknowledgment
- **Disclosure Library**
  supplies the actual checkbox and explanatory wording used in onboarding screens
- **Affiliate Tax SOP**
  not directly shown in full, but operationally drives what payout/tax fields are collected

7.3 Payout flows

The following documents should connect into payout and finance workflows:

- **Qualified Referral & Payout Policy**
  governs when commission becomes payable
- **Affiliate Tax SOP**
  governs payout release conditions, classification, and review
- **Affiliate Terms & Conditions**
  supports contractual basis for blocking, withholding, denying, or clawing back payouts
- **Complaint & Investigation SOP**
  governs disputed or frozen payouts tied to complaints or breach review

7.4 Support flows

The following documents should connect into support workflows:

- **Disclosure Library**
  support macros and approved response texts
- **Complaint & Investigation SOP**
  complaint intake, triage, escalation, customer communication
- **Affiliate Code of Conduct**
  reference point when support identifies affiliate conduct issues
- **Qualified Referral & Payout Policy**
  payout-status and qualification questions
- **Affiliate Privacy Notice**
  privacy-related affiliate queries

7.5 Monitoring and enforcement flows

The following documents should connect into compliance and enforcement workflows:

- **Affiliate Terms & Conditions**
  contractual rights
- **Affiliate Code of Conduct**
  behavioral standards
- **Approved Marketing Materials Policy**
  content-use standards
- **Qualified Referral & Payout Policy**
  referral and payout status consequences
- **Complaint & Investigation SOP**
  case handling process
- **Affiliate Tax SOP**
  finance-side payout holds or exceptions

8. Recommended document hierarchy

Layer 1 — Contractual control

- Affiliate Terms & Conditions

Layer 2 — Behavior and content control

- Affiliate Code of Conduct
- Approved Marketing Materials Policy

Layer 3 — Disclosure and communication control

- Disclosure Library
- Affiliate Privacy Notice

Layer 4 — Qualification and payout control

- Qualified Referral & Payout Policy
- Affiliate Tax SOP

Layer 5 — Enforcement and case management

- Complaint & Investigation SOP

9. Document ownership governance rule

Each document should have:

- one named primary owner,
- at least one supporting review owner,
- a version number,
- an approval date,
- a change log,
- and a review cadence.

Recommended minimum metadata per document:

- Document Name
- Document Owner
- Supporting Teams
- Current Version
- Effective Date
- Status
- External/Internal Classification
- Connected Flows
- Review Frequency
- Last Review Date

10. Change-control rule

A document change should not be made in isolation if it impacts another connected document or live flow.

Examples:

- if the **Qualified Referral & Payout Policy** changes, review:
    - Terms,
    - dashboard wording,
    - payout flow,

    - finance process
- if the **Disclosure Library** changes, review:
    - referral landing page,
    - registration flow,
    - pre-investment flow,
    - support macros
- if the **Code of Conduct** changes, review:
    - onboarding,
    - training,
    - moderation reason codes,
    - investigation templates

11. Recommended launch control

Before go-live, POOOL should confirm that all 8 required documents:

- exist,
- have a named owner,
- have a current approved version,
- are connected to the correct flow,
- and are not contradictory across product, support, finance, and compliance.

D. Short customer-facing / website-facing version

Not primarily customer-facing.
However, the simplest internal explanation is:

The POOOL Affiliate Program should be governed by a document stack, not by one document.
The contract controls participation, the conduct code controls behavior, the materials policy controls content, the disclosure library controls wording, the payout policy controls commission eligibility, the complaint SOP controls investigations, the tax SOP controls payout release, and the privacy notice explains data handling.

E. Required UI text / checkbox text / disclosure text (if relevant)

No new customer-facing checkbox is required for this point.

Recommended internal admin labels:

- Contract Layer

- Conduct Layer
- Content Layer
- Disclosure Layer
- Payout Layer
- Enforcement Layer
- Tax Layer
- Privacy Layer

Recommended internal onboarding/reference label:
Program Document Set
This affiliate program is governed by a linked set of contract, conduct, content, disclosure, payout, tax, privacy, and investigation documents.

F. Operational / backend / implementation notes

- Build a central document register for all 8 required documents.
- Assign one owner and one backup owner per document.
- Link each document to the actual product surfaces it governs.
- Version-control documents and related UI text together.
- Do not allow support, onboarding, or payout teams to use uncontrolled wording outside the registered document set.
- Create a document-to-flow matrix in the admin/compliance workspace.
- Use review triggers whenever:
  - product flow changes,
  - payout logic changes,
  - disclosure logic changes,
  - affiliate onboarding changes,
  - or a serious complaint reveals documentation gaps.

G. Open legal-review items

- Whether ownership should sit formally with Legal, Compliance, Product, or a cross-functional governance owner.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]
- Whether some mixed-use documents should be split into external and internal versions for cleaner operational control.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]
- Whether the Qualified Referral & Payout Policy should be fully external-facing or partially summarized externally with deeper internal appendices.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]
- Whether the Approved Marketing Materials Policy should exist in both:

    - a legal/acceptance version, and
    - a practical creator playbook version.
      [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]
- Whether the Complaint & Investigation SOP should be supported by a separate incident playbook or enforcement matrix.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]
- Whether the Disclosure Library should be treated as a legal-controlled document, product-controlled document, or joint document.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

H. Final recommended version

Use the following as the architecture rule:

> **The POOOL Affiliate Program must be governed by a structured document stack, not by a single document. The minimum required architecture consists of eight linked documents: Affiliate Terms & Conditions, Affiliate Code of Conduct, Approved Marketing Materials Policy, Disclosure Library, Qualified Referral & Payout Policy, Complaint & Investigation SOP, Affiliate Tax SOP, and Affiliate Privacy Notice. Each document must have a defined purpose, a named owner, a clear internal/external use classification, and a mapped connection to the relevant website, onboarding, payout, compliance, and support flows.**

Point 11: Investor / Customer Confirmations

A. Objective of this point

Define the required customer confirmation texts that POOOL should collect:

- from **all investors**, and
- from **referral-sourced investors only**,

so that the customer journey clearly documents:

- receipt of official information,
- independent decision-making,
- understanding of referral compensation where applicable,
- and the limited role of affiliates.

This point is intended to create a clean disclosure and confirmation layer for onboarding, checkout, and first-investment flow.

B. Key assumptions

- The approved baseline in this chat is the binding source of truth.
- The baseline requires two confirmation layers:
    - confirmations for **all investors**, and
    - additional confirmations for **referral customers only**.
- The baseline already supports the following core messages:
    - all investors confirm they reviewed official product, fee, and risk information;
    - all investors confirm they make their decision independently;
    - referral customers additionally confirm that the referrer may receive compensation;
    - referral customers additionally confirm that the referrer is not their personal investment adviser;
    - official POOOL materials remain the controlling source of information.
- This draft is prepared to legal-review standard and is not legally final.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

C. Full internal/professional draft

POOOL Investor / Customer Confirmation Standard

Phase 1

1. Core rule

Before a user completes a first investment, POOOL must obtain the required investor/customer confirmations through the applicable disclosure flow.

The confirmation framework must be split into:

1. **General investor confirmations** — required for all investors; and
2. **Referral-specific confirmations** — required only where the user entered through a referral path or is otherwise classified as a referral customer under POOOL's attribution rules.

2. Confirmation design principle

The purpose of the confirmation layer is to evidence that the customer:

- reviewed official POOOL information,
- understands that investment decisions must be made independently,
- understands the limited role of any affiliate/referrer,
- and understands that referral compensation may exist where applicable.

These confirmations are intended to support transparency, customer understanding, operational control, and dispute handling. They must not be treated as a substitute for complete product, risk, fee, and legal disclosures.
[LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

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3. Required confirmation texts — all investors

A. Plain-language checkbox text — all investors

These confirmations should be shown to every investor before the first investment is submitted.

Checkbox 1 — Official information reviewed

I confirm that I have reviewed the official POOOL product, fee, and risk information relevant to my investment.

Checkbox 2 — Independent decision

I confirm that I am making my investment decision independently and based on official POOOL information.

Checkbox 3 — Official documents control

I understand that only official POOOL documents, disclosures, and platform information are controlling.

---

4. Required confirmation texts — referral customers only

A. Plain-language checkbox text — referral customers only

These confirmations should be shown only where the user is classified as a referral customer.

Checkbox 4 — Referrer compensation disclosure

I understand that the referrer may receive compensation if I complete a qualified investment through the referral path.

Checkbox 5 — No personal adviser relationship

I understand that the referrer is not my personal investment adviser, broker, or personal financial representative.

Checkbox 6 — No reliance on referrer over official materials

I understand that my investment decision must be based on official POOOL information and not on any personal statement, suggestion, or opinion of a referrer.

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5. Longer legal text — full disclosure layer

A. General investor disclosure text — all investors

Investor Confirmation and Reliance Statement
By proceeding, you confirm that you have reviewed the official POOOL materials made available to you in connection with the relevant investment opportunity, including applicable product information, fee information, and risk disclosures. You further confirm that you are making your investment decision independently and that you are relying only on official POOOL documents, platform disclosures, and other official information provided by POOOL through approved channels. No statement outside the official POOOL information set should be treated

as controlling or as a substitute for your own review and decision-making.
[LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

B. Referral-specific disclosure text — referral customers only

Referral Disclosure and Limited Referrer Role Statement
Where you entered POOOL through a referral path, you acknowledge that the referrer may receive compensation if your referral is attributed and becomes a qualified referral under POOOL's program rules. You further acknowledge that the referrer is not acting as your personal investment adviser, broker, fiduciary, or authorized decision-maker and is not authorized to provide you with personal investment advice, suitability assessments, return guarantees, negotiated terms, or payment-handling services. Your decision to invest must be based solely on official POOOL materials and your own independent judgment.
[LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

C. Combined full disclosure version — referral customers

Where product/UX prefers a combined disclosure block for referral customers, the following may be used:

Investor and Referral Confirmation
By proceeding, you confirm that you have reviewed the official POOOL product, fee, and risk information relevant to your investment and that you are making your investment decision independently based solely on official POOOL information. You acknowledge that, where applicable, the referrer may receive compensation if your referral becomes a qualified referral under POOOL's rules. You also acknowledge that the referrer is not your personal investment adviser, broker, fiduciary, or authorized representative and that no personal statement by a referrer overrides or replaces official POOOL documents and disclosures.
[LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

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6. Customer confirmation set by user type

A. All investors — required set

All investors must confirm:

1. official product/fee/risk information reviewed;
2. independent investment decision;
3. official POOOL materials are controlling.

B. Referral customers only — additional required set

Referral customers must additionally confirm:
4. referrer may receive compensation;
5. referrer is not a personal investment adviser/broker/personal representative;
6. official POOOL materials govern and personal referrer statements do not replace them.

---

7. Consent and recordkeeping rule

POOOL must log each required confirmation in a retrievable system record.

For each confirmation event, the system should record at minimum:

- user ID,
- referral / non-referral classification,
- confirmation text version,
- timestamp,
- surface/location shown,
- whether all required boxes were checked,
- whether long-form disclosure was shown or expanded,
- and the event tied to the first-investment flow.

No first investment should proceed unless the required confirmation set for that user type has been completed.

8. No substitution rule

A general terms acceptance or generic platform consent must not be treated as a substitute for the investor/customer confirmation layer required here.

The required confirmations should be:

- explicit,
- specific to the investment/referral context,
- and collected in the relevant flow before first investment.

9. Reconfirmation logic

POOOL may require re-confirmation where:

- the user is making a first investment after a material disclosure change,
- the referral classification changes before investment,
- or the underlying confirmation language is materially updated.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

D. Short customer-facing / website-facing version

Plain-language checkbox text

For all investors

- **I confirm that I have reviewed the official POOOL product, fee, and risk information.**
- **I confirm that I am making my investment decision independently.**
- **I understand that official POOOL information is the only controlling source of information for my investment decision.**

Additional for referral customers only

- **I understand that the referrer may receive compensation if my referral qualifies under POOOL's rules.**
- **I understand that the referrer is not my personal investment adviser, broker, or personal representative.**
- **I understand that I must rely on official POOOL information, not on personal statements from a referrer.**

E. Required UI text / checkbox text / disclosure text (if relevant)

Full set of required customer confirmation texts

1. Standard confirmation block — all investors

Before you continue, please confirm the following:

- I have reviewed the official POOOL product, fee, and risk information relevant to my investment.
- I am making my investment decision independently.
- I understand that only official POOOL documents and disclosures are controlling.

2. Additional confirmation block — referral customers only

Because you entered through a referral path, please also confirm the following:

- I understand that the referrer may receive compensation if my referral qualifies under POOOL's rules.
- I understand that the referrer is not my personal investment adviser, broker, or personal representative.
- I understand that my decision must be based on official POOOL information and not on personal statements from a referrer.

3. Longer legal text — expandable disclosure panel

Important Information
You confirm that you have reviewed the official POOOL materials relevant to your investment, including applicable product information, fee information, and risk disclosures, and that you are making your decision independently based on official POOOL information. If you entered through a referral path, you also acknowledge that the referrer may receive compensation if your referral qualifies under POOOL's rules and that the referrer is not acting as your personal investment adviser, broker, fiduciary, or authorized representative. Official POOOL disclosures and materials remain the controlling source of information for your investment decision.
[LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

F. Operational / backend / implementation notes

Short explanation for product / UX on when each confirmation should appear

1. General investor confirmations — when to show

Show the **all-investor confirmation set**:

- before the user completes their **first investment**,
- after the user has had access to the relevant product, fee, and risk information,
- and before final submission/commitment in the first-investment flow.

These confirmations should apply to every investor, whether referred or not.

2. Referral-specific confirmations — when to show

Show the **referral-customer-only confirmation set**:

- only if the user is classified as a referral customer based on POOOL's attribution logic,
- and before the first investment is finalized.

These should be shown in addition to the all-investor confirmations, not instead of them.

3. Recommended product flow logic

Recommended flow:

1. user reviews opportunity / official materials,
2. user enters invest / checkout / first-investment flow,
3. system checks whether user is classified as direct or referral,
4. show general investor confirmations to all,
5. show referral-specific confirmations only where referral classification = yes,
6. log all confirmations,
7. allow continuation only after required confirmations are completed.

4. Recommended UI structure

Use a layered display:

- short checkbox text visible by default,
- expandable “Important Information” or “Full Disclosure” panel below,
- links to official product, fee, and risk documents directly adjacent to the checkboxes,
- and a clean distinction between “for all investors” and “additional for referral customers.”

5. Classification dependency

Product and engineering should not rely on user self-identification alone where system attribution exists.

The confirmation surface should be triggered by:

- referral attribution status,
- referral landing-page entry,
- referral code usage,
- or other approved referral-classification logic.

6. Logging requirements

Before allowing first investment submission, the system should log:

- confirmation completion status,
- text version IDs,
- display context,
- referral classification at the time shown,
- and timestamp tied to the investment attempt.

7. UX caution

Do not overload the user with a single dense legal wall.

Best practice:

- concise checkbox layer,
- expandable longer disclosure text,
- adjacent links to official supporting documents,
- and clear separation between universal confirmations and referral-only confirmations.

G. Open legal-review items

- Whether the phrase “qualified investment” or “qualified referral” should be used in the customer-facing compensation disclosure, and how much detail should be included.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]
- Whether “broker,” “fiduciary,” and “personal representative” should all remain in the referral disclaimer language or be narrowed.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]
- Whether reconfirmation is required for later investments or only for the first investment.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]
- Whether any market-, product-, or jurisdiction-specific investor confirmations must be added to the universal set.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]
- Whether the long-form disclosure should be embedded directly in the investment flow or referenced through an expandable layer plus linked disclosure page.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

H. Final recommended version

Use the following as the core confirmation framework:

> **All investors must confirm before first investment that they have reviewed the official POOOL product, fee, and risk information, that they are making their investment decision independently, and that official POOOL materials are the controlling source of information. Referral customers must additionally confirm that the referrer may receive compensation if the referral qualifies, that the referrer is not their personal investment adviser, broker, or personal representative, and that they must rely on official POOOL information rather than personal statements from a referrer. These confirmations must be collected explicitly, shown at the appropriate point in the first-investment flow, and logged in POOOL’s system of record.**

Point 12: Disclosure Placement Logic

A. Objective of this point

Define exactly **where** POOOL's referral and investor disclosures must appear in the user journey, so that:

- disclosures are shown at the right time,
- the correct user receives the correct disclosure set,
- direct customers and referral customers are treated differently where required,
- and POOOL can prove, later, what was shown, when, and to whom.

This point is about **placement logic**, not just disclosure wording.

B. Key assumptions

- The approved baseline in this chat is the binding source of truth.
- The approved structure requires channel-based disclosure placement.
- The baseline already identifies three key placement points:
  - referral landing page,
  - registration,
  - before first investment.
- Direct customers should receive the **general investor disclosure/confirmation layer**.
- Referral customers should receive:
  - the **general investor disclosure/confirmation layer**, plus
  - the **referral-specific disclosure/confirmation layer**.
- Referral-specific disclosures should not be shown to every user by default unless product later chooses a broader universal approach for operational simplicity. **[LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]**
- This draft is prepared to legal-review standard and is not legally final.

C. Full internal/professional draft

POOOL Investor / Referral Disclosure Placement Rule

Phase 1

1. Core rule

POOOL must present investor and referral disclosures in a **layered, journey-based sequence** rather than relying on a single disclosure moment.

The required placement framework for Phase 1 is:

1. **Referral Landing Page**
2. **Registration / Account Creation Flow**
3. **Pre-Investment / First-Investment Confirmation Flow**

This structure is intended to ensure that:

- users first receive context-level disclosure,
- then account-level disclosure,
- then transaction-level confirmation before first investment.

2. Placement principle

Disclosures must be placed:

- early enough to be meaningful,
- close enough to the relevant user action to be credible,
- and specifically enough to match the user's channel and referral status.

The disclosure model must distinguish between:

- **direct customers**; and
- **referral customers**.

3. Required placement by stage

Stage 1 — Referral landing page

Where a user enters POOOL through an affiliate/referral path, the referral landing page must present an initial referral disclosure.

This placement is intended to disclose, at first meaningful contact, that:

- the page is part of a referral path,
- the referrer may receive compensation if qualification rules are met,
- and official POOOL information governs.

This page should not attempt to replace the later registration and pre-investment disclosure layers. It is the **first-touch referral transparency layer** only.

Stage 2 — Registration / account creation

During registration, POOOL should show a concise disclosure layer that:

- confirms the user is entering or registering through official POOOL channels,
- reminds the user that official POOOL information governs,
- and, where applicable, informs the user that referral compensation may apply.

This stage is the correct place to reinforce the distinction between:

- platform access / account creation, and
- later investment decision-making.

Registration disclosure should remain concise and should not overload the user with full investment-confirmation language intended for the pre-investment stage.

Stage 3 — Pre-investment / first-investment confirmation flow

Before the user completes their **first investment**, POOOL must present the full confirmation set applicable to that user type.

This is the primary legal/operational confirmation moment and must include:

- all-investor confirmations for all users,
- plus referral-specific confirmations for referral customers only.

No first investment should proceed until the required confirmations have been completed and logged.

4. Direct customer vs referral customer logic

A. Direct customers

A direct customer is a user who is not classified as entering through a referral path under POOOL's approved attribution logic.

Direct customers should receive:

- general platform/information disclosure at relevant journey points,
- and the **all-investor confirmation set** before first investment.

Direct customers should not be required to confirm referral compensation or referrer-role disclosures unless product chooses to use broader universal wording for system simplicity.
[LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

B. Referral customers

A referral customer is a user who is classified as entering through a referral path under POOOL's approved attribution logic.

Referral customers should receive:

- referral landing-page disclosure,
- registration-stage referral disclosure,
- all-investor confirmations before first investment,
- and referral-specific confirmations before first investment.

The referral-customer flow therefore contains an **additional disclosure layer**, not a replacement layer.

5. Trigger logic for referral classification

Referral classification should be based on approved system logic such as:

- referral link attribution,
- referral code usage,
- referral landing-page entry,
- or other approved referral-attribution signals.

Where referral status exists in the system of record at the time a disclosure is shown, the referral-specific disclosure path should apply.

Where referral status changes before first investment, the system should use the **current valid referral classification at the time of the confirmation step** and log that state.

6. Placement integrity rule

POOOL must not rely on:

- hidden footer disclosures alone,
- generic terms acceptance alone,
- or only one late-stage checkbox

to satisfy the referral/investor disclosure framework.

The disclosure flow must be:

- visible,
- understandable,
- specific to the user's context,
- and capable of being evidenced later.

7. Recommended disclosure sequence

Referral customer sequence

1. User arrives on referral landing page
2. Referral disclosure shown

3. User proceeds to registration
4. Registration disclosure shown
5. User later begins first investment
6. All-investor confirmations shown
7. Referral-specific confirmations shown
8. Confirmation records logged
9. Investment submission allowed

Direct customer sequence

1. User arrives through direct/non-referral path
2. Standard platform disclosure/context may be shown
3. User registers
4. Registration disclosure shown
5. User begins first investment
6. All-investor confirmations shown
7. Confirmation records logged
8. Investment submission allowed

8. Fallback rule where attribution is uncertain

If referral attribution is uncertain, disputed, or technically unresolved before first investment, POOOL should apply a conservative operational rule, such as:

- temporarily treating the user as referral-classified for disclosure purposes, or
- blocking progression until classification is resolved,

depending on product/compliance design.
[LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

9. Auditability rule

Each disclosure placement point must be independently auditable.

POOOL should be able to show:

- what disclosure text was shown,
- at what journey step,
- to which user,
- under what referral/direct classification,
- on what date and time,
- and with what user action outcome.

10. No substitution rule

The existence of a disclosure at one placement point does not eliminate the need for the later required disclosure layer.

Specifically:

- referral landing-page disclosure does not replace registration disclosure,
- registration disclosure does not replace pre-investment confirmations,
- and generic legal pages do not replace in-flow confirmations.

11. Interpretation rule

Placement should be judged by the question:

> **Was the right disclosure shown to the right user at the right step, and can POOOL prove it later?**

If the answer is unclear, the placement logic should be treated as incomplete and escalated for correction.

D. Short customer-facing / website-facing version

Recommended placement across referral landing page, registration, and pre-investment flow

POOOL should use a three-step disclosure flow:

1. **Referral landing page**
   If a user comes through a referral link, show an early disclosure that the referrer may receive compensation and that official POOOL information governs.
2. **Registration**
   Show a short reminder during account creation that official POOOL information controls and, where relevant, that the account came through a referral path.
3. **Before first investment**
   Show the full confirmation layer:

- all investors confirm they reviewed official information and decide independently;
- referral customers additionally confirm that the referrer may be compensated and is not their personal adviser.

This structure makes the disclosure visible, timely, and provable.

E. Required UI text / checkbox text / disclosure text (if relevant)

Short UX copy for each placement point

1. Referral landing page

Headline:
Important referral disclosure

Short copy:
You are viewing POOOL through a referral path. The referrer may receive compensation if your referral becomes a qualified referral under POOOL's rules. Please rely on official POOOL information, disclosures, fees, and risk materials when reviewing any opportunity.

CTA support text:
Continue to official POOOL information

---

2. Registration / account creation

For referral customers

Short copy:
You are registering through a referral path. A referrer may receive compensation if your referral qualifies under POOOL's rules. Official POOOL materials remain the controlling source of information.

For direct customers

Short copy:
Please review official POOOL information carefully. Official POOOL materials and disclosures govern your use of the platform and any future investment decision.

---

3. Pre-investment / first-investment flow

For all investors

Section title:
Before you continue

Short copy:
Please confirm that you reviewed the official product, fee, and risk information and that you are making your investment decision independently.

Additional for referral customers

Section title:
Additional referral confirmation

Short copy:
Because you entered through a referral path, please also confirm that the referrer may receive compensation and is not your personal investment adviser or broker.

F. Operational / backend / implementation notes

Logic for direct customers versus referral customers

1. Direct customers

Show:

- standard platform disclosure where appropriate,
- registration disclosure,
- all-investor confirmations before first investment.

Do not require referral-specific confirmations unless:

- system classification changes to referral before first investment, or
- POOOL intentionally adopts universal referral wording for all users. **[LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]**

2. Referral customers

Show:

- referral landing-page disclosure,
- registration-stage referral disclosure,
- all-investor confirmations before first investment,
- referral-specific confirmations before first investment.

3. Referral-status determination

The system should determine user type using:

- active referral attribution status,
- referral code presence,
- landing-page source,
- or equivalent approved referral signal.

The classification used at each display event should be stored.

Logging and evidence requirements for audit purposes

For each disclosure placement event, POOOL should log at minimum:

A. User and session context

- user ID or pre-registration session ID
- affiliate/referral ID if applicable
- direct vs referral classification at time shown
- device/session identifier where available
- date/time stamp

B. Placement metadata

- placement point:
  - referral landing page
  - registration
  - pre-investment
- page/screen ID
- disclosure module ID
- jurisdiction / language version if relevant
- text version ID

C. Display evidence

- whether disclosure was rendered
- whether the user scrolled/viewed if tracked
- whether expandable long-form text was opened if tracked
- whether linked documents were accessed if tracked
- screenshot/archive version reference where maintained

D. User action evidence

- continue clicked
- checkbox(es) completed

- acknowledgment submitted
- registration completed
- first investment attempt initiated
- first investment submission blocked or allowed

E. System state evidence

- referral attribution status at time of display
- later change to referral classification, if any
- version of confirmation text used
- whether the required disclosure set was complete before progression

F. Audit retention principle

Disclosure logs must be retained in a retrievable format sufficient for:

- complaint review,
- payout disputes,
- internal investigations,
- legal/compliance review,
- and regulator/audit response if required.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

Product / UX implementation notes

- Keep the landing-page disclosure short and contextual.
- Keep registration disclosure concise and non-overwhelming.
- Keep the full confirmation burden in the pre-investment step.
- Do not bury referral compensation disclosure only inside long legal text.
- Ensure the referral-specific block appears only when the user is classified as referral-based, unless a broader product choice is formally approved.
- Maintain version control for every disclosure component.
- Support evidence export by user journey and timestamp.

G. Open legal-review items

- Whether referral-specific disclosure should remain limited to referral-classified users only, or whether a universal disclosure model would be preferable for launch simplicity.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

- Whether uncertain referral attribution should default to “show referral disclosure” or “block until resolved.”
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]
- Whether view/open/scroll evidence is required or whether rendered + acknowledged is sufficient.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]
- Whether disclosure retention periods should be aligned explicitly with broader complaint, tax, privacy, and enforcement retention rules.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]
- Whether any additional placement point is needed for later material disclosure changes or re-confirmation events.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

H. Final recommended version

Use the following as the formal rule:

> **POOOL must use a layered disclosure placement model across the referral landing page, registration flow, and pre-investment flow. Referral customers should receive an initial referral disclosure on the referral landing page, a concise referral-aware disclosure during registration, and the full investor plus referral-specific confirmation set before first investment. Direct customers should receive the general registration disclosure and the all-investor confirmation set before first investment. The system must determine and log the user’s referral or direct classification at each disclosure event and retain auditable evidence of what was shown, when it was shown, and what the user confirmed before progression was allowed.**

Point 13: Tax Setup for Affiliate Payouts

A. Objective of this point

Establish the tax-handling framework for affiliate payouts so that POOOL does not release commissions unless the affiliate's payout and tax status has been properly classified, documented, and approved.

This point is intended to ensure that:

- affiliate payouts are not treated as "automatic" cash-outs,
- finance has a defined payout-classification workflow,
- affiliates understand that tax and payout data are mandatory,
- and POOOL launches the program only after the withholding and reporting process is operationally ready.

B. Key assumptions

- The approved baseline in this chat is the binding source of truth.
- The baseline states that affiliate commissions are tax-relevant in Indonesia.
- The baseline further states that POOOL must not make payouts without complete payout and tax data.
- The baseline requires a practical distinction between:
  - Indonesian individuals,
  - Indonesian entities,
  - foreign recipients.
- The baseline also states that finance must define the withholding and reporting process before go-live.
- The baseline mentions that, depending on structure, withholding review may involve:
  - PPh 21 / 26 for individuals,
  - PPh 23 for certain domestic entities / services,
  - PPh 26 for foreign recipients, subject to treaty issues.
    [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]
- This draft does not determine final tax treatment. It creates the operational framework that finance, tax, and legal must finalize before launch.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

C. Full internal/professional draft

POOOL Affiliate Program

Affiliate Tax Handling Framework

Phase 1

1. Purpose

This framework governs how POOOL classifies, documents, reviews, and processes the tax side of affiliate payouts in Phase 1.

Its purpose is to ensure that affiliate commissions are paid only after:

- required payout details are collected,
- the affiliate's tax classification is determined,
- any required withholding logic is applied,
- and the payout is approved under POOOL's finance and compliance controls.

2. Core rule

No affiliate payout may be released unless the affiliate has:

1. completed the required payout setup,
2. completed the required tax-data submission,
3. been classified into the applicable payout/tax category,
4. passed any required withholding/review checks,
5. and been approved for payout in the system of record.

Commission may be accrued or shown as provisional before payout readiness, but it must not become payable for cash release until tax readiness is complete.

3. Scope

This framework applies to all affiliate commissions, referral-based payouts, manual affiliate payout adjustments, and any other compensation paid under the POOOL Affiliate Program.

It applies regardless of:

- payout size,
- affiliate tier,
- payment frequency,
- or whether the affiliate is a natural person or legal entity.

4. Tax-handling principle

POOOL must treat affiliate payouts as tax-relevant payment events requiring structured review before release.

The purpose of the tax workflow is not to make informal assumptions, but to ensure that:

- the recipient is correctly classified,
- required data is on file,
- any withholding requirement is identified,
- and reporting obligations are handled through finance's approved process. **[LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]**

5. Mandatory payout/tax gating

Before any commission moves from "approved commission" to "release for payment," the following gating rule applies:

Payout is blocked unless all required payout and tax fields are complete and the affiliate is marked tax-ready by finance/operations.

Minimum gating statuses should include:

- Pending Payout Setup
- Pending Tax Data
- Pending Classification
- Pending Finance Review
- Tax Ready
- Payout Blocked
- Payable
- Paid

6. Recipient classification logic

For launch, POOOL should classify each affiliate payout recipient into one of the following operational categories:

A. Indonesian individual

Use this category where the payout recipient is treated as an Indonesian natural person for payout/tax workflow purposes.

Operational consequence:

- collect required personal payout details,
- collect required taxpayer / tax-status information,
- route through the finance workflow for individual-recipient withholding/review handling,

- and do not release payout until the individual classification file is complete.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

B. Indonesian entity

Use this category where the payout recipient is treated as an Indonesian company, business, or other domestic entity for payout/tax workflow purposes.

Operational consequence:

- collect required entity payout details,
- collect required entity tax identification and supporting data,
- confirm entity classification in the finance workflow,
- and apply the domestic-entity withholding/review process selected by finance before payout.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

C. Foreign recipient

Use this category where the payout recipient is not treated as an Indonesian domestic individual or domestic entity for payout/tax workflow purposes.

Operational consequence:

- collect required foreign-recipient payout details,
- collect jurisdiction / residency / tax-supporting data required by finance,
- route through foreign-recipient withholding review,
- and block payout until treaty-sensitive and cross-border handling questions are reviewed as required.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

7. Withholding review principle

Finance must determine, before launch, which withholding workflow applies to each recipient class under the approved tax interpretation.

Based on the approved baseline, the withholding review may involve:

- PPh 21 / 26 review for individuals,
- PPh 23 review for certain Indonesian entities / service-type payment treatment,
- PPh 26 review for foreign recipients,
- with treaty-sensitive treatment reviewed separately where relevant.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

This framework does not fix the final legal tax position. It requires finance and legal/tax to operationalize it before live payout.

8. Required affiliate submission items

Before tax-ready status can be granted, the affiliate must provide all required payout and tax information applicable to their classification.

This should include, as applicable:

- legal name / entity name,
- payout beneficiary name,
- payout method details,
- country / residency information,
- recipient type classification,
- tax identification details where required,
- supporting documents where required,
- declarations needed for finance review,
- and any additional documents needed for domestic or foreign payout handling. **[LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]**

9. No payout on incomplete file

If any required payout or tax item is missing, inconsistent, expired, or under review:

- payout must remain blocked,
- commission may remain accrued but unpaid,
- and the affiliate must be prompted to complete or correct the missing information.

There should be no manual exception outside documented finance escalation and approval controls.
[LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

10. Finance approval rule

Before payout release, finance must be able to confirm at minimum:

- recipient class identified,
- required tax data collected,
- withholding handling decision applied or documented,
- payout beneficiary details verified at the required operational standard,
- reporting treatment assigned,
- and payout batch eligibility approved.

11. Reporting and recordkeeping

POOOL must retain a clear audit trail showing:

- who was paid,
- in what classification category,
- on what basis,
- what data was used,
- what withholding/review treatment was applied,
- and when finance approved release.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

These records should be maintained in a format suitable for:

- payout reconciliation,
- complaint handling,
- internal audit,
- tax reporting support,
- and regulator / legal review if needed.

12. Change-of-status rule

If an affiliate's tax or payout status changes, POOOL must be able to:

- pause future payouts,
- request updated data,
- reclassify the recipient,
- and prevent further release until the updated file is approved.

Examples include:

- change from individual to entity payout,
- change of country / residency,
- changed beneficiary data,
- expired or invalid tax information,
- or new withholding/treaty review questions.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

13. Launch-readiness rule

POOOL must not go live with affiliate payouts until finance has finalized:

- the classification decision tree,
- the required document list per category,
- the withholding workflow,
- the reporting workflow,
- the payout-block logic,
- and the review / escalation ownership model.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

D. Short customer-facing / website-facing version

Short internal finance summary

Affiliate commissions are **not payable automatically**.

Before any payout is released, finance must confirm:

- the affiliate's recipient category,
- that complete payout and tax data is on file,
- that the correct withholding/review path has been assigned,
- and that the payout is approved for release.

For launch, finance must work with three operational categories:

1. Indonesian individuals,
2. Indonesian entities,
3. foreign recipients.

No complete file, no payout release.

E. Required UI text / checkbox text / disclosure text (if relevant)

Affiliate-facing wording explaining that payouts require complete tax and payout data

Short affiliate-facing explanation

To receive affiliate payouts, you must first complete your payout and tax profile.

This includes the payout details and tax information required for your recipient type. Your commission may appear in your dashboard, but it will not be released until your payout and tax setup is complete and approved.

Plain-language onboarding / dashboard text

Payouts require completed payout and tax details.
If your payout or tax information is incomplete, your commission will remain on hold until your file is approved.

Checkbox / acknowledgement text

I understand that affiliate payouts require complete and approved payout and tax information and may be withheld until my file is fully reviewed.

Missing-data warning text

Your payout is currently on hold because your payout or tax setup is incomplete. Please complete the required information before the next payout cycle.

F. Operational / backend / implementation notes

Classification logic for Indonesian individuals, Indonesian entities, and foreign recipients

1. Indonesian individuals

Operational treatment:

- classify as domestic natural person,
- collect personal identity-linked payout details,
- collect required tax information for individual payout handling,
- assign to the individual withholding/review workflow,
- do not release payout until finance marks the file tax-ready. **[LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]**

2. Indonesian entities

Operational treatment:

- classify as domestic legal entity / business recipient,
- collect entity payout details and entity tax details,
- collect any supporting entity documents required by finance,
- assign to the domestic-entity withholding/review workflow,
- do not release payout until finance marks the file tax-ready. **[LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]**

3. Foreign recipients

Operational treatment:

- classify as non-domestic payout recipient,

- collect foreign payout details and residency-related data required by finance,
- assign to the cross-border withholding/review workflow,
- review treaty-sensitive questions before release where applicable,
- do not release payout until finance marks the file tax-ready.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

List of required operational controls before launch

1. Classification controls

- recipient classification decision tree finalized
- Indonesian individual / Indonesian entity / foreign recipient logic documented
- edge-case escalation owner assigned
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

2. Data collection controls

- mandatory payout fields defined by recipient category
- mandatory tax fields defined by recipient category
- required document list defined by recipient category
- incomplete-file blocking logic implemented

3. System controls

- payout status fields created
- tax-readiness field created
- payout block flag created
- finance approval field created
- audit trail for status changes enabled
- commission cannot enter payout batch unless tax-ready = yes

4. Withholding / review controls

- finance withholding workflow documented
- domestic-individual review path documented
- domestic-entity review path documented
- foreign-recipient review path documented
- treaty-sensitive escalation process documented
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

5. Reporting controls

- payout register format defined
- withholding/reporting output fields defined
- finance reconciliation workflow defined
- document retention owner assigned
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

6. Operational ownership controls

- operations owner for missing-data follow-up assigned
- finance owner for tax classification assigned
- escalation owner for unusual cases assigned
- suspension / payout-freeze coordination path defined

7. Affiliate communication controls

- onboarding screens updated
- dashboard warning text implemented
- missing-tax-data reminders implemented
- support macros prepared for payout-on-hold cases

8. Pre-go-live control

- test case completed for each recipient class
- blocked-payout scenario tested
- incomplete-file scenario tested
- post-approval payout release scenario tested
- audit-log export tested

G. Open legal-review items

- Final legal tax treatment and withholding mapping for each recipient class.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]
- Confirmation of which specific tax documents/data points are mandatory for each recipient category.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]
- Confirmation of treaty-handling requirements for foreign recipients.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]
- Confirmation of whether any payouts must be blocked entirely in certain cross-border cases.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]
- Confirmation of record-retention requirements for affiliate tax and payout files.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

- Confirmation of whether affiliate dashboard display should show gross commission, withheld amount, and net payable separately.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

H. Final recommended version

Use the following as the formal rule:

> **POOOL must not release any affiliate payout unless the affiliate has completed the required payout and tax setup, has been classified into the applicable recipient category, and has been approved through the relevant finance withholding/review workflow. For launch, POOOL must distinguish at minimum between Indonesian individuals, Indonesian entities, and foreign recipients. Incomplete payout or tax files must block payout release. Finance must finalize the classification, withholding, reporting, escalation, and audit-control process before the affiliate payout function goes live.**
> **[LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]**

Point 14: Affiliate Privacy and Data Handling

A. Objective of this point

Create the privacy and data-handling framework for the POOOL Affiliate Program so that affiliate operations are supported by clear rules on:

- what data is collected,
- why it is collected,
- who may access it,
- how long it is kept,
- when it must be deleted,
- and how incidents must be handled.

This point is intended to ensure that the affiliate program is not operated as a loose marketing workflow, but as a controlled data-governance environment with clear privacy boundaries.

B. Key assumptions

- The approved baseline in this chat is the binding source of truth.
- The baseline already requires:
  - a separate **Affiliate Privacy Notice**,
  - **minimal data collection**,
  - a **roles and rights concept**,
  - **retention and deletion rules**,
  - and an internal **breach-response process**.
- The baseline also assumes that POOOL processes affiliate-related data such as:
  - affiliate application data,
  - referral tracking data,
  - conversion data,
  - KYC/onboarding data,
  - and payout/tax data.
- This framework is operational and privacy-governance focused. It does not claim a final legal allocation of controller/processor roles, lawful basis, or cross-border transfer treatment.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

C. Full internal/professional draft

POOOL Affiliate Program

Affiliate Data Governance Framework

Phase 1

1. Purpose

This framework governs the collection, use, storage, access, retention, deletion, and incident handling of data processed in connection with the POOOL Affiliate Program.

Its purpose is to ensure that affiliate-related data is handled in a controlled, proportionate, and auditable manner and that privacy controls are embedded into onboarding, attribution, payout, monitoring, and enforcement workflows.

2. Scope

This framework applies to all data processed in connection with:

- affiliate application and onboarding,
- affiliate account administration,
- referral attribution and tracking,
- conversion and qualification events,
- payout and tax handling,
- compliance monitoring,
- complaint handling,
- investigation and enforcement,
- and related support or audit workflows.

It applies to internal teams, systems, vendors, tools, and workflows used to operate the affiliate program.

3. Core governance rule

POOOL may process only the data reasonably necessary to operate, secure, review, pay, monitor, and enforce the affiliate program.

Data must not be collected, exposed, retained, combined, or reused more broadly than required for the approved program purposes.

4. Permitted processing purposes

Affiliate-program data may be processed only for approved operational purposes, including:

- affiliate application intake and review,
- identity/KYC verification where required,

- affiliate account activation and status management,
- referral attribution,
- qualified-referral determination,
- commission calculation,
- payout and tax handling,
- fraud prevention and abuse detection,
- policy monitoring and enforcement,
- complaint and dispute handling,
- internal reporting and audit,
- and legal/compliance support where required.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

Data must not be used for unrelated purposes unless separately approved and properly reflected in the applicable privacy and internal governance documents.
[LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

5. Data categories processed

A. Affiliate identity and profile data

This may include:

- full name,
- contact details,
- country / residency information,
- affiliate account identifiers,
- channel / profile information submitted during application,
- and related onboarding profile fields.

B. Affiliate onboarding and verification data

This may include:

- application responses,
- KYC/identity-verification status,
- verification documents or document metadata where required,
- screening outcomes,
- training completion status,
- quiz completion status,
- acknowledgements,
- consent records,
- and policy acceptance records.

C. Referral attribution and performance data

This may include:

- affiliate ID,
- referral link or code ID,
- referral timestamps,
- campaign/source/channel metadata,
- referral status,
- qualified-referral status,
- conversion timestamps,
- tier-related volume records,
- and payout-eligibility status.

D. Transaction-linked program data

This may include only the minimum investment/conversion fields necessary for affiliate qualification and payout logic, such as:

- first eligible paid investment status,
- qualifying event timestamp,
- qualifying amount where needed for program rules,
- holdback status,
- reversal status,
- and exclusion reason codes.

Affiliates themselves should not receive unrestricted visibility into underlying customer transaction details beyond what is strictly necessary for the approved affiliate interface design.
[LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

E. Payout and tax data

This may include:

- payout beneficiary details,
- payout method details,
- tax classification fields,
- supporting tax documents,
- withholding/readiness status,
- payout approval status,
- payout history,
- and finance review records.

F. Monitoring, complaint, and enforcement data

This may include:

- content review records,
- moderation flags,
- policy-breach records,

- customer complaints related to affiliate conduct,
- investigation notes,
- suspension/freeze/clawback records,
- and internal decision logs.

G. Technical and security data

This may include:

- account activity logs,
- login/session data,
- device/browser metadata where used,
- IP-related or anomaly-detection metadata where available,
- audit trail records,
- and system event history used for fraud prevention, security, or investigation. **[LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]**

6. Minimum data principle

POOOL must apply a strict minimum-data rule throughout the affiliate program.

This means:

- collect only data required for a defined program purpose;
- do not request optional sensitive data unless clearly necessary and approved;
- do not expose more customer or affiliate data to internal users than needed for their role;
- do not retain duplicate datasets without operational need;
- do not build affiliate-facing features that reveal unnecessary customer-level detail;
- and do not keep data merely because it may become useful later.

Where the same purpose can be achieved with less data, less granular data, masked data, or aggregated data, POOOL should use the less intrusive option.

7. Access-control framework

Access to affiliate-program data must be role-based and need-to-know only.

At minimum, access should be separated across:

- affiliate operations,
- compliance,
- finance,
- customer support,
- product/engineering,
- legal/privacy review,
- and audit/management oversight.

The following access principles apply:

- affiliate-facing dashboards may show only the minimum data necessary for the affiliate's own program participation;
- operations may access onboarding and workflow data relevant to application handling;
- compliance may access monitoring, investigation, and incident data relevant to risk review;
- finance may access payout and tax data relevant to release and reporting workflows;
- product/engineering access should be limited to what is operationally necessary for system support, debugging, and controlled administration;
- privileged/admin access must be limited, logged, and reviewable.

8. Internal data separation rule

POOOL should maintain internal separation between:

- affiliate account data,
- customer account data,
- KYC/identity data,
- transaction/investment data,
- payout/tax data,
- and enforcement/investigation data.

Teams should not have broad cross-category visibility unless required for their function.

In particular:

- affiliates must not receive internal compliance data,
- affiliates must not receive underlying customer KYC documents,
- affiliates must not receive unrestricted transaction-level visibility,
- and customer-facing teams should not access tax/payout files unless necessary for support escalation.

9. Retention requirements

POOOL must define and implement written retention periods for each major affiliate-program data category.

At minimum, retention schedules should cover:

- application records,
- KYC/onboarding records,
- referral attribution records,
- qualification and payout records,
- policy acceptance and consent logs,

- complaint and investigation files,
- tax/payout documentation,
- and audit logs.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

Retention periods should be:

- purpose-based,
- documented,
- consistently applied,
- and aligned with legal, tax, complaint, fraud, audit, and operational needs.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

10. Deletion and deactivation requirements

When data is no longer required for an approved purpose and no retention obligation applies, it should be deleted, anonymized, or otherwise removed from active use in accordance with POOOL's retention rules.

Deletion handling should distinguish between:

- application rejected,
- affiliate never activated,
- affiliate inactive,
- affiliate terminated,
- payout/tax records still subject to retention,
- complaint/investigation hold,
- and legal/audit preservation hold.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

POOOL should ensure that deletion requests and scheduled deletion actions can be:

- recorded,
- reviewed,
- approved where necessary,
- and evidenced.

11. Security and protection requirements

Affiliate-program data must be protected through appropriate technical and organizational controls, including:

- access controls,
- authentication controls,
- logging and audit trails,

- data segregation,
- secure document handling,
- approved storage locations,
- restricted export/download capability where appropriate,
- and incident response escalation processes.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

Sensitive records such as identity/KYC data, payout/tax files, and investigation materials should be subject to enhanced internal restrictions.

12. Breach-response requirements

POOOL must maintain an internal breach-response process covering affiliate-program data.

At minimum, the process should support:

- incident identification,
- containment,
- access suspension where needed,
- internal escalation,
- impact assessment,
- remediation,
- evidence preservation,
- and notification decision-making under the applicable privacy/legal framework.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

The breach process should clearly assign ownership across:

- security/technical response,
- privacy/legal review,
- compliance,
- operations,
- and communications.

13. Auditability and logging

POOOL must maintain evidence showing:

- what affiliate-program data was collected,
- what notices and acknowledgements were shown,
- who accessed which records,
- what changes were made,
- what approvals were recorded,
- when payout/tax data changed,
- and how incidents, complaints, deletions, or freezes were handled.

Important admin and data-access actions should be logged in a retrievable audit trail.

14. Vendor and tool control

Any tool, system, or vendor used in the affiliate workflow must be reviewed and approved before being used for:

- identity/KYC handling,
- tracking,
- payout/tax processing,
- document storage,
- communications,
- analytics,
- or case management.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

POOOL should document:

- what tool is used for what function,
- what data it receives,
- who can access it,
- and what contractual/privacy controls apply.

15. Privacy-notice alignment rule

The external Affiliate Privacy Notice and internal operating controls must describe the same real data flows.

POOOL must not publish a privacy notice that is materially inconsistent with:

- actual onboarding fields,
- actual tracking logic,
- actual payout/tax data collection,
- actual monitoring workflows,
- or actual retention and deletion practices.

16. No uncontrolled data sharing rule

Affiliate-program data must not be shared externally or internally on an ad hoc basis without a defined purpose, approved access path, and documented control.

This includes:

- screenshots,
- exports,

- spreadsheets,
- case notes,
- chat messages,
- or informal sharing between teams.

17. Governance review rule

The affiliate-program data model should be reviewed:

- before go-live,
- when major program changes are introduced,
- when new tools/vendors are added,
- when new data fields are collected,
- and after material incidents or complaint trends.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

D. Short customer-facing / website-facing version

Short summary for affiliates / customers

POOOL processes affiliate-related data only to operate and protect the affiliate program.

This may include onboarding data, referral tracking data, qualification and payout data, compliance records, and related support or investigation records.

POOOL should collect only the data needed for the program, restrict access by role, keep records only as long as required, and maintain internal processes for deletion, security, and incident response.

For affiliates and customers, the key message is simple:
POOOL should use affiliate-program data only for defined program purposes and handle it through controlled access, retention, and protection rules.

E. Required UI text / checkbox text / disclosure text (if relevant)

Categories of data processed

The affiliate-program framework should recognize at minimum these categories:

1. Affiliate identity and profile data

2. Onboarding, KYC, and acceptance data
3. Referral attribution and conversion data
4. Qualification and payout-related transaction data
5. Payout and tax data
6. Monitoring, complaint, and enforcement data
7. Technical, security, and audit-log data

Plain-language privacy / acknowledgment text

Affiliate privacy summary:
POOOL uses affiliate-program data to onboard affiliates, track referrals, determine qualified referrals, manage payouts, monitor compliance, and protect the program from fraud or misuse.

Onboarding acknowledgment text:
I understand that POOOL may process my affiliate-program data for onboarding, referral tracking, qualification, payout, compliance, fraud prevention, and program administration as described in the Affiliate Privacy Notice.

Customer-facing referral privacy support text:
POOOL may process referral and attribution data to determine whether a user entered through a referral path and whether any referral qualifies under the program rules.

F. Operational / backend / implementation notes

Minimum data principle

Operationally, POOOL should implement the following minimum-data controls:

- each onboarding field should have a defined purpose;
- optional fields should be limited;
- affiliate dashboards should show only necessary summary data;
- customer data shown in affiliate tools should be minimized or masked where possible;
- investigation data should be restricted to approved internal roles;
- exports should be limited and logged;
- duplicate storage should be reduced.

Access, retention, deletion, and breach-response requirements

1. Access requirements

- role-based access model documented
- privileged access limited and logged
- finance access separated from general operations access
- compliance access separated from affiliate-facing visibility
- affiliate-facing views restricted to the affiliate's own permitted information
- document downloads restricted where appropriate
- periodic access review process assigned

2. Retention requirements

- written retention schedule defined per data category
- retention owner assigned
- legal/tax/complaint hold logic defined
- archived vs active storage distinction defined
- expired data review mechanism implemented **[LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]**

3. Deletion requirements

- deletion triggers defined
- deletion workflow documented
- deletion request intake path defined where applicable **[LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]**
- suppression of deletion where legal/audit/complaint hold applies
- deletion/anonymization action logged
- orphaned or duplicate data cleanup process assigned

4. Breach-response requirements

- incident owner assigned
- affiliate-program incidents included in central breach-response plan
- severity classification defined
- containment actions documented
- legal/privacy escalation path documented
- evidence preservation checklist prepared
- notification decision workflow documented **[LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]**
- post-incident remediation review required

Implementation notes for privacy notice drafting and internal controls

A. Privacy notice drafting notes

The Affiliate Privacy Notice should clearly cover:

- who the notice applies to,
- what categories of affiliate-program data are collected,
- why that data is processed,
- what systems/workflows use it,
- who may receive or access it internally or externally,
- how long it is retained,
- how deletion/retention exceptions work,
- how security and incident handling are managed at a high level,
- and what contact/escalation path applies for privacy-related requests. **[LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]**

The notice should match actual operations and avoid vague generic wording.

B. Internal control notes

Before launch, POOOL should have:

- a field-level data map for affiliate onboarding and payout flows,
- a system access matrix,
- a retention matrix,
- a deletion workflow,
- a breach-response playbook,
- approved storage locations for sensitive files,
- vendor/tool review records,
- and a version-controlled Affiliate Privacy Notice.

C. Product / engineering notes

- add role-based permissions by module and data type
- separate affiliate-facing summary data from internal raw data
- log access to sensitive records
- support status flags for retention hold / deletion hold
- support audit export for access, consent, payout, and incident history
- avoid showing unnecessary customer-level details in affiliate views
- ensure policy/version IDs are stored with acknowledgements

D. Compliance / operations notes

- use only approved channels/tools for affiliate data handling
- prohibit informal sharing of screenshots and exports except through controlled workflows
- train teams on what affiliate-program data they may and may not access
- review complaint and incident trends for privacy-control gaps
- ensure suspension, freeze, and investigation workflows also preserve necessary records

G. Open legal-review items

- Final allocation of controller/processor roles and any equivalent local privacy-role mapping.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]
- Final retention periods by data category.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]
- Final deletion-rights handling and any exceptions that must apply.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]
- Final incident/breach notification obligations, timelines, and thresholds.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]
- Final treatment of cross-border storage, vendor access, and transfer issues, if any.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]
- Final rule on how much customer-level referral/conversion detail may be shown in affiliate dashboards.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

H. Final recommended version

Use the following as the formal rule:

> **POOOL must operate the Affiliate Program under a controlled data-governance framework. The program may process only the data reasonably necessary for affiliate onboarding, referral attribution, qualification, payout, tax handling, compliance monitoring, fraud prevention, complaint handling, and audit support. POOOL must apply a minimum-data principle, role-based access controls, written retention and deletion rules, and a defined breach-response process. A separate Affiliate Privacy Notice must accurately describe the real affiliate-program data flows and must be aligned with internal controls, system behavior, and operational practice.**

Point 15: Monitoring, Suspension, Freezing, and Clawback Controls

A. Objective of this point

Create the enforcement and control framework for the POOOL Affiliate Program so that POOOL can:

- monitor affiliate conduct and referral quality,
- investigate possible breaches,
- freeze links, payouts, or commissions when needed,
- suspend affiliates where risk exists,
- and claw back commissions where payouts should not have been earned or retained.

This point is intended to ensure that the affiliate program is enforced through real operational controls, not just contract language.

B. Key assumptions

- The approved baseline in this chat is the binding source of truth.
- The baseline already requires active monitoring, not just written rules.
- The baseline specifically requires:
    - consent logging,
    - versioned materials,
    - reporting mechanisms,
    - link deactivation,
    - payout freeze capability,
    - clawback capability,
    - and suspension controls.
- The baseline also supports the principle that the contract alone is not enough; POOOL needs training, monitoring, and sanctions.
- The framework must apply to:
    - conduct breaches,
    - qualification failures,
    - fraud/abuse concerns,
    - reversal events,
    - and other program-integrity issues.
- This draft is prepared to legal-review standard and is not legally final. **[LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]**

C. Full internal/professional draft

POOOL Affiliate Program

Monitoring, Suspension & Clawback Framework

Phase 1

1. Purpose

This framework governs the monitoring, investigation, freezing, suspension, removal, and clawback mechanisms applicable to the POOOL Affiliate Program.

Its purpose is to ensure that POOOL can:

- detect and review misconduct or abuse,
- protect customers and program integrity,
- prevent improper payouts,
- respond proportionately to breach severity,
- and preserve a clear audit trail for enforcement decisions.

2. Core enforcement rule

POOOL must operate the affiliate program with active monitoring and enforceable controls.

Where there is evidence or reasonable suspicion of:

- prohibited affiliate conduct,
- invalid referral qualification,
- fraud or manipulation,
- policy breach,
- payment/reversal issues,
- or misuse of POOOL materials or systems,

POOOL may review, restrict, freeze, suspend, deactivate, deny payout, claw back commissions, or permanently remove the affiliate, subject to internal procedure and applicable law.
[LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

3. Control layers

The enforcement framework should operate through five control layers:

A. Monitoring

Ongoing detection of conduct, content, attribution, qualification, payout, and abuse-risk signals.

B. Review

Case-level assessment of a flagged affiliate, referral, payout, or conduct incident.

C. Freeze / restriction

Temporary measures used to stop ongoing risk while review is pending.

D. Suspension / deactivation

Temporary or permanent interruption of affiliate participation.

E. Clawback / denial / offset

Financial correction mechanisms where commission should not be paid, retained, or credited.

4. Monitoring scope

POOOL should monitor, at minimum:

- affiliate onboarding and acknowledgment completion,
- use of approved vs. unapproved materials,
- referral-source behavior,
- public affiliate content,
- referral-attribution patterns,
- qualified-referral status changes,
- payout-readiness status,
- reversal and refund events,
- self-referral and referral-ring indicators,
- customer complaints,
- and repeat conduct patterns.

Monitoring should be risk-based, documented, and proportionate to the Phase 1 program model.

5. What may be monitored

Monitoring may include, as relevant:

- affiliate-submitted content,
- public posts, stories, captions, blogs, and videos,
- use of approved links and materials,
- account-status events,
- qualification and payout events,

- exception requests,
- complaint submissions,
- and internal support/escalation records.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

Where monitoring involves sensitive review practices or privacy-sensitive tooling, those aspects must be separately aligned with the privacy framework and legal review.
[LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

6. Monitoring triggers

POOOL should maintain structured triggers for review, including but not limited to:

- prohibited claims or wording,
- missing or altered disclosures,
- use of unapproved materials,
- advisory or recommendation behavior,
- private cold outreach indicators,
- side-deal indicators,
- payment-handling indicators,
- unusual attribution patterns,
- fraud or identity irregularities,
- reversal/chargeback activity,
- referral disputes,
- self-referral indicators,
- referral-ring indicators,
- repeated user complaints,
- refusal to cooperate with review,
- and repeat prior violations.

7. Review rule

When a trigger is raised, POOOL may open a review case.

A review case may assess:

- the conduct itself,
- the affected referrals,
- payout impact,
- customer impact,
- material version used,
- history of prior warnings or incidents,
- and whether provisional protective measures are required.

During review, POOOL may:

- request clarification,
- request supporting records,
- restrict affiliate activity,
- freeze payouts,
- freeze tier progression,
- deactivate the link,
- and reclassify affected referrals or commissions as provisional, blocked, or under investigation.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

8. Freeze controls

POOOL should have technical and operational ability to apply one or more temporary freeze measures, including:

A. Link freeze / deactivation

Temporarily disable the affiliate's referral link, referral code, or attribution path.

B. Payout freeze

Block release of one or more pending commissions, payout batches, or future payout eligibility.

C. Referral qualification freeze

Prevent affected referrals from moving into qualified/payable status while review is pending.

D. Tier-credit freeze

Temporarily exclude disputed or high-risk volume from tier calculations until review is complete.

E. Dashboard restriction

Limit access to materials, dashboard tools, or certain functions while the case is under review.

A freeze is a protective measure and should not be treated as final liability or final breach determination by itself.
[LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

9. Suspension controls

POOOL may suspend an affiliate where:

- serious or repeated rule violations are indicated,
- ongoing risk to customers or program integrity exists,
- cooperation with review is missing,

- repeated warnings have failed,
- or immediate operational separation is necessary.

Suspension may include:

- inactive affiliate status,
- link/code deactivation,
- blocked commission accrual,
- blocked new referral qualification,
- blocked payout release,
- restricted dashboard access,
- retraining requirement,
- or re-certification requirement before reinstatement.

10. Permanent removal

POOOL may permanently remove an affiliate where:

- critical misconduct is established,
- fraud or intentional abuse is identified,
- prohibited advisory/sales conduct caused material risk,
- payment handling or side deals occurred,
- repeated serious violations show disregard of the rules,
- or continued participation is incompatible with program integrity.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

Permanent removal should include:

- termination of active affiliate status,
- deactivation of referral tools,
- removal from payout eligibility for affected commissions,
- preservation of enforcement records,
- and clawback/offset review where applicable.

11. Clawback principle

POOOL may deny, reverse, offset, or claw back commissions where the underlying basis for payout is invalid, disqualified, reversed, or improperly obtained.
[LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

Clawback logic should apply, at minimum, where:

- a referral was not truly qualified,
- payout was made before a later disqualifying event became known,
- fraud or manipulation is detected,

- self-referral or referral-ring conduct is identified,
- commission arose from prohibited conduct,
- reversal/refund/chargeback/cancellation affected the qualifying event,
- or payout was otherwise made in error.

12. No vested-right rule

Until commission is fully cleared under the qualification, review, tax, payout, and enforcement framework, the affiliate should not be treated as having an unconditional right to payment.

Even after payout, commissions may remain subject to post-payment review and correction where the framework expressly allows reversal, denial, offset, or clawback.
[LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

13. Practical separation of measures

For operational clarity, POOOL should distinguish between:

A. Warning

Educational or corrective response without immediate program separation.

B. Restriction / freeze

Temporary control while facts are reviewed.

C. Suspension

Temporary removal from active participation.

D. Permanent removal

Final termination from the affiliate program.

E. Clawback / offset

Financial correction affecting already-earned or already-paid amounts.

These may be used separately or together depending on severity and timing.

14. Event triggers for review, freezing, suspension, and clawback

A. Event triggers for review

Open a review where there is:

- content that may breach permitted/prohibited activity rules,

- customer complaint,
- referral dispute,
- missing disclosure issue,
- unapproved material issue,
- suspicious onboarding or payout data,
- unusual attribution or conversion pattern,
- suspected self-referral,
- suspected referral-ring pattern,
- unusual reversal pattern,
- repeated borderline behavior,
- or internal escalation request.

B. Event triggers for freezing

Apply a temporary freeze where:

- referral qualification is disputed,
- payout is pending but fraud/compliance review is unresolved,
- customer harm is possible,
- unapproved materials are in active circulation,
- serious breach indicators exist but facts are not yet final,
- reversal/chargeback events affect commissions not yet released,
- or continued link activity could worsen exposure.

C. Event triggers for suspension

Suspend where:

- serious conduct breach is indicated,
- the affiliate appears to be acting as adviser, seller, closer, or payment handler,
- private cold outreach is systematic,
- side deals or unofficial promises are suspected,
- repeated breaches continue after warning,
- the affiliate obstructs investigation,
- or interim removal is needed to protect customers or program integrity.

D. Event triggers for clawback

Start clawback/offset review where:

- already-paid commission is tied to a disqualified referral,
- fraud or abuse is discovered after payout,
- self-referral or referral ring is identified,
- a reversal/refund/chargeback invalidates the qualifying event,
- payout was made in error,
- or commission arose from policy-breaching conduct.

15. Operational decision standards

All enforcement actions should follow documented reason codes and severity standards.

Each case should evaluate:

- severity,
- evidence quality,
- customer impact,
- program-integrity impact,
- financial impact,
- whether conduct was accidental or intentional,
- repeat history,
- and whether remediation is realistic.

16. Material versioning rule

POOOL must maintain versioned records of:

- approved materials,
- affiliate acceptances,
- training content,
- disclosure texts,
- and relevant policy versions

so that enforcement can assess what rule set and content version applied at the time of the incident.

17. Reporting mechanism

POOOL should provide an internal mechanism for:

- customer complaints,
- internal staff escalation,
- support-team escalation,
- compliance flags,
- and manager review requests.

The reporting mechanism should support structured case creation and reason-code tagging.

18. Record-preservation rule

Once a case is opened, relevant evidence should be preserved, including:

- content copies,

- links,
- screenshots,
- timestamps,
- user reports,
- system logs,
- payout status,
- qualification status,
- and relevant communications or acknowledgements.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

19. Consistency rule

Monitoring and enforcement must be implemented consistently enough that POOOL can show the program is actually governed in practice and not merely described in documents.

D. Short customer-facing / website-facing version

Short affiliate-facing enforcement summary

POOOL actively monitors affiliate compliance.

If an affiliate breaks the rules, POOOL may:

- issue a warning,
- remove or block content,
- deactivate referral links,
- freeze commissions or payouts,
- suspend the affiliate,
- deny or claw back commissions,
- or permanently remove the affiliate from the program.

Simple rule:
If your conduct creates customer risk, payout risk, fraud risk, or program-integrity risk, POOOL may stop activity first and review the case immediately.

E. Required UI text / checkbox text / disclosure text (if relevant)

1. Affiliate acknowledgment text

I understand that POOOL may monitor affiliate activity, review referral conduct, deactivate links, freeze payouts, suspend accounts, deny commissions, and claw back payouts where required under the affiliate rules.

2. Dashboard enforcement notice

Compliance notice:
Your affiliate participation is subject to monitoring, review, payout controls, suspension, and clawback rules under the POOOL Affiliate Program.

3. Suspension screen text

Account under review
Your affiliate account is temporarily restricted while POOOL reviews a compliance, qualification, or payout matter. During this review, referral tools or payouts may be paused.

4. Payout freeze text

Payout on hold
One or more commissions are currently on hold pending qualification, compliance, fraud, reversal, or payout review.

F. Operational / backend / implementation notes

Event triggers for review, freezing, suspension, and clawback

1. Review triggers

Create a case when any of the following occurs:

- complaint from a customer or user,
- complaint from internal team,
- flagged public post/video/story/blog,
- suspected guarantee or return claim,
- suspected advice or asset recommendation,
- suspected private cold outreach,
- suspected side deal,
- suspected payment handling,
- unapproved material use,
- attribution dispute,
- unusual referral pattern,

- self-referral indicator,
- referral-ring indicator,
- excessive reversal / refund pattern,
- missing mandatory acknowledgment / disclosure issue,
- failed cooperation request,
- repeated borderline behavior.

2. Freeze triggers

Freeze one or more controls when:

- payout is pending but the case is unresolved,
- referral qualification is under investigation,
- high-risk conduct appears ongoing,
- materials need immediate takedown,
- commission was generated from potentially non-compliant activity,
- reversal event hits pending payouts,
- fraud indicators are unresolved,
- or there is credible risk of further damage if the link remains active.

3. Suspension triggers

Suspend when:

- serious breach evidence exists,
- advisory/sales behavior is material,
- private solicitation is repeated or systematic,
- affiliate is handling money or transaction steps,
- affiliate refuses to cooperate,
- affiliate repeats prior warned conduct,
- or interim separation is operationally necessary.

4. Clawback triggers

Open clawback/offset review when:

- the referral later fails qualified-referral standards,
- a paid commission is tied to reversal/refund/chargeback,
- self-referral is confirmed,
- referral ring is confirmed,
- fraud/manipulation is confirmed,
- commission arose from prohibited conduct,
- or payout was released by error.

Operational logging and evidence requirements

For each monitoring or enforcement event, POOOL should log at minimum:

A. Case metadata

- case ID
- affiliate ID
- status of affiliate at case opening
- date/time opened
- trigger source
- trigger category
- severity level
- assigned owner

B. Conduct / incident evidence

- content URL or source location
- screenshot or archived copy
- message copy / transcript where available
- material version used
- policy section(s) implicated
- complaint text or report text
- dates/times of conduct

C. Referral / payout impact data

- affected referral IDs
- affected commission IDs
- affected tier credit
- current qualification status
- payout status
- freeze status
- reversal status if any
- estimated financial exposure

D. Account and system evidence

- acknowledgment version history
- training completion history
- prior warning / enforcement history
- referral-link status changes
- admin actions taken
- access or edit logs where relevant

- system reason codes

E. Decision and outcome log

- decision type
- reason code(s)
- warning issued yes/no
- freeze applied yes/no
- suspension applied yes/no
- clawback review started yes/no
- permanent removal yes/no
- effective date/time
- reviewer / approver identity
- reinstatement conditions if any

F. Preservation requirement

Relevant records should be preserved in a retrievable form for:

- complaint handling,
- payout disputes,
- internal audits,
- legal/compliance review,
- and any later escalation.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

Practical escalation ladder from warning to permanent removal

Level 1 — Warning / correction

Use where:

- breach is minor,
- customer-risk impact is low,
- no fraud/payment-handling issue exists,
- and remediation appears realistic.

Possible actions:

- warning,
- content correction,

- takedown request,
- retraining,
- temporary monitoring flag.

Level 2 — Restricted status / targeted freeze

Use where:

- issue is more than minor,
- facts need review,
- risk is active but not yet final,
- or payout/referral validity is uncertain.

Possible actions:

- freeze pending commissions,
- deactivate specific link/campaign,
- restrict dashboard/material access,
- hold affected referrals from qualification,
- open formal case review.

Level 3 — Temporary suspension

Use where:

- serious breach indicators exist,
- repeat behavior continues,
- advisory/sales conduct is material,
- or customer/program-integrity protection requires temporary separation.

Possible actions:

- suspend affiliate account,
- deactivate all referral tools,
- block new referral qualification,
- freeze payouts,
- require explanation/retraining before reinstatement.

Level 4 — Financial correction / clawback

Use where:

- payout or commission basis is invalid,
- previously approved commission is no longer supportable,
- or improper earnings must be corrected.

Possible actions:

- deny pending payout,
- reverse payable status,
- offset future payouts,
- claw back prior payout,
- recalculate tier status.

Level 5 — Permanent removal

Use where:

- critical misconduct is established,
- fraud or intentional abuse exists,
- payment handling or side deals occurred,
- repeated serious breaches show disregard,
- or reinstatement is not appropriate.

Possible actions:

- terminate affiliate status,
- permanently deactivate links/codes,
- block future participation,
- preserve records,
- complete clawback/offset review,
- escalate internally as required.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

G. Open legal-review items

- Final scope of POOOL's contractual right to freeze, deny, offset, or claw back commissions.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]
- Whether any enforcement action requires mandatory notice, cure period, or appeal path in specific cases.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]
- Whether permanent removal triggers additional customer, finance, or legal notification requirements.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]
- Whether monitoring of certain channels or evidence types requires additional privacy/process safeguards.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

- Whether post-payment clawback should be limited by timing, category, or specific contractual language.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]
- Whether suspension and freeze authority should be split between operations, compliance, and finance by action type.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

H. Final recommended version

Use the following as the formal rule:

> **POOOL must operate the Affiliate Program with active monitoring, review, freeze, suspension, and clawback controls. Where conduct, qualification, payout, fraud, reversal, or program-integrity risk is detected or reasonably suspected, POOOL may open a case, preserve evidence, restrict activity, deactivate referral tools, freeze commissions or payouts, suspend the affiliate, deny affected commissions, and claw back or offset amounts that were not properly earned or retained. Enforcement must be risk-based, documented, auditable, and supported by a practical escalation ladder from warning to permanent removal.**
> **[LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]**

Point 16: Why the Affiliate Contract Alone Is Not Enough

A. Objective of this point

Explain, for internal governance purposes, why POOOL cannot rely on the affiliate contract alone to control Phase 1 affiliate risk.

This point is intended to make clear that:

- a signed contract is necessary, but not sufficient,
- practical governance depends on operational controls,
- and POOOL must combine contractual, product, compliance, training, monitoring, and enforcement layers to run the affiliate program responsibly.

B. Key assumptions

- The approved baseline in this chat is the binding source of truth.
- The baseline already states that the affiliate contract alone does not make POOOL "untouchable."
- The baseline also states that if third parties act for POOOL's interest and cause harm, POOOL may still face customer, regulatory, operational, or dispute exposure even if written rules existed.
- The baseline therefore requires real controls in addition to the contract, including:
  - onboarding,
  - training,
  - approvals,
  - monitoring,
  - logging,
  - freezing,
  - suspension,
  - and clawback.
- This draft is prepared to legal-review standard and is not legally final.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

C. Full internal/professional draft

POOOL Affiliate Program

Governance Position: Why the Affiliate Contract Alone Is Not Enough

Phase 1

1. Core governance position

The affiliate contract is a required foundation document, but it is not, by itself, a sufficient governance system for the POOOL Affiliate Program.

A contract can:

- define permitted and prohibited conduct,
- obtain acknowledgements,
- reserve rights to suspend, freeze, or claw back,
- and strengthen POOOL's position in internal enforcement and dispute handling.

However, a contract does **not by itself**:

- prevent misconduct,
- ensure affiliate understanding,
- stop unapproved communications in real time,
- prove that POOOL governed the program in practice,
- protect customers from non-compliant conduct before harm occurs,
- or demonstrate that POOOL actively controlled the affiliate channel.

For Phase 1, POOOL must therefore treat the contract as only **one layer** of the governance framework.

2. Why contract-only governance is insufficient

A contract-only model fails for four practical reasons:

A. A contract does not ensure understanding

An affiliate may sign terms without actually understanding:

- what general information means,
- when private conversation becomes affiliate communication,
- what counts as advice,
- what counts as a prohibited asset recommendation,
- what a qualified referral is,
- or when payout can be denied or clawed back.

Without training and tested understanding, contract acceptance alone is weak as an operational safeguard.

B. A contract does not prevent conduct drift

Even if the written rules are correct, affiliates may gradually drift into:

- advice,
- persuasion,
- objection handling,
- private outreach,
- side deals,
- or unofficial explanations,

especially if they are motivated by conversion or commission outcomes.

Without monitoring, approvals, and enforcement, written terms do not reliably stop that drift.

C. A contract does not prove real governance

If POOOL is later asked what controls it had in place, a signed agreement alone does not show that POOOL actually:

- trained affiliates,
- reviewed materials,
- tracked acknowledgements,
- controlled link activation,
- investigated complaints,
- froze risky payouts,
- suspended bad actors,
- or corrected improper referrals.

Practical governance requires evidence of active control, not just paper rules.
[LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

D. A contract does not correct problems automatically

When misconduct happens, POOOL needs operational tools to react immediately.

A contract does not itself:

- deactivate links,
- stop a payout batch,
- remove a misleading story,
- freeze disputed commission,
- block tier credit,

- trigger retraining,
- or preserve evidence.

Those are operational controls that must exist separately.

3. The correct governance model

The correct governance model for POOOL Phase 1 is:

> **Contract + onboarding + training + approvals + monitoring + logging + freeze/suspension powers + clawback/sanctions**

Each layer addresses a different control problem:

- **Contract** defines the rules and enforcement rights.
- **Onboarding** prevents unreviewed affiliates from becoming active.
- **Training** reduces misunderstanding and boundary mistakes.
- **Approvals** control who may participate and what may be used.
- **Monitoring** detects real-world misconduct and risk signals.
- **Logging** creates evidence and auditability.
- **Freeze/Suspension** stops risk while review is ongoing.
- **Clawback/Sanctions** correct improper economic outcomes and deter repeat misconduct.

4. Governance consequence for POOOL

If POOOL wants to position the affiliate model as a controlled referral-only system, it must be able to show that the channel is governed in practice.

That means POOOL must be able to answer yes to questions such as:

- Did the affiliate complete onboarding before activation?
- Did the affiliate accept the right policy versions?
- Did the affiliate receive training?
- Did the affiliate pass a basic knowledge check?
- Did POOOL control what materials could be used?
- Could POOOL detect violations?
- Could POOOL freeze or suspend activity quickly?
- Could POOOL deny or claw back improper commissions?
- Could POOOL produce logs and evidence afterward?

If the answer is no, then the contract is functioning as paper protection only, not as a real governance layer.

5. The practical risk of relying only on contract language

Relying only on contract language creates the following risks:

- **customer risk**: affiliates may say or do things the contract forbids, but customers still experience the harm;
- **program risk**: invalid referrals may still be tracked, paid, and tier-counted before discovery;
- **payout risk**: commissions may be released without sufficient control;
- **dispute risk**: POOOL may struggle to prove what was shown, accepted, or monitored;
- **enforcement risk**: POOOL may have rights on paper but no operational mechanism to act quickly;
- **governance credibility risk**: the program may look controlled in documents but uncontrolled in practice.

6. Control framework: why additional controls are required

A. Training is required

Training is required because the affiliate rules are not self-executing.
Affiliates must be taught:

- what they may say,
- what they may not say,
- when to redirect,
- how referral classification works,
- and what creates breach risk.

Without training, the contract is likely to be misunderstood, ignored, or inconsistently applied.

B. Monitoring is required

Monitoring is required because POOOL cannot assume that every affiliate will remain compliant after signing.

Monitoring allows POOOL to:

- detect misuse of materials,
- identify guarantees or advice,
- review complaints,
- investigate unusual referral patterns,
- and intervene before more damage occurs.

Without monitoring, the contract is reactive only after harm becomes visible.

C. Approvals are required

Approvals are required because POOOL must control:

- who enters the program,
- who receives an active link,
- what materials are available,
- and whether a specific workflow or communication format is allowed.

Without approvals, the contract cannot stop unqualified or high-risk affiliates from becoming active.

D. Sanctions are required

Sanctions are required because rules without consequences do not produce reliable channel discipline.

Sanctions include:

- warnings,
- takedowns,
- retraining,
- link deactivation,
- payout freeze,
- suspension,
- permanent removal,
- and clawback.

Without sanctions, the contract lacks practical deterrent value.

7. Management rule

Management should treat the affiliate contract as a **necessary legal instrument**, but never as the only control relied upon for launch approval or ongoing program safety.

A Phase 1 affiliate program should not be considered governance-ready unless the following are all live together:

- contractual documentation,
- onboarding controls,
- training and quiz,
- approved materials process,
- referral qualification logic,
- logging and evidence systems,
- monitoring process,
- complaint and investigation process,
- payout blocking/freeze capability,
- suspension/removal authority,
- clawback process.

8. Internal decision principle

No team should argue that a governance gap is acceptable because "the affiliate signed the contract."

That reasoning is not acceptable for:

- missing onboarding steps,
- missing training,
- missing monitoring,
- missing logs,
- missing review rights,
- missing freeze tools,
- or missing sanction workflows.

If the operational control is absent, the governance framework is incomplete even if the contract text exists.

D. Short customer-facing / website-facing version

Concise board / management memo version

Subject: Why the affiliate contract alone is not enough

The affiliate contract is necessary, but it is not sufficient to govern the POOOL affiliate channel.

A signed contract can define rules and reserve enforcement rights, but it does not by itself:

- ensure affiliate understanding,
- prevent advice or selling behavior,
- control which materials are used,
- stop misconduct in real time,
- prove active governance,
- or protect POOOL against payout, complaint, and channel-integrity failures.

For Phase 1, POOOL must operate the affiliate program through a full control stack: **contract + onboarding + training + approvals + monitoring + logging + freeze/suspension + clawback/sanctions**.

Management should not approve the affiliate launch unless these controls exist operationally, not just contractually.

E. Required UI text / checkbox text / disclosure text (if relevant)

Control framework showing why training, monitoring, approvals, and sanctions are required in addition to the contract

1. Contract layer

Purpose: defines the rules, acknowledgements, and enforcement rights.

Without it: POOOL lacks a formal rule base.

2. Onboarding layer

Purpose: prevents unreviewed people from entering the program or receiving an active link.

Without it: anyone could become active before review.

3. Training layer

Purpose: ensures affiliates understand practical boundaries before they start.

Without it: affiliates may sign rules they do not understand.

4. Knowledge-check layer

Purpose: confirms minimum rule comprehension.

Without it: POOOL cannot distinguish between acceptance and actual understanding.

5. Approval layer

Purpose: controls activation, materials access, and exceptions.

Without it: the program becomes uncontrolled at entry and content level.

6. Monitoring layer

Purpose: detects conduct drift, complaints, misuse, and fraud patterns.

Without it: POOOL finds problems too late.

7. Logging / evidence layer

Purpose: proves what was accepted, shown, used, tracked, and enforced.

Without it: POOOL cannot evidence real governance.

8. Freeze / suspension layer

Purpose: allows immediate risk containment during review.

Without it: risky activity can continue while facts are being checked.

9. Clawback / sanctions layer

Purpose: corrects improper outcomes and deters repeat misconduct.

Without it: rules have weak operational consequences.

F. Operational / backend / implementation notes

List of minimum governance controls POOOL must maintain

1. Contractual controls

- signed Affiliate Terms
- Code of Conduct acceptance
- Marketing Materials Policy acceptance
- Qualified Referral & Payout Policy acceptance
- Privacy Notice acknowledgment
- versioned acceptance logs

2. Entry controls

- application process
- KYC / identity review
- payout/tax setup gating
- manual or controlled activation approval
- no active link before approval

3. Training controls

- mandatory onboarding training
- scenario-based rule education

- short quiz / pass requirement
- training completion logs
- retraining path where needed

4. Materials controls

- approved materials library
- version control
- restriction on unapproved decks/scripts
- takedown / replacement process
- owner for approvals

5. Referral qualification controls

- valid attribution check
- KYC completion check
- first paid investment check
- holdback/review logic
- anti-fraud / self-referral / referral-ring controls
- payout gating

6. Monitoring controls

- complaint intake channel
- public content review process
- red-flag keyword / conduct review
- attribution anomaly review
- payout anomaly review
- repeat-offender tracking

7. Evidence controls

- consent logs
- training logs
- content version logs
- disclosure logs
- payout decision logs
- enforcement case records
- admin action history

8. Enforcement controls

- warning workflow
- takedown workflow

- link deactivation
- payout freeze
- qualification freeze
- suspension process
- permanent removal process
- clawback / offset process

9. Governance ownership controls

- named owner for affiliate operations
- named owner for compliance review
- named owner for finance/payout review
- named owner for legal/privacy escalation
- escalation path for cross-functional cases

10. Review controls

- periodic policy refresh
- periodic access review
- periodic materials review
- periodic affiliate re-certification where needed
- incident trend review for governance gaps

G. Open legal-review items

- Whether the internal governance statement should be mirrored in shortened form in the Affiliate Terms or board materials.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]
- Whether any specific control should be mandatory before launch as a legal condition rather than only a governance recommendation.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]
- Whether any sanction or freeze action requires additional notice, cure rights, or escalation formalities.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]
- Whether management should adopt a formal “no-launch without controls” approval memo or board resolution.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

H. Final recommended version

Use the following as the formal internal governance position:

The affiliate contract is a necessary but insufficient control for the POOOL Affiliate Program. It defines the rules and enforcement rights, but it does not by itself ensure understanding, prevent misconduct, demonstrate active governance, or stop improper payouts and customer-risk events in practice. POOOL must therefore operate the affiliate program through a full control framework that includes onboarding, training, approvals, monitoring, logging, freeze/suspension tools, and clawback/sanctions in addition to the contract. The program should not be treated as governance-ready unless those controls are operationally in place.

Point 17: The Master Rule for Phase 1

A. Objective of this point

Create the single controlling rule that defines the Phase 1 operating boundary of the POOOL Affiliate Program.

This master rule is intended to serve as:

- the highest-level conduct rule for affiliates,
- the core interpretation standard for operations, compliance, product, and management,
- and the shortest enforceable summary of what the Phase 1 model is and is not.

It should be strong enough to anchor:

- the rulebook,
- onboarding,
- training,
- moderation,
- enforcement,
- and internal decision-making.

B. Key assumptions

- The approved baseline in this chat is the binding source of truth.
- Phase 1 is a **controlled, referral-only, single-level** model.
- Affiliates may:
    - share general information,
    - use approved marketing materials,
    - share their personal referral link,
    - and direct users to official POOOL pages and documents.
- Affiliates may not:
    - provide personal investment advice,
    - recommend specific assets,
    - promise returns,
    - engage in private cold outreach,
    - negotiate,
    - close,
    - or handle payments.
- The master rule must be stated in a way that is operationally clear and enforceable.
- This draft is prepared to legal-review standard and is not legally final.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

C. Full internal/professional draft

POOOL Affiliate Program

Master Rule of the POOOL Affiliate Program

Phase 1

1. Formal master rule

POOOL affiliates may act only as limited referrers. In Phase 1, they may use only general information, approved marketing materials, their personal referral link, and official POOOL pages or documents to introduce users to POOOL. They must not provide personal investment advice, recommend specific assets, promise or imply returns or safety, conduct private cold outreach, negotiate, close, handle customer funds or payments, or otherwise act as advisers, brokers, sellers, or transaction intermediaries.

2. Controlling interpretation rule

If a communication, workflow, or affiliate action goes beyond:

- general information,
- approved materials,
- personal referral-link sharing,
- and referral to official POOOL sources,

then it is outside the intended Phase 1 model unless expressly approved under a separate written framework.
[LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

3. Boundary rule

The Phase 1 boundary is not defined by whether an affiliate merely mentions POOOL.
It is defined by the affiliate's **function**.

The permitted function is:

- introduction,
- awareness,
- compliant referral traffic,

- and redirection to official POOOL information.

The prohibited function is:

- advice,
- recommendation,
- persuasion,
- negotiation,
- closing,
- payment handling,
- or private solicitation.

4. Substance-over-form rule

POOOL will interpret affiliate conduct by **substance, not label**.

An affiliate is in breach of the Phase 1 model if the affiliate is, in substance:

- advising,
- steering,
- selling,
- persuading,
- negotiating,
- or handling the transaction,

even if the affiliate uses softer wording, indirect language, private channels, informal formats, or another title such as:

- ambassador,
- partner,
- introducer,
- guide,
- mentor,
- consultant,
- or community lead.

5. No-expansion-by-practice rule

The Phase 1 model may not be expanded in practice through:

- exception handling,
- VIP treatment,
- “trusted affiliate” discretion,
- private explanations,
- call-based persuasion,

- private group selling,
- or informal manager approval.

If conduct falls outside the master rule, it is not permitted merely because it was commercially useful, conversion-positive, or done by a high-performing affiliate.

6. Internal application rule

This master rule must control the interpretation of:

- Affiliate Terms,
- Code of Conduct,
- Approved Marketing Materials Policy,
- onboarding,
- training,
- disclosure design,
- qualification review,
- complaint handling,
- investigation,
- suspension,
- clawback,
- and product/engineering design decisions.

Where another internal document is unclear, this master rule should be used as the primary interpretive standard.

7. Default decision rule

When there is uncertainty, the default internal question should be:

> **Is the affiliate still only introducing POOOL through approved information and official POOOL sources, or has the affiliate started advising, selling, persuading, negotiating, or handling the transaction?**

If the second condition is even partly true, the conduct should be treated as outside the Phase 1 model and escalated or stopped.

8. Enforcement consequence

Any conduct inconsistent with this master rule may result in:

- warning,
- content removal,
- link deactivation,
- payout freeze,

- suspension,
- denial of affected commissions,
- clawback,
- or permanent removal,

depending on severity, repetition, customer impact, and program-integrity risk.
[LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

D. Short customer-facing / website-facing version

Short website / help-center version

POOOL affiliates may introduce POOOL, share approved materials, use their personal referral link, and direct users to official POOOL information only. They may not give personal investment advice, recommend specific assets, promise returns, privately solicit users, negotiate deals, or handle payments. In Phase 1, affiliates may refer — but they may not advise or sell.

E. Required UI text / checkbox text / disclosure text (if relevant)

1. Rulebook one-paragraph version

The POOOL Affiliate Program is a controlled referral-only model. In Phase 1, affiliates may use only general information, approved materials, their personal referral link, and official POOOL pages or documents to introduce users to POOOL. Affiliates must not provide personal investment advice, recommend specific assets, promise returns or safety, conduct private cold outreach, negotiate, close, handle payments, or otherwise act as advisers, brokers, sellers, or transaction intermediaries.

2. Affiliate onboarding acknowledgment

I understand that my role is limited to general information, approved materials, my personal referral link, and referral to official POOOL information only. I may not advise, recommend, promise returns, privately solicit, negotiate, close, or handle payments.

3. Internal admin / moderation label

Master Rule Trigger:
If the affiliate is doing more than introducing POOOL through approved information and official sources, escalate for review.

F. Operational / backend / implementation notes

Founder / manager version: logic and boundary of the model

Phase 1 works only if POOOL keeps affiliates inside a narrow, defensible role: **traffic and awareness, not human conversion**.

The logic is simple:

- Affiliates may create attention.
- Affiliates may share approved information.
- Affiliates may send users to official POOOL materials through their personal referral path.
- The user must then review official POOOL information and decide independently.

The moment an affiliate starts helping the user **decide**, **choose**, **commit**, **trust**, **send money**, or **move faster**, the affiliate has crossed out of the referral model and into advisory/sales territory.

That is the boundary management must protect.

This means:

- no “soft closers,”
- no “friendly investment guidance,”
- no “I only explained which asset is better,”
- no “trusted affiliate exceptions,”
- no “private chat conversion support,”
- no “send me the details and I’ll help you through it.”

Operationally, management should use this master rule as the answer to every gray-zone question:
If the affiliate is no longer just introducing and redirecting, stop it or escalate it.

Internal implementation use

This master rule should be:

- quoted in the rulebook,
- shown in onboarding,
- built into training,

- used in moderation decisions,
- used in support macros,
- used in manager approvals,
- and embedded in product copy and dashboard notices.

Product / engineering note

Any feature that encourages or supports:

- personal recommendation,
- private persuasion,
- deal negotiation,
- transaction assistance by affiliates,
- or off-platform conversion handling

should be treated as inconsistent with the Phase 1 master rule unless separately approved.
[LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

G. Open legal-review items

- Whether the master rule should be incorporated verbatim into the Affiliate Terms, or shortened there and expanded in the Rulebook.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]
- Whether the phrases “adviser,” “broker,” “seller,” and “transaction intermediary” should be further tailored in the formal contract wording.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]
- Whether any limited support role provided through official POOOL channels needs explicit carve-out language so it is not confused with affiliate conduct.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]
- Whether the enforcement sentence should be mirrored word-for-word across the Code of Conduct and Monitoring / Clawback framework.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

H. Final recommended version

Use the following as the controlling Phase 1 rule:

> **POOOL affiliates may act only as limited referrers. In Phase 1, they may use only general information, approved marketing materials, their personal referral link, and official POOOL pages or documents to introduce users to POOOL. They must not provide personal investment advice, recommend**

specific assets, promise or imply returns or safety, conduct private cold outreach, negotiate, close, handle customer funds or payments, or otherwise act as advisers, brokers, sellers, or transaction intermediaries. If an affiliate does more than introduce and refer through approved information and official POOOL sources, the conduct is outside the Phase 1 model and may be restricted or sanctioned accordingly.

Point 18: Launch Sequencing and Implementation Order

A. Objective of this point

Define the safest and most defensible order for launching the POOOL Affiliate Program in Phase 1.

This point is intended to ensure that POOOL does **not** activate the program merely because affiliate links, landing pages, or payout logic are technically available. Instead, the program should go live only after the required legal/compliance, operational, product, disclosure, and enforcement layers are in place.

B. Key assumptions

- The approved baseline in this chat is the binding source of truth.
- The baseline already recommends the following order:
    1. first classify and structure the core product / regulatory / licensing position properly,
    2. then finalize the affiliate documents,
    3. define KYC and tax flow,
    4. build media kit and mandatory texts,
    5. manually pilot with a limited group,
    6. manually review payouts first,
    7. only then scale.
- The affiliate program is a **second-layer distribution/control system**, not the primary product-structure layer.
- Phase 1 should launch as a **controlled pilot**, not as an open-scale program.
- This draft is prepared to legal-review standard and is not legally final.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

C. Full internal/professional draft

POOOL Affiliate Program

Go-Live Readiness & Sequencing Plan

Phase 1

1. Core launch principle

The POOOL Affiliate Program must not be launched as a marketing feature first and governed later.

The correct launch standard is:

> **Structure first, controls second, pilot third, scale last.**

This means the affiliate program should become active only after:

- the underlying product/distribution position has been reviewed to the required internal standard,
- the affiliate governance documents are complete,
- onboarding and disclosure flows are live,
- qualification, payout, tax, privacy, and monitoring controls are operational,
- and POOOL has completed a limited pilot under manual supervision.

2. Sequencing rule

The correct implementation order for Phase 1 is:

Step 1 — Core product / structure readiness

Before activating the affiliate layer, POOOL must first ensure that the underlying product and operating structure have been internally defined to the required launch standard.

This includes, as applicable:

- the product model,
- customer journey model,
- platform flow,
- required risk/fee/product disclosure surfaces,
- internal legal/compliance positioning,
- and any broader framework that the affiliate system depends on.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

The affiliate system must not be used to distribute into a product structure that is itself still undefined, unstable, or internally unresolved.

Step 2 — Governance document readiness

Before program activation, POOOL must complete the core affiliate governance stack, including at minimum:

1. Affiliate Terms & Conditions

2. Affiliate Code of Conduct
3. Approved Marketing Materials Policy
4. Disclosure Library / required disclosure texts
5. Qualified Referral & Payout Policy
6. Complaint & Investigation SOP
7. Tax handling workflow / Tax SOP
8. Affiliate Privacy Notice

The program should not launch on a partial-document basis where material governance documents are still missing.

Step 3 — Flow and control readiness

Before activation, POOOL must implement the operational controls required to make the rules work in practice.

At minimum, this includes:

- affiliate application flow,
- KYC / identity review flow,
- payout and tax setup flow,
- policy acceptance logging,
- training and quiz flow,
- referral attribution logic,
- qualified-referral logic,
- holdback/review logic,
- disclosure placement logic,
- logging and evidence capture,
- freeze / suspension controls,
- payout-blocking controls,
- and admin review tooling.

Step 4 — Materials and messaging readiness

Before program activation, POOOL must prepare the approved external communication layer, including:

- approved public affiliate materials,
- approved referral landing pages,
- required short disclosure texts,
- redirect language,
- help-center content,
- training scenarios,
- and moderation reference examples.

Affiliates should not be activated before POOOL has given them a controlled set of approved communication tools.

Step 5 — Controlled pilot launch

The first live phase should be a **manual pilot** with a limited number of approved affiliates.

The baseline launch model supports a pilot of approximately **10–20 affiliates**, manually reviewed and monitored before broader rollout.

This pilot should be treated as a validation phase for:

- onboarding quality,
- content discipline,
- disclosure performance,
- referral tracking,
- qualification logic,
- payout/tax operations,
- complaint handling,
- and enforcement readiness.

Step 6 — Manual payout control phase

During the pilot phase, POOOL should not rely on fully automatic payout release.

Initial payouts should be manually reviewed for:

- referral qualification,
- holdback expiry,
- anti-fraud checks,
- tax readiness,
- payout-file completeness,
- and rule compliance.

This manual review phase is part of launch control and should remain in place until POOOL has evidence that the workflow operates reliably.

Step 7 — Controlled scale-up

Only after the pilot and manual payout phase have produced satisfactory operational results should POOOL increase:

- affiliate volume,
- traffic volume,
- payout volume,
- automation depth,

- or marketing reach.

Scaling should occur in controlled stages, not as an immediate open-public expansion.

3. Launch-readiness rule

No affiliate-program activation should occur until all launch gates in this plan are complete and formally confirmed by the relevant internal owners.

A “soft launch,” “quiet launch,” or “test launch” that exposes real users, real referrals, or real payout rights should still be treated as a live program launch and must satisfy the same control standard.

4. Go-live governance rule

Before launch, POOOL should identify clear internal ownership for:

- affiliate operations,
- compliance review,
- finance / payout review,
- legal/privacy escalation,
- product/engineering implementation,
- customer support escalation,
- and enforcement decisions.

A program should not go live if ownership is unclear or fragmented.

5. Launch gates that must be completed before program activation

Gate 1 — Product / structural readiness

- underlying product and user flow defined
- official risk/fee/product information available in usable form
- internal legal/compliance positioning reviewed to launch standard **[LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]**

Gate 2 — Governance documents complete

- Affiliate Terms finalized to internal launch standard
- Code of Conduct complete
- Marketing Materials Policy complete
- Qualified Referral & Payout Policy complete
- Disclosure texts complete
- Complaint & Investigation SOP complete
- Tax handling workflow complete

- Affiliate Privacy Notice complete

Gate 3 — Onboarding and account controls live

- application flow live
- KYC / identity flow live
- payout/tax setup flow live
- acceptance/version logging live
- training live
- quiz live
- no-link-before-approval control live

Gate 4 — Referral and payout controls live

- referral attribution working
- qualified-referral logic implemented
- holdback logic implemented
- self-referral / referral-ring controls implemented
- payout block / freeze controls implemented
- tax-readiness gating implemented
- manual payout review path implemented

Gate 5 — Disclosure and UX controls live

- referral landing-page disclosure live
- registration disclosure logic live
- pre-investment confirmation logic live
- direct vs referral logic working
- disclosure logging working

Gate 6 — Monitoring and enforcement controls live

- complaint intake path live
- review case workflow live
- link deactivation capability live
- payout freeze capability live
- suspension workflow live
- clawback/offset workflow defined
- evidence logging and preservation working

Gate 7 — Team readiness complete

- internal owners assigned
- operations trained
- finance trained
- support trained

- moderation/escalation process tested
- pilot review responsibilities assigned

Gate 8 — Pilot readiness complete

- pilot affiliate cohort selected
- pilot materials issued
- pilot monitoring cadence set
- manual payout review cadence set
- incident escalation owner assigned
- pilot feedback loop prepared

6. Pilot-stage controls

During the initial pilot, POOOL should apply enhanced controls, including:

A. Limited cohort size

Activate only a small, manually approved affiliate group.

B. Manual approval only

No automatic affiliate activation during pilot.

C. Approved-materials only

Pilot affiliates should use only centrally issued materials.

D. Content visibility review

Where feasible, pilot affiliate public content should be periodically reviewed.

E. Manual referral review

Qualified referrals should be manually checked before payout approval.

F. Manual payout release

No automatic payout release during pilot.

G. Incident-fast-response rule

Any serious breach indicator during pilot should trigger immediate review, and where needed:

- link freeze,
- payout freeze,
- or affiliate suspension.

H. Pilot feedback loop

POOOL should capture pilot findings on:

- unclear rules,
- repeat affiliate mistakes,
- missing disclosures,
- UX friction,
- operational bottlenecks,
- false positives,
- payout delays,
- and training gaps.

Pilot findings should be used to tighten the system before scaling.

7. No-scale-before-proof rule

POOOL must not scale the affiliate program until it has operational proof that the pilot model works.

Operational proof should include evidence that POOOL can reliably:

- onboard affiliates,
- collect acknowledgements,
- train affiliates,
- monitor conduct,
- classify referrals,
- hold and release payouts correctly,
- respond to complaints,
- freeze when needed,
- and preserve evidence.

If these functions are not working consistently, scale should be delayed until remediation is complete.

8. Internal launch decision standard

Management should approve launch only when it can reasonably answer yes to all of the following:

- Is the product/disclosure layer ready enough to support referral traffic?
- Are the governing documents complete?
- Are onboarding, training, and logging live?
- Are referral qualification and payout gating working?
- Are tax/privacy/enforcement controls operational?

- Can POOOL stop problems quickly if needed?
- Is the pilot plan ready and owned?

If not, the affiliate program should remain in pre-launch state.

D. Short customer-facing / website-facing version

Simple implementation roadmap

Use this rollout order:

1. **Finalize core product/disclosure structure**
2. **Complete affiliate governance documents**
3. **Build onboarding, KYC, payout, tax, and logging controls**
4. **Prepare approved materials and mandatory disclosures**
5. **Launch a small manual pilot (10–20 affiliates)**
6. **Review all early payouts manually**
7. **Only then expand gradually**

This is the safest rollout model because it keeps POOOL in control before the program scales.

E. Required UI text / checkbox text / disclosure text (if relevant)

Because this point is primarily internal and operational, no customer-facing checkbox is required.
However, the following internal launch-status labels are recommended:

Internal admin labels

- Pre-Launch
- Controls Incomplete
- Pilot Ready
- Pilot Live
- Manual Payout Review
- Scale Review Pending
- Scale Approved

Internal launch note

Affiliate program status:
The POOOL Affiliate Program may be activated only after all launch gates are complete and the pilot-control phase is approved.

F. Operational / backend / implementation notes

Practical rollout order for product, compliance, and operations

Phase A — Pre-Launch Build

- finalize program rules and document stack
- finalize disclosure placement and confirmation texts
- configure affiliate onboarding flow
- configure training and quiz
- configure referral attribution
- configure qualification and holdback logic
- configure payout block / tax gating / privacy controls
- configure enforcement tools and case logging

Phase B — Internal Readiness Check

- test every major workflow end-to-end
- test missing-data cases
- test payout-on-hold case
- test referral vs direct disclosure logic
- test link deactivation
- test payout freeze
- test evidence export
- assign owners and fallback owners

Phase C — Pilot Launch

- onboard limited affiliate cohort
- keep manual approval active
- keep manual content oversight active where feasible
- keep manual payout review active
- track incidents and friction points weekly or at another defined cadence

Phase D — Pilot Assessment

- review compliance incident count
- review payout error count
- review disclosure completion evidence
- review qualification accuracy
- review support/complaint trends
- review training effectiveness
- update rules/materials/processes where needed

Phase E — Controlled Expansion

- expand only after pilot assessment is acceptable
- increase cohort size gradually
- keep freeze/suspension/clawback fully active
- automate only after control reliability is demonstrated

G. Open legal-review items

- Whether the underlying product / licensing / regulatory positioning is sufficiently settled for affiliate launch.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]
- Whether any launch gate should be made an absolute legal/compliance sign-off requirement rather than an operational recommendation.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]
- Whether a pilot of 10–20 affiliates should remain a recommendation or become a formal launch cap.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]
- Whether manual payout review must remain mandatory for a defined minimum period or volume threshold.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]
- Whether any written internal launch approval memo or board-level sign-off should be required before first activation.
  [LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED]

H. Final recommended version

Use the following as the formal launch rule:

> **POOOL must launch the Affiliate Program in a staged order: first confirm the core product and disclosure structure, then complete the affiliate governance documents, then implement onboarding, qualification, payout, tax, privacy, disclosure, logging, and enforcement controls, then launch a limited manual**

pilot, then manually review early payouts, and only after that scale the program. No affiliate-program activation should occur until the required launch gates are complete and the responsible internal owners confirm readiness. The affiliate channel should be treated as a controlled pilot first and a scaled program only after operational proof exists.

I. Ask whether to continue with the next point

Willst du etwas ändern oder soll ich mit dem nächsten Prompt weitermachen?